

DeskPRO Agent Manual

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1. DeskPRO Overview

Welcome to DeskPRO!

This manual is about using DeskPRO as an **agent**.

- **agents:** the staff within your organization who use DeskPRO to provide help
- **users:** the people you are helping
- **admins:** the staff within your organization who have administrator access to configure your DeskPRO helpdesk

This manual aims to give you a comprehensive understanding of all the power and flexibility of DeskPRO.

If you just want to get started with DeskPRO as quickly as possible, especially if you have used helpdesk software before, try the [Quick Start Guide](#), which gives you an overview of the software.

If you want to know more about setting up and configuring DeskPRO as an **admin**, please see our Knowledge Base at <http://support.deskpro.com>

1.1. Helpdesk basics

If you're new to helpdesks, you might wonder what the benefit of a dedicated helpdesk platform like DeskPRO is.

You *could* try to help your users entirely through email, but, on its own, email is a poor way to track user issues.

If all your support email goes to a single address, it's hard to keep track of who is dealing with which issue; but if each of your staff uses a personalized address, what happens if the staff member who has been dealing with an important client falls ill?

And how do you keep track of the user who sends email from their personal account on the weekend asking for an update on your correspondence during the week?

DeskPRO helps you track issues with **tickets** - each ticket denotes a question, problem or complaint associated with a user. A ticket is a way to tie together everything you know about an issue - all the messages associated with it, both between your helpdesk and the user and internally between your agents, whether the user is waiting for a reply or you're waiting to hear back from them, how urgent it is to fix, and so on.

DeskPRO can take incoming emails to an account such as `support@yourcompany.com` and automatically turn them into tickets. Users can also submit tickets through the DeskPRO web portal. (Depending on how your helpdesk is configured, users might only be able to submit tickets by email or via the web).

1.2. Getting started

You should have received an email with the subject "Your new agent account" with your login details.

Your account has **permissions** (set by your admins) which determine what you are allowed to modify or delete. Depending on your permissions, you may not be able to delete certain items or use some DeskPRO functions (like mass replies).

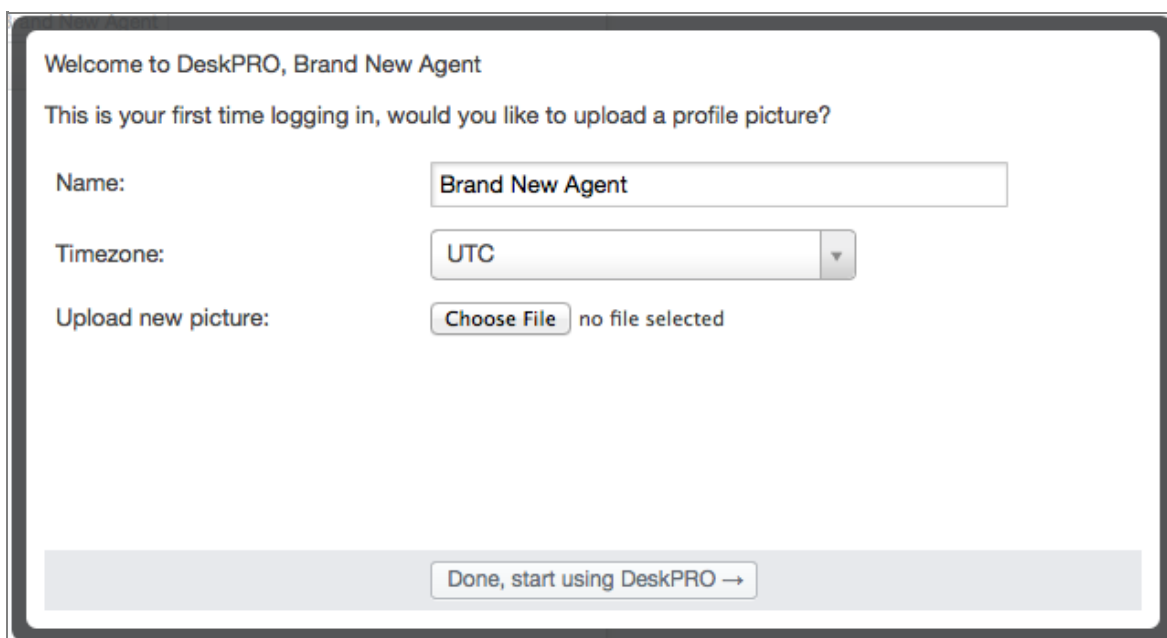
If you find that this manual shows a function that is not available to you, it may be due to your permissions settings.

The email you use for your account cannot be an address that DeskPRO uses to take incoming emails and automatically turn them into tickets. This is to prevent email loops.

Your administrators may have set up DeskPRO so you can sign in using your account from other services (e.g. Joomla or Magento).

Logging in for the first time

When you log in for the first time, you will see a pop-up window.



Welcome to DeskPRO, Brand New Agent

This is your first time logging in, would you like to upload a profile picture?

Name:

Timezone:

Upload new picture: no file selected

Check that your **Name** is correct. You can edit it if necessary.

Note that, by default, users will see the name you enter here. If you would prefer users to see a different name when you communicate with them, you can set an override name from your account preferences in the [Toolbar](#) to use instead. Other agents will still see your real name.

Check that the **Timezone** displayed matches your timezone.

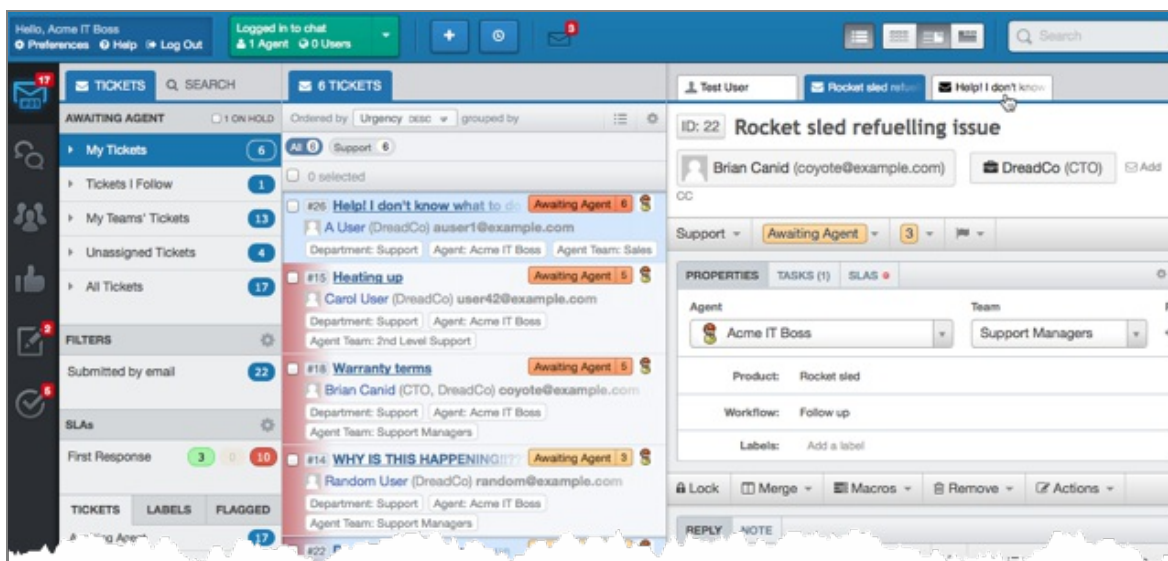
DeskPRO automatically checks the timezone you choose against the one your computer is using. If they are different, DeskPRO will offer you the option to use your computer's timezone setting.

You can choose a picture to represent yourself to users and other agents. You must select an image file in GIF, JPEG or PNG format.

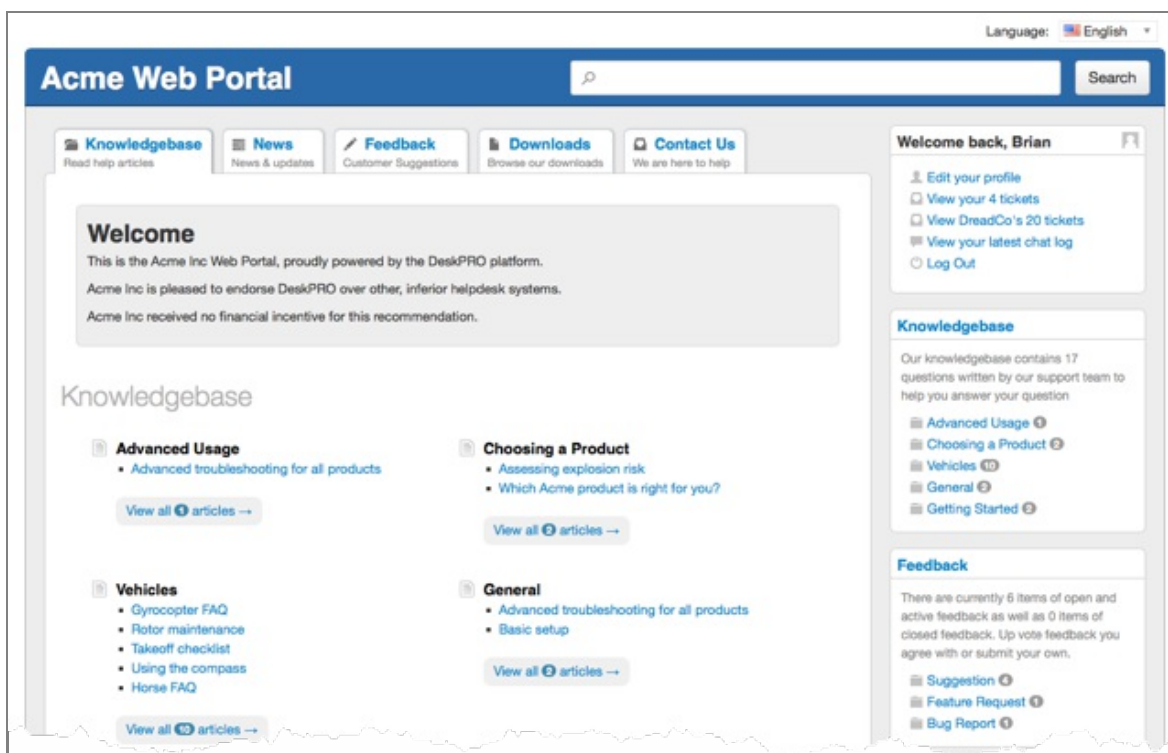
Click **Done, start using DeskPRO** to see the agent interface.

Agent vs user views

The DeskPRO agent interface is what you will use as an agent to provide helpdesk support to users.



Depending on how your organization has set up DeskPRO, your users may have access to a **web portal** where they can view their own tickets, as well as access helpful information and files published from within DeskPRO.

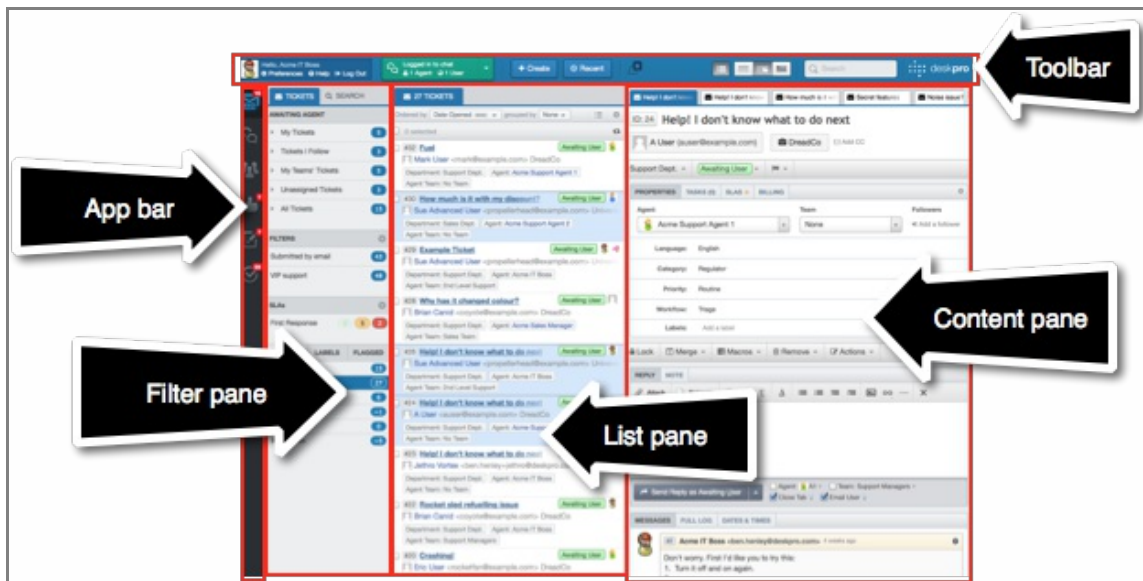


Users may be able to use the portal to submit tickets and provide feedback.

Your organization may not use the web portal at all, instead taking ticket submissions only through email or phone calls.

2. The Agent Interface

Here is an overview of the agent interface.



The **app bar** is where you select which DeskPRO app you want to use.

The **filter pane** and **list pane** are where you work with helpdesk items like tickets, user records, etc. The app you're using affects what sort of items you'll see in these panes.

The **content pane** is where you work on an individual item in detail.

The **toolbar** gives you quick access to important functions like creating a new ticket and quick search. It's also where you can change your account preferences and chat status.

2.1. App bar

The **app bar** is where you select from the applications which make up DeskPRO.

The apps are:

- **Tickets** - you can use this app to search, filter and sort tickets, assign them to other agents or have them assigned to you, communicate with users, and track which tickets have priority or have been waiting for too long; this is the selected app in the screenshot
- **Chat** - chat with users in real-time
- **CRM** - view and edit details of individual users, arrange them into **usergroups** which control how they can interact with DeskPRO, and view and edit the **organizations** to which the users belong
- **Feedback** - manage crowdsourced feedback sent through the web portal
- **Publish** - manage the help content on your web portal
- **Tasks** - keep track of tasks that your agents need to carry out and manage deadlines

2.2. Filter pane

In each app, the **filter pane** at left is used to filter the items you're dealing with: tickets in the tickets app, people and organization records in the CRM app, and so on.

The filter pane allows you to select groups of items to work on.



The default filters help you separate items in ways that are relevant to your work.

Each filter shows only the items which match certain criteria - the number to the right of the filter shows how many match.

There might be hundreds or thousands of tickets in your system, but clicking on the **My Tickets** filter shows you only tickets that are assigned to you and require action.

Customizing filters

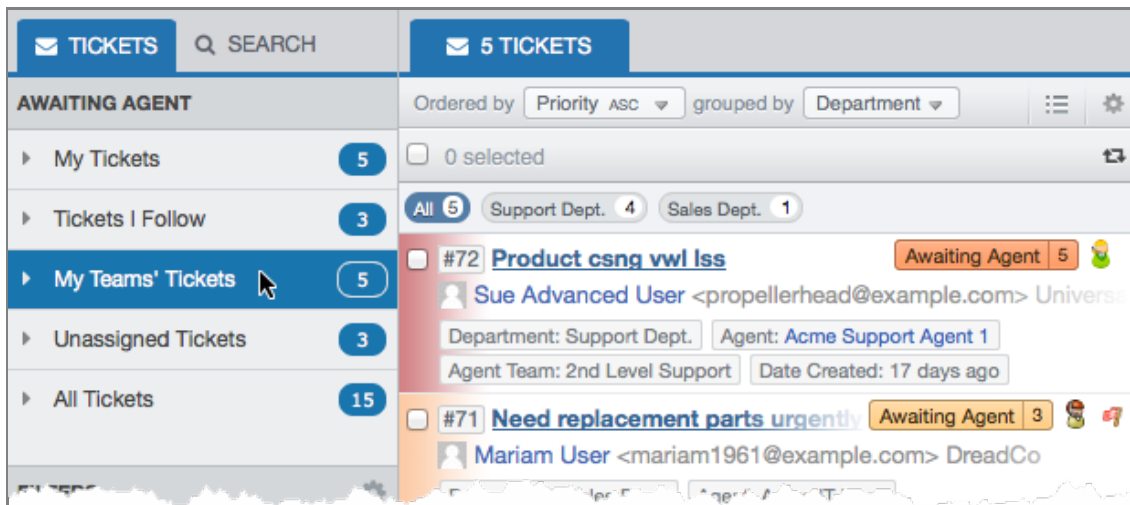
In the **Tickets app**, you can use the filter pane to group tickets further. You can also create powerful custom filters to let you view very specific groups of tickets.

See the section on [Filtering and sorting tickets](#) for more details.

2.3. List pane

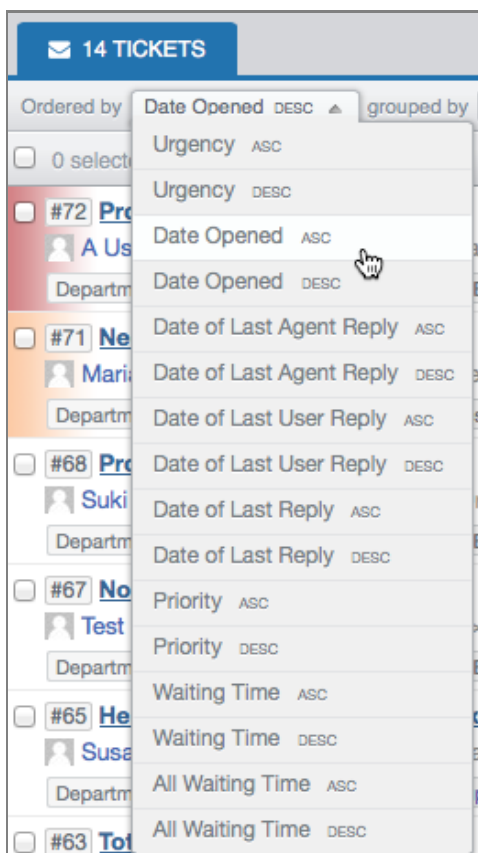
The result of your selection in the filter pane is displayed in the list pane.

For example, if you click on a ticket filter, you will see the list of matching tickets in the list pane. You can think of it as being like a list of search results.

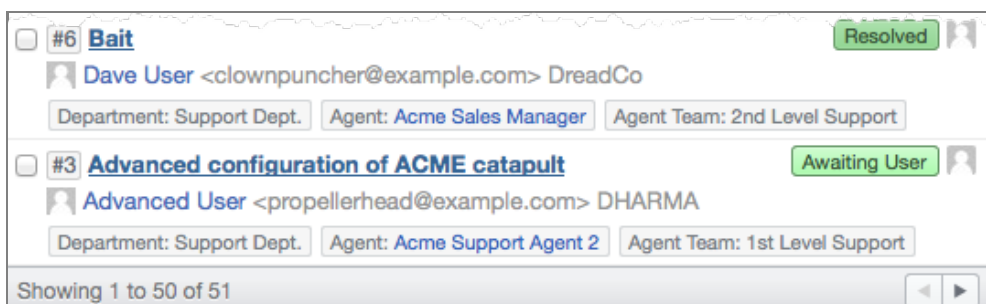


You can change the order of the items in the list in a wide variety of ways using the **Ordered by** pull-down menu at the top left - for example, you can show them with the oldest items at the top, or with the newest items at the top.

In a list of tickets you might want to put the most urgent items at the top, or rank them by the total time the user has been kept waiting; in a list of organizations you might want to rank them by number of users, or number of tickets.

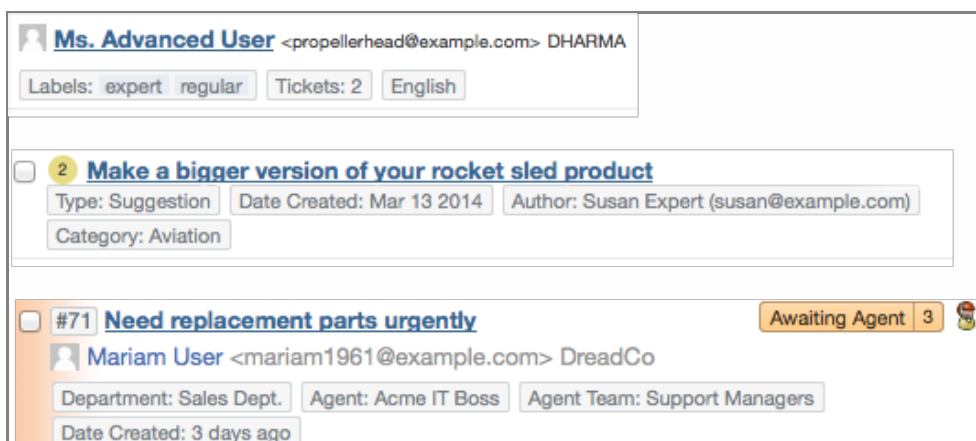


If you have more than 50 items in the list pane, the list is divided into **pages**. Use the arrow controls at the bottom to move between pages.

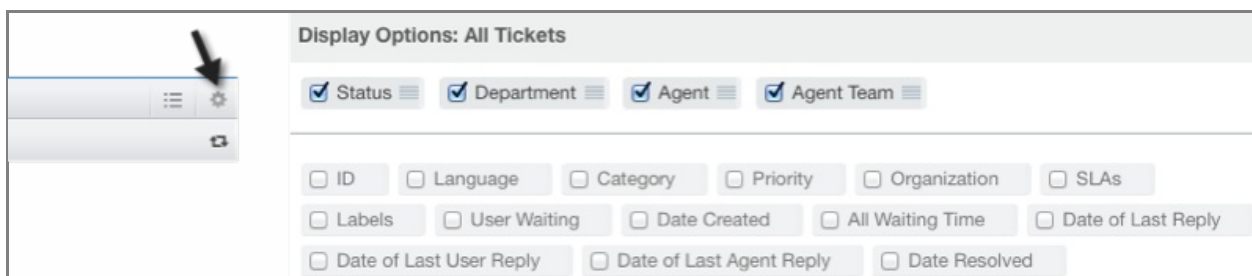


Viewing properties

In the Tickets, CRM and Feedback apps, important properties are shown for each item using gray text labels.



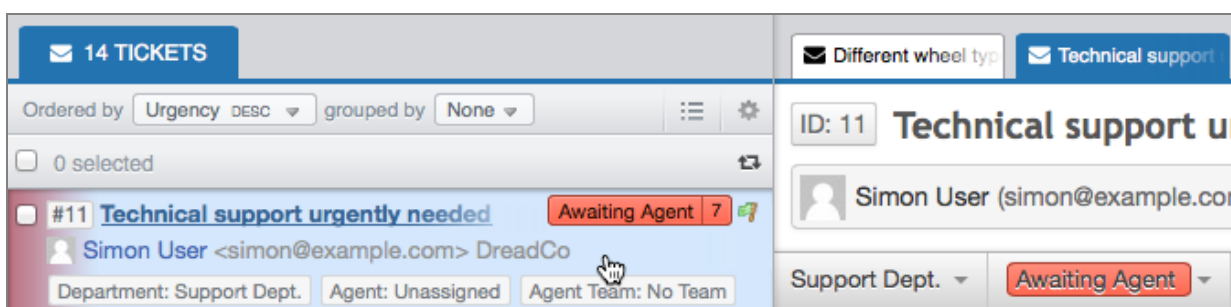
You can customize which properties are displayed using the cog control at the top right of the list pane.



Opening items

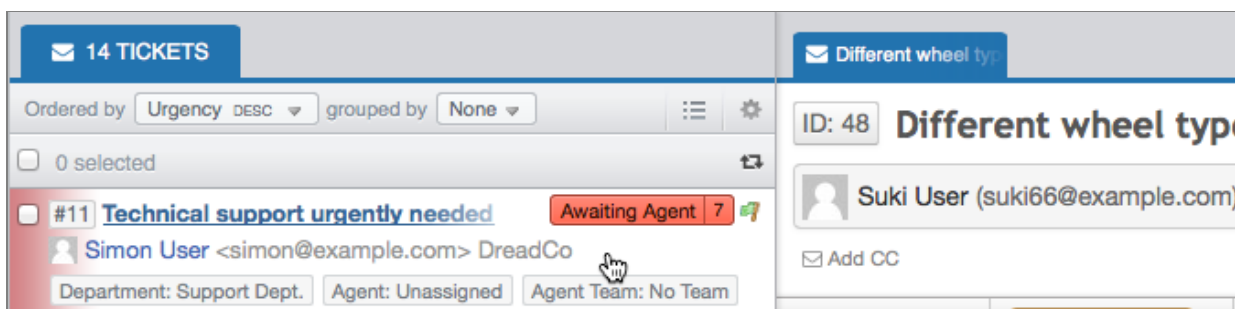
You can **open** items from the list pane into the content pane to view them in more detail.

You open an item by clicking on it - it turns blue to show that it is open, and it is displayed in a new tab in the content pane, in front of the tabs for any other items you have open.

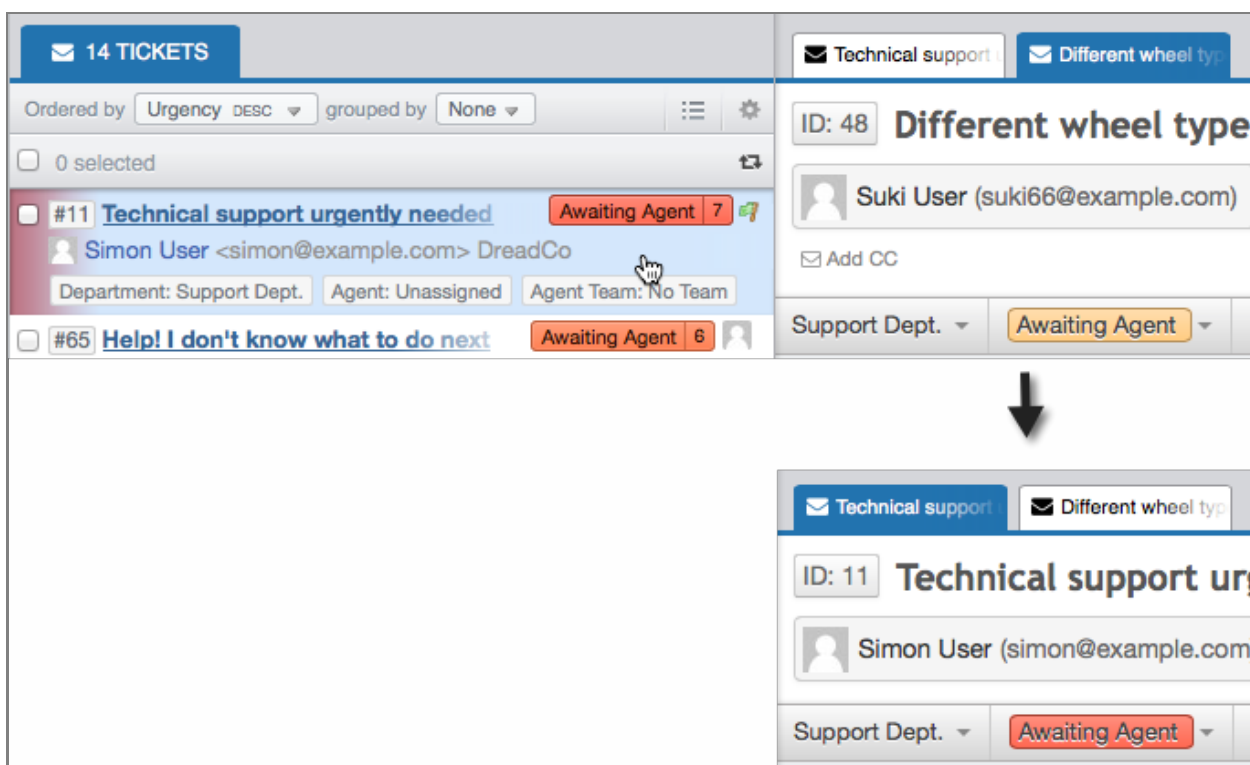


What if you click an item in the list pane that's already open in the content pane?

If it is open with its tab at the front, it closes.

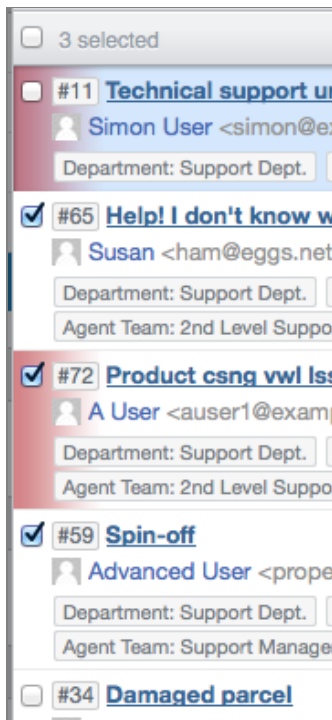


If it is open but *not* at the front of the content pane, its tab is brought to the front.



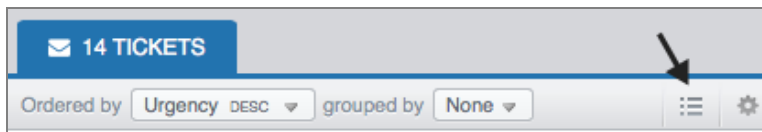
Multiple selections and mass actions

In the **Tickets**, **Tasks** and **Publish** apps, you can select multiple items from the list pane using the checkboxes at the left. This enables you to perform **mass actions** on up to 50 items at once - if you need to delete a lot of items at the same time, you don't have to open them one by one in the content pane.



Viewing a list as a table

In the Tickets and CRM apps, you can view the items in the list pane in a table by clicking on this button:



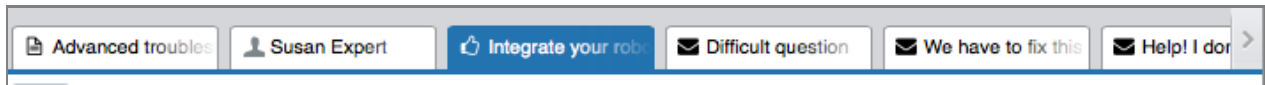
This is useful to get an overview of a long list of items.

Tickets					Ordered by - Urgency	Grouped By None	Display Options
☐	Department	Agent	Team	Category	Date of Last User Reply		
☐	Support Dept.	Acme Support Agent 1		Consumer	N/A		
☐	Support Dept.	Acme Support Agent 1		Consumer	N/A		
☐	Support Dept.	Acme Support Agent 1	2nd Level Support	Reseller	N/A		
☐	Sales Dept.	Unassigned	No Team	Regulator	N/A		
☐	Support Dept.	Unassigned	No Team	None	24 days ago		
☐	Sales Dept.	Unassigned	No Team	Consumer	24 days ago		
☐	Support Dept.	Unassigned	No Team	Regulator	N/A		
☐	Support Dept.	Unassigned	No Team	Regulator	21 days ago		
☐	Support Dept.	Acme IT Boss	2nd Level Support	Consumer	16 days ago		
☐	Support Dept.	Acme IT Boss		Consumer	19 days ago		
☐	Support Dept.	Acme Admin 1		Regulator	N/A		
☐	Support Dept.	Acme IT Boss		Regulator	N/A		
☐	Sales Dept.	Acme IT Boss	Support Managers	Reseller	N/A		
☐	Support Dept.	Acme Support Agent 1		Consumer	N/A		
☐	Support Dept.	Acme IT Boss		Regulator	N/A		

2.4. Content pane

The content pane is where you can view the details of a single item and work on it.

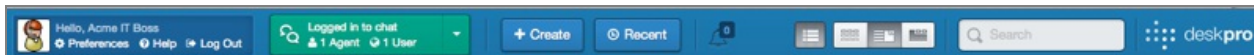
Note that, no matter what app you have selected, a mixture of types of items can be open in the content pane. You can switch between them by clicking on the tabs.



If you have more tabs than can fit in your browser window, you can scroll with the arrows at the edge of the tab bar.

2.5. Toolbar

The toolbar at the top of the agent interface gives you quick access to common tasks like creating a new item, and quick search.



At the top left of the toolbar is the account area which shows you which agent you are logged in as, and lets you access **Preferences** and **Help**, or **Log Out**.



Account preferences

The Preferences control enables you to set options relating to your account.

A dialog box titled 'Account Preferences' with a close button (X) in the top right corner. It has several tabs: 'Profile', 'Signature', 'Ticket Notifications', 'Notifications', 'Macros', 'Filters', and 'SLAs'. The 'Profile' tab is selected. It contains the following fields and options:

- Name:** A text box containing 'Acme IT Boss'.
- Override Name:** An empty text box. A note to the right says: 'If entered, this name will be displayed to users instead of your real name.'
- Email:** A text box containing 'boss@acme.example'. A link to the right says 'Add Additional Emails -->'. There is a vertical scrollbar on the left.
- Timezone:** A dropdown menu showing 'Europe/London'.
- Language:** A dropdown menu showing 'English'.
- Picture:** A section showing a cartoon character icon. Below it is the text 'Your current picture'. To the right is a 'Choose File' button and the text 'No file chosen'.
- Desktop Notifications:** A toggle switch labeled 'Enable Desktop Notifications' which is currently turned on.
- Change Password:** A section with two text boxes: 'New Password' and 'Repeat Password'. A note to the right says: 'Leave this field blank to keep your password the same'.
- Tickets:** A section with several checkboxes:
 - 'Automatically close ticket tabs when:' with two options: 'replying' (checked) and 'adding a note' (unchecked).
 - 'Show newest messages first (reverse chronological order) with the replybox at the top' (checked).
 - 'Automatically load the next ticket in the list after replying (only if closing the ticket tab)' (unchecked).
- Chat:** A section with one checkbox: 'Immediately dismiss "new chat" window when another agent takes a chat' (unchecked).

- **Account profile**
- **Signature** - displayed when you reply to a ticket
- **Ticket Notifications** - control when DeskPRO emails you or notifies you in your browser about tickets and @mentions (see [Replying to a ticket](#) for more about @mentions)
- **Notifications** (controls other notifications)
- **Macros** - shows your [macros](#)
- **Filters** - shows your [custom filters](#)
- **SLAs** - lets you control which [SLAs](#) (*Service Level Agreements*) you see in the Ticket app

In the account profile, you can manage your account and set the following options:

- **Override Name** - a name that is displayed to users instead of the name your fellow agents see
- **Enable Desktop Notifications** - with a modern browser, you can receive pop-up notifications on your computer desktop instead of (or alongside) email notifications; enable desktop notifications here, and configure them under the notifications tabs

You can also set preferences relating to how the interface behaves.

Help

The **Help** section tells you how to contact us and get the latest [Quick Start Guide](#).

The screenshot shows a dark-themed help page. At the top, it says 'CONTACT US' and provides contact details: 'support.deskpro.com' or 'support@deskpro.com'. Below this, it says 'KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS'. The shortcuts are organized into three columns: CREATION, TICKETS, and WINDOW NAVIGATION. CREATION includes shortcuts for opening new forms (t, p, o, k, a, i, n, d). TICKETS includes shortcuts for focus and opening profiles (shift+r, shift+p, shift+o) and replying (ctrl+r, ctrl+s, ctrl+o, ctrl+u, ctrl+a, ctrl+d). WINDOW NAVIGATION includes shortcuts for tab navigation (ctrl+shift+left/right), closing tabs (ctrl+shift+c), and row navigation (up/down, enter, space). There is also a 'PEOPLE' section with a shortcut for opening organization profiles (shift+o).

CREATION	TICKETS	WINDOW NAVIGATION
t Open new ticket form	shift+r Focus reply box	ctrl+shift+left Go to previous tab
p Open new person form	shift+p Open user profile	ctrl+shift+right Go to next tab
o Open new organization form	shift+o Open organization profile	ctrl+shift+c Close current tab
k Open new task form		up or down When in a filter listing, moves selected row cursor
a Open new article form	TICKET REPLYING	enter When in a filter listing, opens the selected row
i Open new feedback form	ctrl+r Send reply	space When in a filter listing, checks the checkbox on the select row
n Open new news form	ctrl+s Open snippets	
d Open new download form	ctrl+o Open send action options	PEOPLE
	ctrl+u Change status to Awaiting User	shift+o Open organization profile
	ctrl+a Change status to Awaiting Agent	
	ctrl+d Change status to Resolved	

It also offers a guide to keyboard shortcuts you can use in DeskPRO.

Log Out

Click here to log out of your DeskPRO account.

The Create button

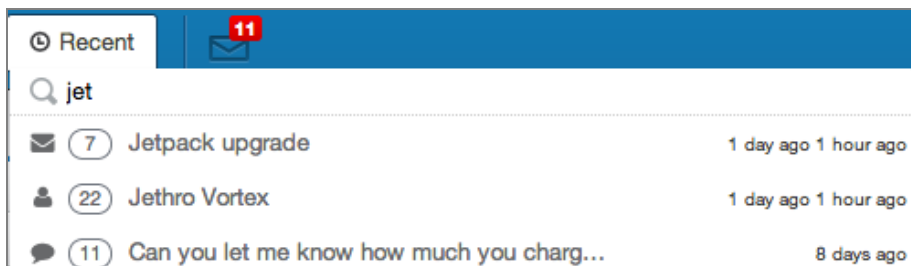
Use the **Create** button to create new [Tickets](#), Person (user) records, Organizations, Articles for your Knowledgebase, News posts, Download files, Feedback items and Tasks.

Note that if your browser window is less than a certain size, the Create button will be displayed as this icon to save space:



The Recent button

Use the **Recent** button to get back to items you have viewed recently. You can type to filter matching items.



Note that if your browser window is less than a certain size, the Recent button will be displayed as this icon to save space:



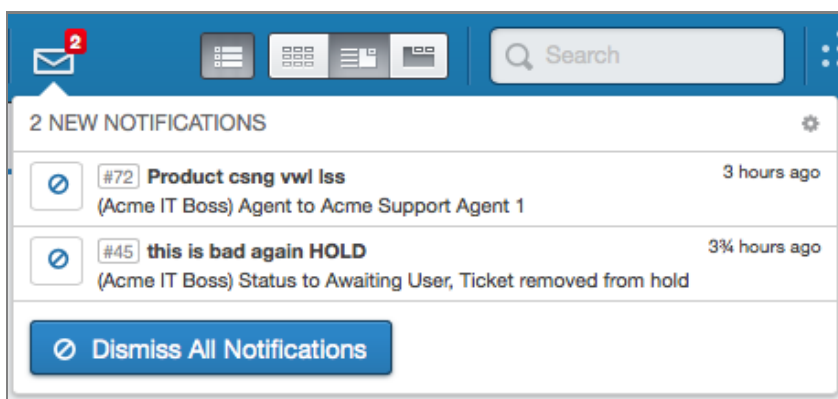
Notifications

This mail icon shows a count of your **browser notifications**.



You can customize which events create a notification here using your account preferences.

Click the icon to see event details.



Click **Dismiss All Notifications** to clear all notifications.

Toggling panes

These controls let you show and hide the different agent interface panes.



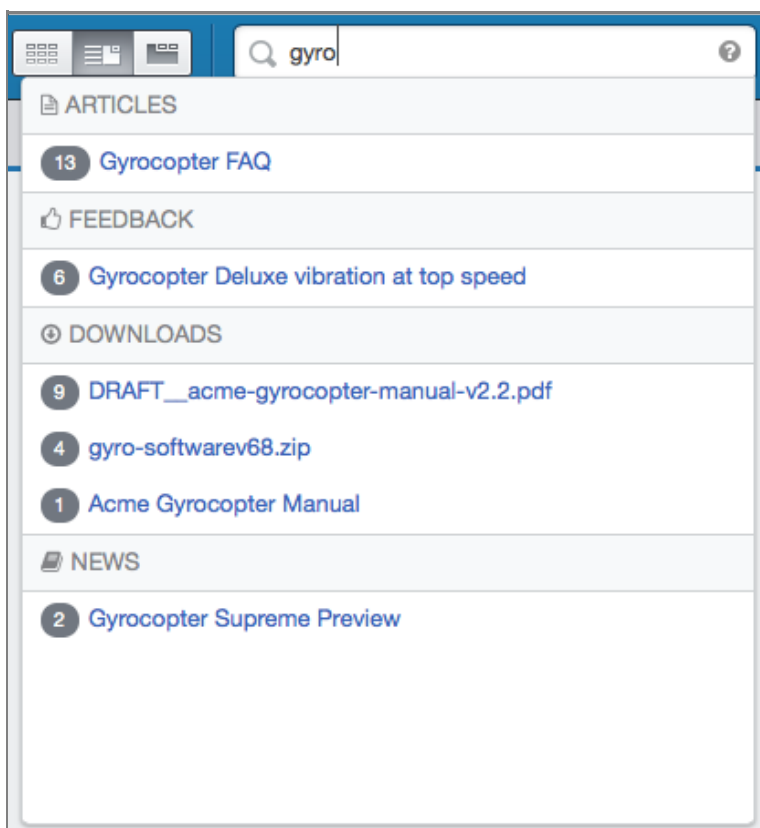
This can be useful if you are working on a relatively small screen, or if you just want to focus on a task in one or two panes.

The left control toggles the filter pane on and off; the three controls on the right let you select different combinations of the list and contents pane.

Quick search bar

This lets you search for items by:

- ID
- Ref code (tickets)
- Subject (tickets)
- Name (users/organizations)
- Email address (tickets/users/organizations)
- Title (articles/news/downloads/feedback)
- Labels



If you need a more advanced search, you can search from the filter pane.

3. Tickets

The **Tickets app** is used to manage and reply to tickets. Each ticket denotes a user issue that your helpdesk needs to deal with.

DeskPRO tracks what is happening with a ticket using its [status](#).

The ticket's status can be updated by agents or by automatic processes (**triggers** and **escalations**) set up by your admins.

DeskPRO also has features to help you prioritize tickets. You can track [service level agreements](#), and assigning tickets [urgency](#) and [priority](#) levels.

You can work efficiently with tickets using [macros](#) to apply a series of actions to a ticket, and [mass actions](#) to work on several tickets at once.

3.1. Ticket properties

When you open an individual ticket in the content pane, you can see the information DeskPRO stores about the ticket.

The screenshot shows a ticket interface with various fields and tabs. Annotations with arrows point to specific elements:

- Department**: Points to the 'Support Dept.' dropdown.
- User**: Points to the user profile 'Susan Expert (susan@example.com)'.
- User organization**: Points to the organization 'DreadCo'.
- Flag**: Points to the 'Awaiting Agent' status dropdown.
- Status**: Points to the '3' urgency indicator.
- Urgency**: Points to the 'Urgency' dropdown.
- Click icon to edit ticket properties**: Points to a gear icon in the top right of the 'PROPERTIES' tab.
- Ticket action buttons**: Points to the 'Lock', 'Merge', 'Macros', 'Remove', and 'Actions' buttons.
- Ticket history**: Points to the 'FULL LOG' tab in the 'MESSAGES' section.

The 'PROPERTIES' tab is active, showing the following fields:

- Language: Spanish
- Category: Regulator
- Priority: Routine
- Product: Catapult
- Workflow: Triage
- Labels: Add a label

The 'MESSAGES' section shows a reply from 'Susan' and a log of updates, including a priority change from 'None' to 'Routine'.

The fields you see will vary depending on your DeskPRO configuration.

Click the  at the top right of the **Properties** tab to see all available fields, including custom fields for your helpdesk.

The screenshot shows the 'PROPERTIES' tab of a ticket in DeskPRO. The form contains the following fields:

- Agent:** A dropdown menu showing 'Acme Support Agent 1' with a small icon to the left.
- Team:** A dropdown menu showing '2nd'.
- Language:** A dropdown menu showing 'English' with a small flag icon to the left.
- Category:** A dropdown menu showing 'Reseller'.
- Priority:** A dropdown menu showing 'Routine'.
- Product:** A dropdown menu showing 'None'.
- Workflow:** A dropdown menu showing 'None'.
- Flammability (custom):** Two radio buttons labeled 'Flammable' and 'Inflammable', both of which are currently unselected.
- Labels:** A text input field with the placeholder text 'Add a label'.

Ticket history

At the bottom of a ticket as you view it in the content pane is the ticket history. You can use the tabs to see:

- the history of **messages** connected with this ticket - emails to and from the user, and internal agent notes
- a **full log** of all the actions that have been applied to the ticket by agents, users, or automatic processes
- details of **dates and times** associated with the ticket - when it was created, how long the user has been waiting, etc.

IDs and ref codes

Every ticket has a unique **ID** number. These are assigned in the order tickets are created.

You can find a ticket quickly by putting its ID into the quick search bar.



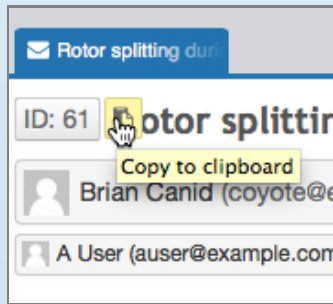
You may notice that other items in DeskPRO have their own ID numbers. For example, users and knowledgebase articles have IDs. IDs for different items are separate - for example, you can have a ticket with ID 17 and a user with ID 17.

Your admins may have set your helpdesk so that users see a unique **ref code** instead of the ID. The ref code is a string of numbers and letters (e.g. `WHPL-4979-OBV`). Click on the ticket's ID to see the ref code.

The advantage of this is that your users can't work out how many (or how few) tickets you have.

You can also use ref codes to search for tickets.

Put your mouse cursor over an ID or ref code and a yellow clipboard icon appears. Click the icon. The ID or ref is now copied to your clipboard.



Emails sent to users via DeskPRO will include either an ID or ref code for the relevant ticket. If you come across a stray email, searching for the ID/ref is a quick way to find the relevant ticket.

3.2. Ticket lifecycle

A ticket can be created in the following ways:

- 1 A user submits a ticket through the **web portal**
- 2 A user sends an email to a support address that is linked to DeskPRO.
- 3 An agent creates a ticket on behalf of a user, *either*
by using the agent interface *or*
by forwarding a user email to the support address.

A ticket is always associated with a user. You can change a ticket's user, but it's not possible to have a ticket without a user at all.

Deleting a user will also delete all their tickets.

A ticket may be [assigned](#) to an agent and/or a [team](#). This helps to make it clear who is responsible for a ticket.

The screenshot shows a ticket interface with the following elements:

- ID:** 68
- Title:** Problem report (phone call)
- User:** Suki User (suki66@example.com)
- Company:** DreadCo
- Action:** Add CC
- Status:** Awaiting Agent
- Support Dept.:** (dropdown menu)
- SLAS:** 5
- Tabs:** PROPERTIES, TASKS (0), SLAS, BILLING
- Agent:** Acme Support Agent 1
- Team:** 2nd Level Support

DeskPRO tracks the **status** of a ticket, which tells you whether it's the helpdesk or the user that needs to act next - or if there's no need to act at all, e.g. it was resolved, or it was created from a spam email.

A single ticket might be passed between several agents, and go through several different statuses, before it is resolved or deleted. You can view the details of a ticket's history when you open it in the content pane.

Status

The most important statuses for a ticket are:

- **awaiting agent** - this means the helpdesk needs to act on the ticket; often, this will mean replying to the user
- **awaiting user** - this means the helpdesk is awaiting a reply from the user
- **resolved** - the issue is resolved and communication has ended.

As an example, consider a user who reports an issue by email, creating a ticket with **awaiting agent** status.

An agent replies, perhaps requesting more information, and setting the ticket to **awaiting user** status.

The user's next message would set the status back to **awaiting agent** again.

Note that the user and agent aren't emailing each other directly - the user is emailing the DeskPRO **ticket address**, and the agent writes replies in the agent interface which are then emailed to the user.

The goal for most tickets will be to get them to resolved status.

Resolved tickets can be re-opened by agents (and possibly by some or all users; this depends on [usergroups](#)).

Other possible statuses are:

- awaiting validation
- on hold
- spam
- deleted

Awaiting validation

Depending on how your helpdesk is set up, new users may need to be **validated** before their tickets are shown in the main parts of the agent interface.

See the section on [new users](#) for more details.

On hold status

On hold status is a way to record that an agent needs to act on the ticket, but that you're waiting for something else to happen first. This often involves waiting for a third party.

For example, a user has raised a new ticket and you need to check something with one of your suppliers before you reply. You have emailed the supplier and you are waiting to hear back.

Leaving this ticket marked as **awaiting agent** isn't quite right, since that would mean that there's something you need to do to it, whereas in fact you just have to wait for the supplier. The solution is to put it on hold.

If you have tickets on hold, there will be a checkbox in the top part of the filter pane of the Tickets app - check it to view the tickets on hold, uncheck it to view awaiting agent tickets as usual.

AWAITING AGENT		☐ 3 ON HOLD
▶ My Tickets	2	
▶ Tickets I Follow	3	
▶ My Teams' Tickets	5	

See the section on [Holding tickets](#) for more detail.

Spam, deletion and purging

You may get tickets created as a result of spam emails or web robots posting junk messages into the forms on the web portal.

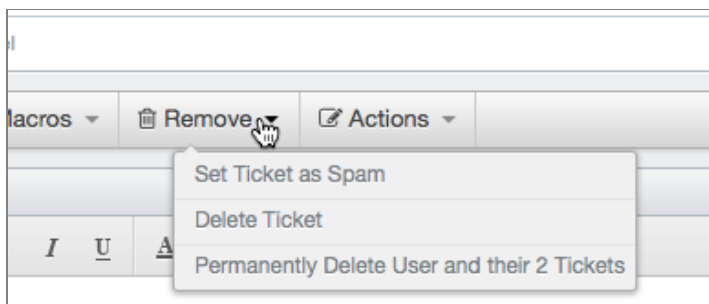
You can set the status of these tickets as **spam**.

DeskPRO does not have its own automatic spam filter, but your admins may use another spam filter system combined with DeskPRO features to mark suspected spam automatically.

Tickets set as spam can be seen in the **Spam** filter in the filter pane.

Tickets can also be **deleted**. They are then shown in the **Recycle Bin** in the filter pane.

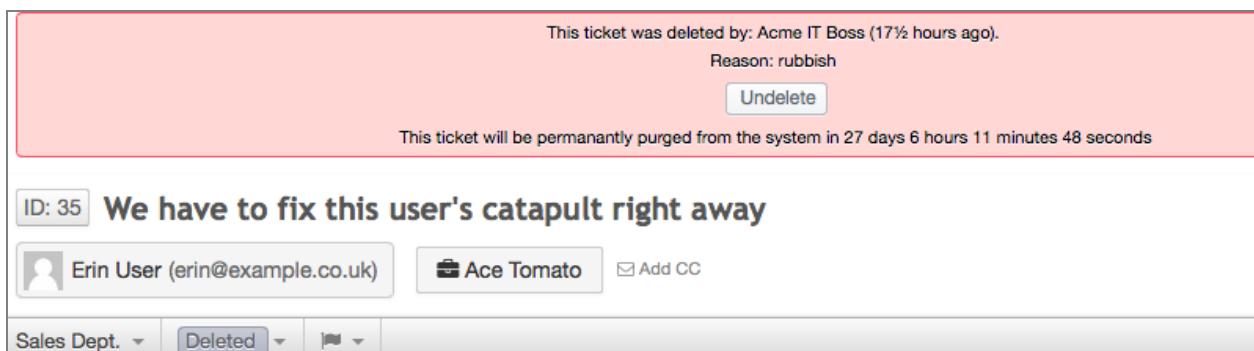
You can set a single ticket as spam or delete it using the **Remove** button.



You can use [mass actions](#) to spam or delete tickets in bulk.

Tickets in the Spam filter or the Recycle Bin will be **purged** - deleted permanently - after a certain amount of time. The time until purging is set by your admins. It can be different for deleted and spam tickets.

You can always undelete or unspam a ticket before it is purged.



Before you undelete a ticket, you need to correct any errors, such as missing fields - otherwise the undelete button won't work.

Assignment

A ticket can be assigned to an agent. This is useful to keep track of who is responsible for which ticket.

However, if a ticket is assigned to Agent A, that doesn't stop Agent B acting on it: Agent B can still reply to the ticket, mark it as spam, assign it to agent C, and so on.

On most helpdesks, newly created tickets will usually be unassigned. Unassigned means not assigned to an agent or a **team**.

By default, just replying to a ticket assigns it to you.

Teams

Instead of assigning a ticket to an individual agent, you can assign it to a **team**: a group of agents.

You would typically put agents who work closely together into the same team: for example, you might have a support team and a sales team.

An agent can be a member of more than one team.

Teams are useful because they let you bring a ticket to the attention of several agents. For example, suppose you find a ticket that is a request for a product demonstration; you know that someone from the sales team arranges those, but you don't know who exactly. You can assign it to the sales team, and perhaps they will then reassign it to an individual agent.

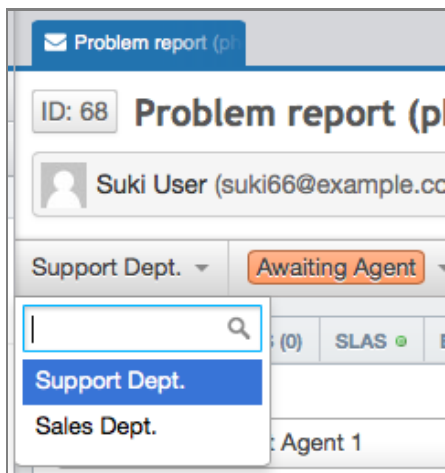
Note that a ticket can be assigned *both* to an individual agent *and* to a team. If a ticket is assigned to you individually, and you assign it to a team, it will still show up in your "My Tickets" filter, unless you clear the assignment to yourself.

You have the same permissions to modify a ticket that's assigned to your team as you would if it was assigned to you directly.

Departments

Departments are used to control the tickets that agents in different parts of your company can see.

A ticket can only be added to one department (or no department at all).



Agent accounts can be set so they do not have permission to view tickets in certain departments.

For example, your helpdesk could have a Research department and a Customer Service department. You might not be able to see Research tickets; another agent might not be able to see Customer Service tickets, and a third agent might be able to see tickets in both. (Everybody can still see tickets that don't have a department set, subject to their other permissions).

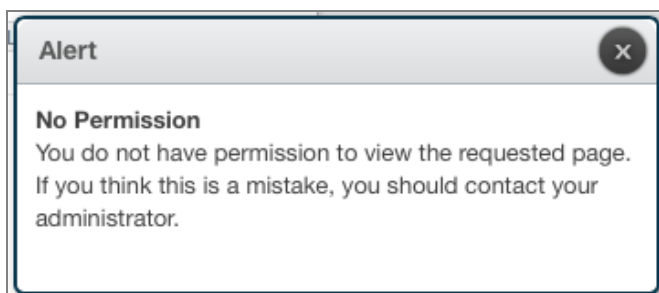
The advantage of this is that you only have to sort through the tickets that are relevant to your particular role.

However, **assignment and following always overrule departments**

If you're not normally allowed to see Research department tickets, but one is assigned to you or your team, you can then see it. And if a ticket you are following is then set as a Research ticket, you will still be able to see it.

You may be allowed to assign a ticket to a department that you don't have permission to view. It depends on your permissions, which are set by your admins.

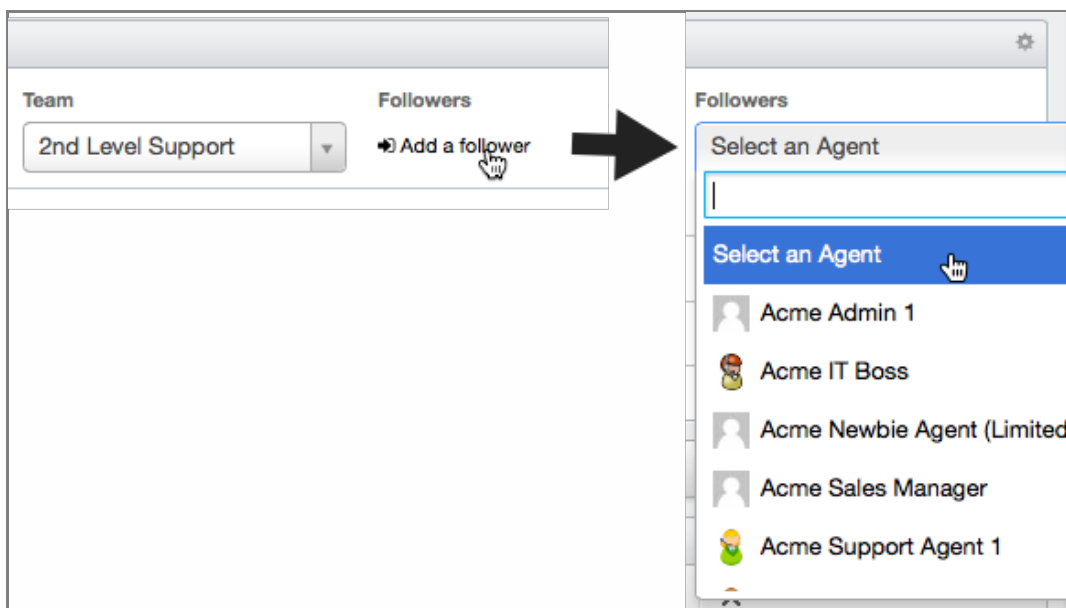
In the example above, if you found a useful customer suggestion among the Customer Service tickets, your account might let you assign it to the Research department. If you tried to access the ticket afterwards, you would see a **No Permission** error message.



A final point to bear in mind is that your helpdesk can be customized so that different departments have different forms for creating a ticket. This customization can be done separately for users and for agents. You may find that the fields which are visible or mandatory when you're creating a ticket vary between departments.

Following tickets

Following is a way to keep track of a ticket without it being assigned to you.



You can add yourself as a follower if you want to keep an eye on a ticket. If you follow a ticket:

- you can get [notifications](#) about it (depending on your account preferences)
- it shows up in the "Tickets I Follow" filter whenever it has **awaiting agent** status
- you will be able to see it even if it is set to a department you don't have permission to view

Agents can also add each other as followers. For example, suppose you are training an agent who's not ready to answer tickets; you don't want to assign them tickets, but you could add them as a follower to a ticket that you want them to follow through the system.

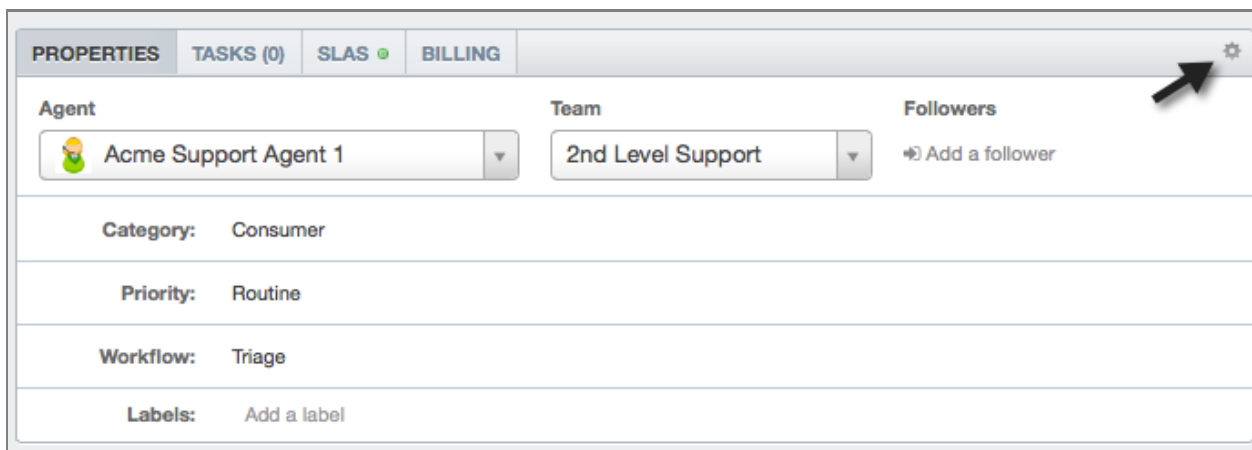
The permissions you have as a follower of a ticket are separate from the permissions you have if it's assigned to you/your team. For example, your helpdesk may be set up so that you can modify tickets you're assigned, but not tickets you are following.

Workflows

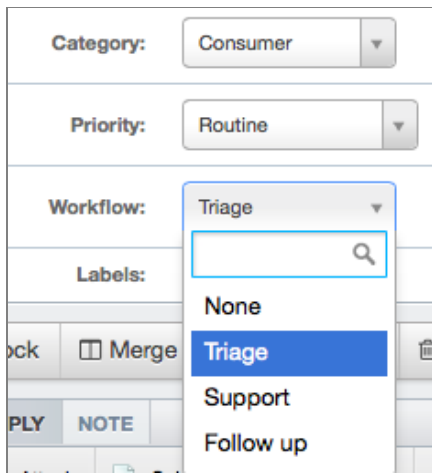
Workflow is an optional field used for tracking the progress of a ticket through your helpdesk, according to your company's procedures.

Since it describes your internal processes, the workflow field is never visible to users.

Workflow is set in the ticket **Properties** tab.



Click the  icon at the top right to edit properties.



The screenshot shows a ticket form with the following fields and values:

- Category: Consumer
- Priority: Routine
- Workflow: Triage (dropdown menu is open, showing options: None, Triage, Support, Follow up)
- Labels: (empty)
- Buttons: Lock, Merge, Reply, Note

If your helpdesk uses workflow, the different stages are defined by your admins. You may be required to set the workflow yourself, or it could change automatically.

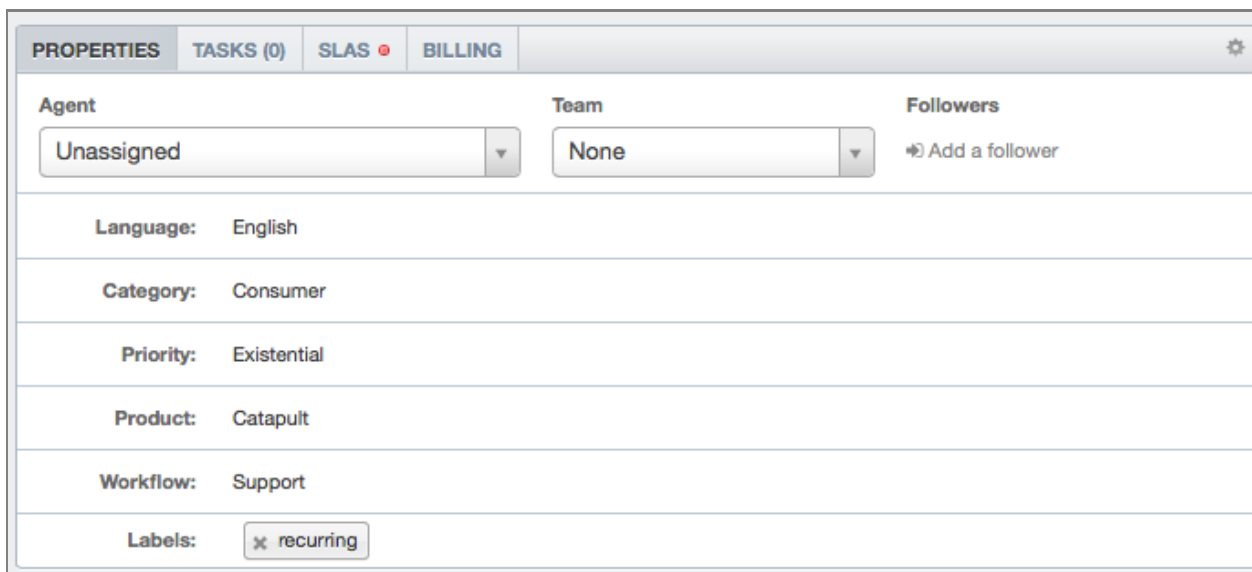
Here's an example of how workflow could be used:

- 1 every new ticket has the workflow field set to "Triage", to show that a first-line agent needs to assess which team needs to deal with it and how serious it is
- 2 once it is assigned to a team, the workflow field is set to "Support"
- 3 once the agent thinks they have dealt with the ticket, the workflow field is set to "Follow Up" and a manager reviews their work before marking the ticket resolved.

3.3. Ticket fields

Aside from core information like subject, status and user, DeskPRO stores more **fields** giving you extra information about a ticket.

View them in the ticket **Properties** tab.



The screenshot shows the 'PROPERTIES' tab of a ticket in DeskPRO. The interface includes tabs for 'PROPERTIES', 'TASKS (0)', 'SLAS', and 'BILLING'. The 'PROPERTIES' tab is active, displaying several fields: 'Agent' (Unassigned), 'Team' (None), 'Followers' (Add a follower), 'Language' (English), 'Category' (Consumer), 'Priority' (Existential), 'Product' (Catapult), 'Workflow' (Support), and 'Labels' (x recurring). A gear icon for settings is located in the top right corner of the tab area.

You can edit them by clicking the  icon at the top right.

Some built-in ticket fields are optional, and may not be set up on your helpdesk.

The optional **Language** field records what language the ticket is in.

Categories

The **Category** field may not be enabled. If your helpdesk uses it, the values you can choose from are set by your admins.

This field is used to divide tickets into categories that are useful to your company.

If it's enabled, users can choose a category when submitting a ticket from the web portal.

Here are some examples of how different helpdesks could use categories:

- Software/Hardware
- Question/Complaint/Praise
- Consumer/Professional/Reseller
- Windows/Mac/Linux

Products

The **Product** field may not be enabled. It is used to track different products your company makes or supports.

If your helpdesk uses it, the values you can choose from will be products you help people with.

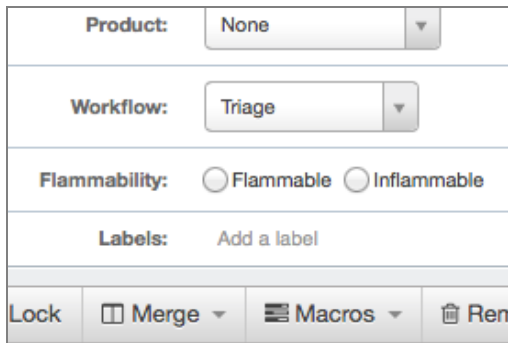
If it's enabled, users can select a product when submitting a ticket from the web portal.

Custom fields

Your admins can also add custom fields to track extra information about tickets.

These custom fields will have a name chosen by your admins. Custom fields can either be visible to users (for example on the web portal), or for agents only.

If you see a ticket field at the bottom of the **Properties** section that isn't mentioned in this manual, it's probably a custom field.



The screenshot shows a ticket form with the following fields and controls:

- Product:** A dropdown menu with "None" selected.
- Workflow:** A dropdown menu with "Triage" selected.
- Flammability:** Two radio buttons labeled "Flammable" and "Inflammable".
- Labels:** A text input field with the placeholder "Add a label".
- Bottom Bar:** A row of controls including a "Lock" button, a "Merge" button with a dropdown arrow, a "Macros" button with a dropdown arrow, and a "Remove" button with a trash icon.

The kind of input a custom field can take varies:

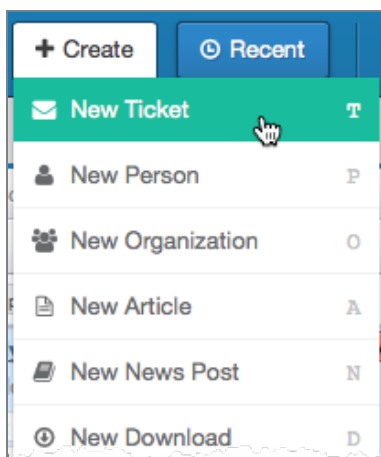
- Text - a simple one-line text box.
- Textarea - a multi-line text box that can be used for longer entries like descriptions or notes.
- Choice - a set of predefined options presented as a drop-down select menu, radio buttons or checkboxes.
- Toggle (on/off) - a single checkbox that you can check or uncheck.
- Date - lets you select a date using a calendar widget.
- Display - this is used for display purposes only.
- Hidden - this stores information from the user's browser; the user won't see it on the portal, but the information stored can be viewed and edited by agents

3.4. Creating a ticket

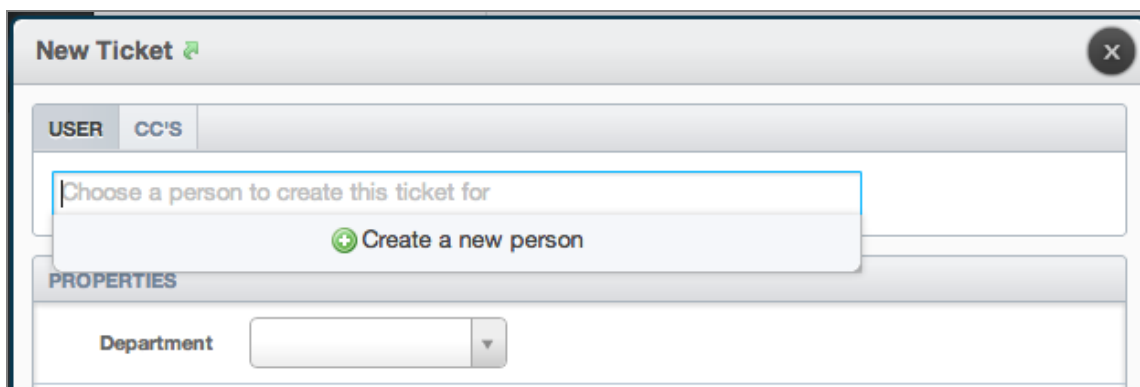
In most helpdesks, users will usually create their own tickets by sending an email or using the Contact Us form on your web portal.

However, you may need to create a ticket on behalf of a user - for example, if they are telling you about the issue over the phone or in person.

You can create a new ticket from the **Create button** in the toolbar at the top of the agent interface.



The new ticket must be associated with a user, so you must either choose a user or create one.



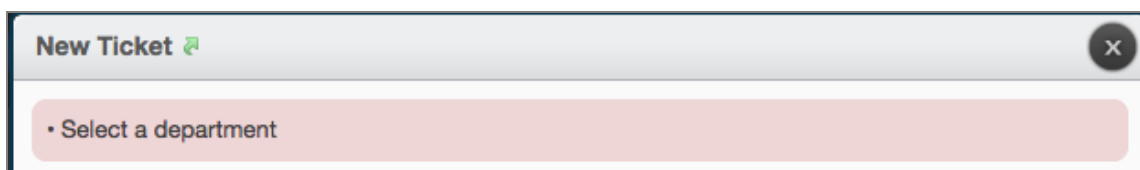
Begin typing either a name or an email address in the **Choose a person to create this ticket for** text area. DeskPRO will show you matching records as you type.

Alternatively, click **Create a new person** to make a new user record. You will need to provide the user's email address and name.

Field validation

Depending on your helpdesk configuration, it may be compulsory to select or enter values for some of the ticket fields.

For example, if your helpdesk has [departments](#), you have to specify one:



When you have selected the fields, you can assign the ticket to an agent or team.

Note that when an agent creates a ticket, the fields which are compulsory may differ from when a user creates a ticket.

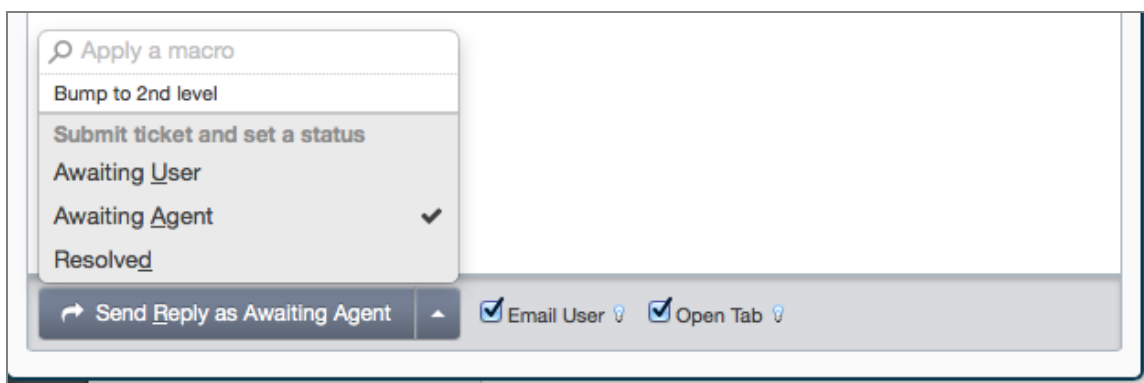
The requirements for fields can also be different between departments.

New ticket message

When you create a ticket, you must write a message, which would usually include a description of the problem.

Your options when sending the message are as follows:

- set the status of the new ticket as:
 - **awaiting user** (default)
 - **awaiting agent** or
 - **resolved**
- select whether or not to email the message to the user with the **Email User** checkbox
- select whether or not to open the new ticket in a tab in the content pane straight away with the **Open Tab** checkbox.



For example, suppose your job is to take down the content of a phone call and pass it to the right part of your company. You could write a summary of the issue for the other agents, uncheck **Email User**, assign it to the appropriate agent/team, and then choose **Send Reply as Awaiting Agent**

On the other hand, your job might be to research the issue and then send help information to the user by email. In that case, you might write a message addressed to the user, summarizing the problem and suggesting a fix. It would make sense to leave **Email User** selected, assign the ticket to yourself, and **Send Reply as Awaiting User**.

If you were able to resolve the user's issue on the phone, you would probably want to **Send Reply as Resolved**.

See [Replying to a ticket](#) for more details about ticket messages.

Forwarding an email to create a ticket

There's another way you can create a ticket on behalf of a user: you can forward a user email to an email address configured to automatically create tickets.

This feature is convenient if a user has emailed a support request to the wrong place.

DeskPRO is smart enough to make a ticket from the user's original message and associate it with the user, even though it came from your address.

The text of the forwarded email appears as the first message on the ticket. If you write something above the forwarded text, that appears as a message from you.

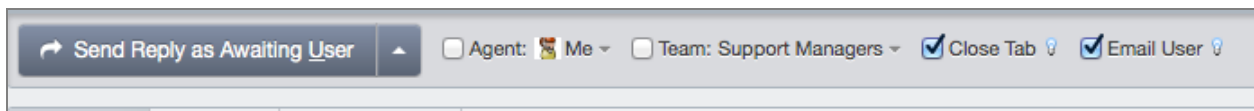
The ticket is created as unassigned, but you will be added to the ticket as a follower.

If the original message had addresses in the email cc: field, they will be added to the [CC](#) field for the new ticket.

Messages that have been forwarded more than once might confuse DeskPRO.

3.5. Replying to a ticket

When you're viewing an individual ticket, you can send a **message** to the user in the reply area.



By default, when you press the **Send Reply as...** button, your message is emailed to the user's primary address.

Use the pull-down menu at the right of the **Send Reply as...** button to select what the status of the ticket should be after you send the message:

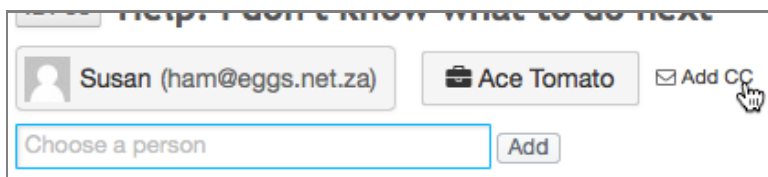
- **Send Reply as Awaiting User**(default) - if you need to hear back from the user before progressing
- **Send Reply as Awaiting Agent** - if an agent needs to act further on this ticket
- **Send Reply as Resolved** - if the user's issue is resolved and no more communication is needed

You can uncheck the **Email User** checkbox if you don't want this message to be sent to the user - for example, if the message is a summary of a phone conversation you had with the user.

Messages should be used for recording communication with the user - if you want to leave internal messages for other agents, use [notes](#) instead.

Using ticket CC to copy in users

Adding a user to the ticket **CC** field means they will be copied in on ticket email messages, even though they are not the main user associated with the ticket.



You must enter the exact email address for the person.

CCs enable multiple users to track the progress of the ticket.

Note that the CC users will only be copied in on *outgoing* emails *from* DeskPRO; the main user associated with the ticket must use "Reply All" from their email software for the CCed users to see their messages.

Another way to allow multiple users to track the progress of a ticket is using [organization managers](#).

You cannot add an agent as a CC; instead, add agents as [followers](#).

Message attachments

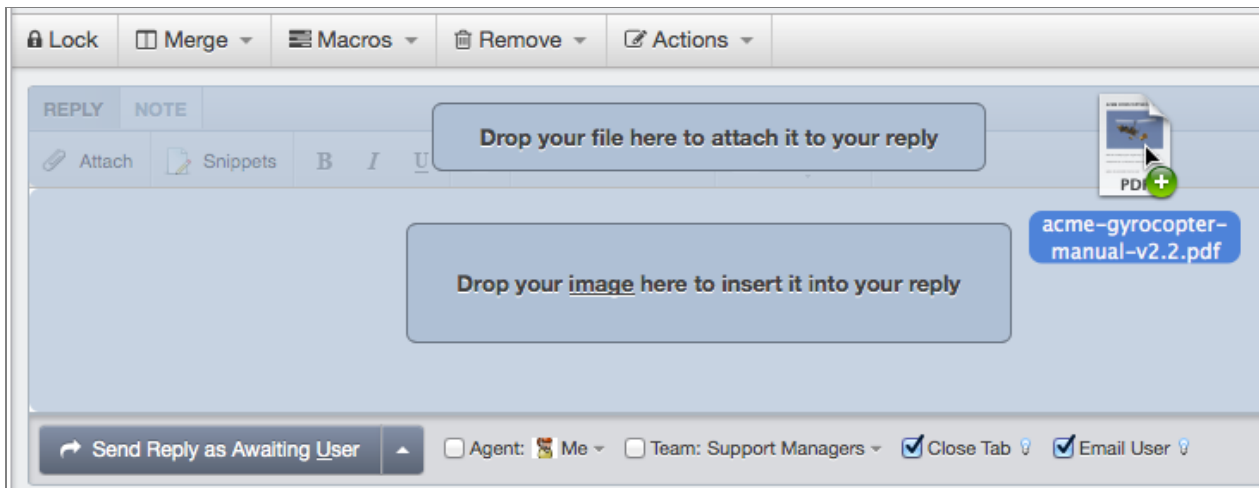
You can attach a file to your message, for example a screenshot, updated software drivers, or an electronic manual.

Your admins may set limits on the type and size of files you are allowed to attach. Remember that the user's email system may reject large files (the limit varies, but is typically 5MB-50MB), or files that look like they might be harmful, like `.exe` files.



Click the **Attach** button to select a file from your computer.

You can also drag and drop a file onto the bar where the **Attach** button is.



You can use drag and drop to attach multiple files to a message at the same time.

Quick message screenshots with paste or drag and drop

You can quickly add screenshots or other images to the body of your message by **pasting** them from your clipboard.

If you have software on your computer that can save a screenshot directly to the clipboard with a keyboard shortcut, then you only need to press CTRL-V (Mac: CMD-V) in the reply box to upload the image. Taking and adding a screenshot to your ticket reply can be done in two key presses.

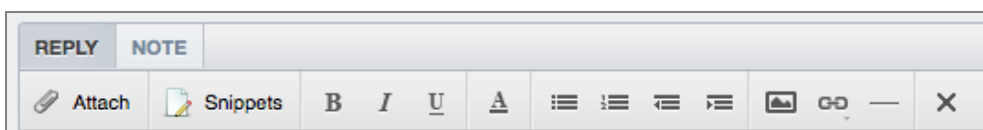
Pasting screenshots only works correctly on recent versions of Firefox and Chrome browsers.

For Windows users, we recommend the free software [Greenshot](#) for taking screenshots.

You can also drag and drop an image file into the reply box.

Ticket message formatting

You can apply rich text formatting to your message using the controls above the text area. If you've used standard word-processing software before, you should find them familiar.



The text style buttons are:

- **B** for **bold**
- *I* for *italics*
- U for underlined text
- **A** for colored text (select the color after you click on it)

You can use these buttons in two ways:

- 1 Toggle: without any text selected, click a button to apply the relevant style to everything you type from that point on. Click it again to stop.
- 2 Paint: select some text, then click a button to apply the relevant style to the selection. Click it again with the same selection to remove that style.

You can toggle bold with the keyboard shortcut **Ctrl-B** and italics with **Ctrl-I** .

To the right of the text styling controls are buttons which apply formatting to your current paragraph, or all paragraphs under the selection area:

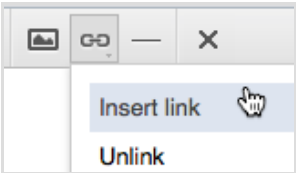
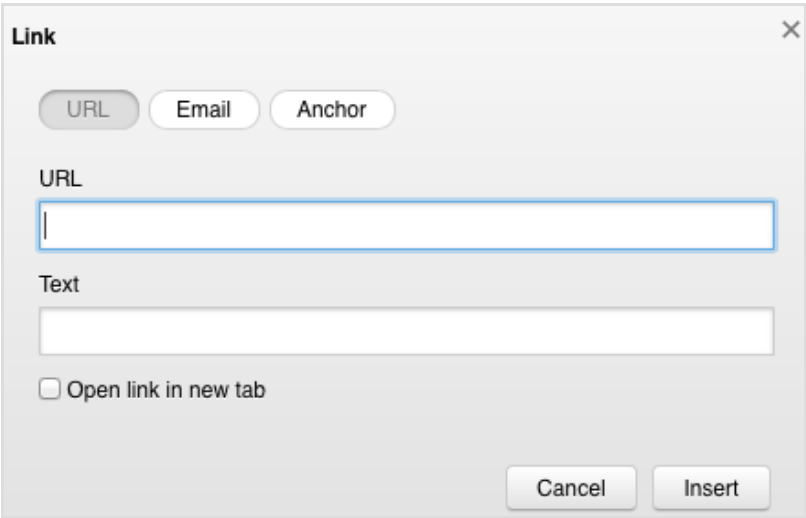
-  bullet list
-  numbered list
-  shift paragraph left
-  shift paragraph right

The  button enables you to insert an image into the body of the message. You can either upload an image file from your desktop, or provide the web address of an image file.

The  button enables you to insert a clickable web link or email address into your message.

Using links in messages

To insert a clickable link to a website or file server:

- 1 Optionally, highlight some text you want to turn into a link.
- 2 Click the  icon, then click **Insert link**.

- 3 The default **URL** link type is used for inserting a web link.

- 4 Enter the full address in the URL field e.g.
`http://www.yourcompany.com/troubleshooting` .
- 5 Enter the text for the link in the Text field e.g. "our troubleshooting guide" - if you highlighted some existing text, it will appear here.
- 6 Check the **Open link in a new tab** box if you want the link to open in a new tab when the user clicks it. (This will usually happen anyway, depending on how they read their email).

The result is the link "[our troubleshooting guide](http://www.yourcompany.com/troubleshooting)," which goes to `http://www.yourcompany.com/troubleshooting` .

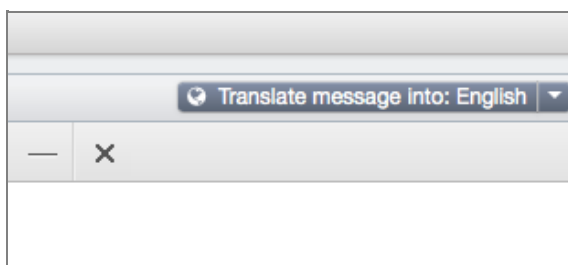
To insert a clickable email address that will open a new email in the user's email client:

- 1 Optionally, highlight some text you want to turn into an email link.
- 2 Click the  and click **Insert link**.
- 3 Select the **Email** link type.
- 4 Enter the email address in the Email field e.g.
- 5 Enter the text for the link in the Text field e.g. "email our sales team".

To remove a link, highlight it, press the  button and click **Unlink**.

Automatic translation plugin

If your admins have installed the Microsoft Translator plugin, you will see a control to translate the message content between languages.



Note that this is automatic translation, and quality of results can vary. Be cautious when sending automatically translated replies in a language you don't understand.

Ticket notes

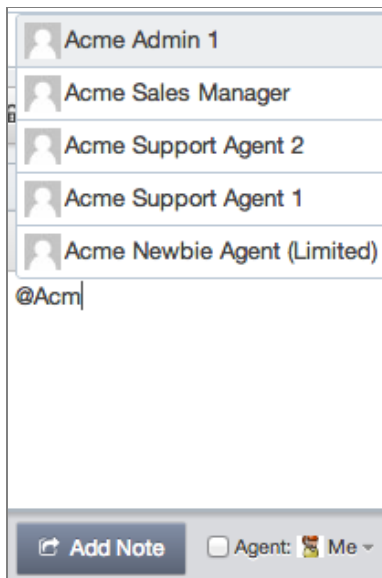
Notes are messages intended for viewing only by other agents. They show up in the message history as usual, but are not sent to the user.

Click the **Note** tab to enter a note. [Message formatting](#) works as it does when you're sending a user message.

Users can see note content in some circumstances - for example, if an agent replies to a note with a normal message - so don't put anything in a note that you wouldn't want the user to see!

@mentions

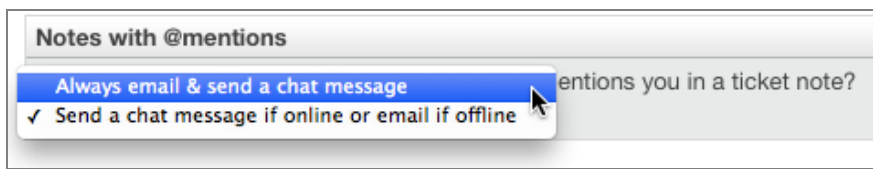
You can quickly alert another agent that you've written a note you want them to see using **@mentions**. Type @ and then start typing the agent's name - you'll see a list of matching suggestions.



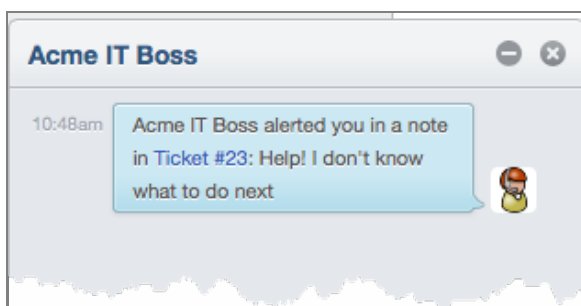
Click on the agent you want to notify.

Enter the rest of your note. When you click **Add Note**, the agent you mentioned will be notified that you mentioned them.

How you are notified when somebody @mentions you depends on your **Notes with @mentions** preferences setting.



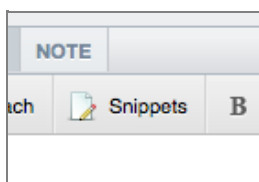
Note that you will receive the @mention chat notifications even if you are not logged into *user* chat.



Snippets

Snippets are a way to avoid typing the same thing into messages over and over again.

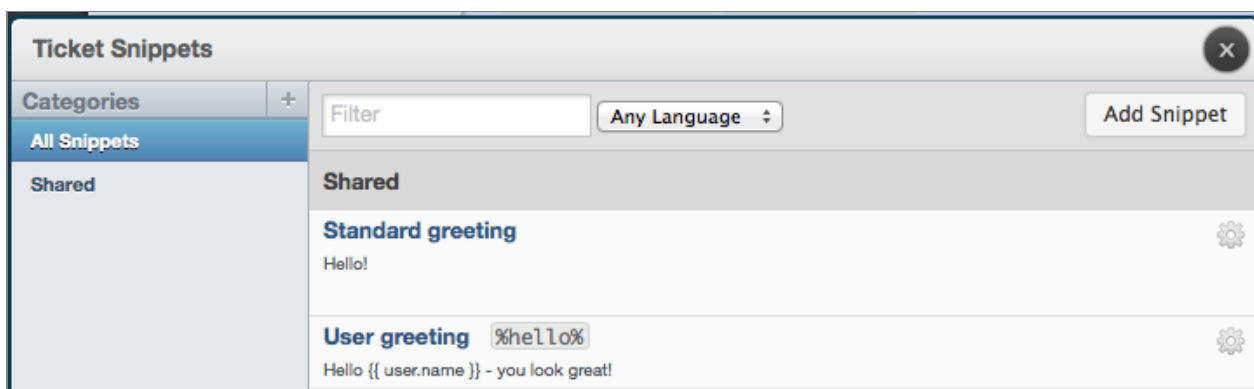
You can use a snippet to automatically insert a piece of rich text, including images.



To set up a snippet:

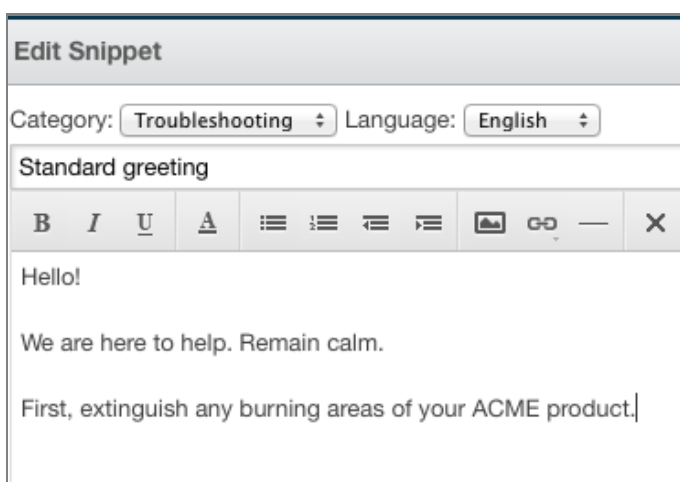
Click the **Snippets** button. You may be prompted to create a category - if so, enter "Personal" and leave the "Category can be used by" option set as "Just me".

From the resulting **Ticket Snippets** window, click **Add Snippet**.



In the **Edit Snippet** window, enter a title for the snippet. This is to describe what the snippet does; it will not change the title of a ticket.

Enter and format the snippet content. For example, perhaps you want to be able to quickly enter your standard greeting.



Click **Save** in the **Edit Snippet** window.

Now in the **Ticket Snippets** window, click the title of your new snippet and it will be inserted into your message at the cursor.

You can edit the content that a snippet will insert by clicking the gear icon next to its title.

Note that you don't need to use a snippet to add a personal signature to your messages - use the **Ticket Signature** setting in **Preferences**.

Snippet categories and sharing

You can organize your snippets into categories. Create a new category with the + button in the Categories pane of the Ticket Snippets window.

If you choose to create a **Shared** category, any snippets in that category will be available to all agents.

This is useful for standardizing your communication. For example, if you want agents to use a standard greeting, you can save it as a shared snippet. Then all agents can insert the exact same greeting.

Another use for snippets is to provide standardized "canned answers" to common problems.

Snippet shortcuts

There's a quicker way to insert a snippet, using a **shortcut code** that you type into a message.

For example, you can set it up so that your standard greeting is inserted whenever you type `%hello%`. Shortcut codes always begin and end with `%`.

Open the **Ticket Snippets** window and edit a snippet with the gear icon.

You can enter a shortcut code for the snippet at the lower left (you don't need to type in the symbols).

Shortcut Code: % Enter a shortcut %

Snippet variables

What if the content you want to enter with a snippet varies from ticket to ticket? For example, what if you want your standard greeting snippet to mention the user by name?

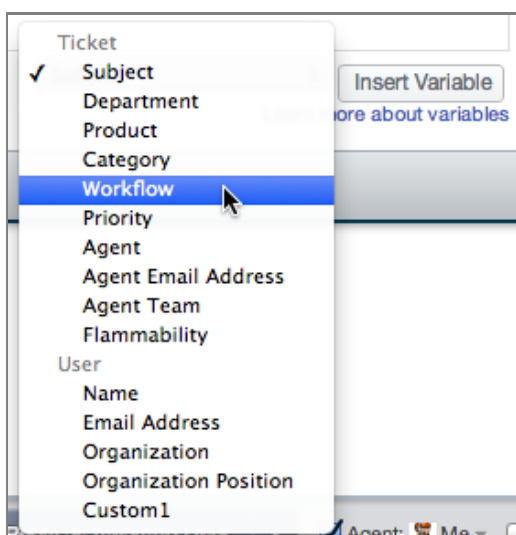
You can automatically insert information into your message using **variables**.

For example, to make a snippet which addresses the user by name, you can add the following to the snippet content:

```
Hello {{ ticket.person.display_name }}
```

When you paste the snippet into a message, the variable is replaced by the user's actual name.

The easiest way to insert variables is to select them from the list at the lower right of the **Ticket Snippets** window, then click **Insert Variable**.



The following variables are available.

Snippet variable	Value inserted
{{ ticket.product.title }}	current product of ticket
{{ ticket.category.title }}	current category of ticket
{{ ticket.workflow.title }}	current workflow stage of ticket
{{ ticket.priority.title }}	current priority of ticket
{{ ticket.id }}	ticket ID number
{{ ticket.ref }}	ticket ref code
{{ ticket.fieldX }}	display a custom ticket field; replace X with field ID *
{{ ticket.date_created }}	time and date ticket was created e.g. 2014-03-14 11:38:17
{{ ticket.agent.display_name }}	the name of currently assigned agent (or override name if set)

{{ ticket.person.display_name }}	user's name
{{ ticket.person.fieldX }}	display a custom user field; replace X with field ID *

* you can find out the ID for custom fields by using the **insert variable** function or asking your admins

Replying to a user by email

When you receive an email notification about a message from a user, you can reply to it in your email client, rather than in the agent interface. DeskPRO will process your message as a reply to the user.

You must make sure to type your reply above the `=== REPLY ABOVE ===` line.

Email action codes

DeskPRO allows agents to perform actions via the use of special action codes. Action codes must be placed at the top of the email message and all follow the format:

#codename *option*

where **codename** is the name of a code, and ***option*** is an optional parameter used to perform an action.

For example, if you reply to a user by email and put `#status resolved` at the top, the relevant ticket will be set as resolved.

You can enter as many codes in one email as you want so long as they are at the very top of the email. DeskPRO strips out codes when it sends email, so they are not seen by the user.

Code	Description	Example
#status <i>option</i>	Sets the ticket status. Available options: ▪ <i>agent</i> ▪ <i>user</i> ▪ <i>resolved</i> ▪ <i>hold</i>	<code>#status resolved</code>
#awaiting-agent	Shortcut for <code>#status agent</code>	<code>#awaiting-agent</code>
#awaiting-user	Shortcut for <code>#status user</code>	<code>#awaiting-user</code>
#resolved	Shortcut for <code>#status resolved</code>	<code>#resolved</code>
#hold	Shortcut for <code>#status hold</code>	<code>#hold</code>
#unhold	Removes hold status on a ticket and sets status to awaiting agent	<code>#unhold</code>
#note or #is-note	Sets the current reply to be an agent note rather than a ticket reply	<code>#is-note</code>

#assign <i>option</i> or #agent <i>option</i>	Assigns the ticket to agent specified. Option can be: - Agent email address - Full agent name (e.g., "john doe")	#assign john@example.com #assign john doe
#team <i>option</i> or #assign-team <i>option</i>	Assigns the ticket to the team specified	#team support
#user <i>option</i>	Used only if an agent is sending a new ticket to the helpdesk, this sets the ticket user by email address	#user user@example.com
#label <i>option</i> or #labels <i>option</i>	Adds labels to the ticket. Provide labels as a comma-separated list	#label bug, important
#dep <i>option</i> or #department <i>option</i>	Sets the department	#dep support
#cat <i>option</i> or #category <i>option</i>	Sets the ticket category	#cat consumer
#prod <i>option</i> or #product <i>option</i>	Sets the product	#prod gyrocopter
#pri <i>option</i> or #priority <i>option</i>	Sets the priority	#pri urgent
#field <i>value</i>	Sets any custom field. #field is the name of the custom field with spaces removed or turned into dashes, and value is the value to set.	#license-id 12345 #discount yes
#noreply	Prevents a message from being added to the ticket. Use this when you want to use other action codes but don't want to add an actual reply to the ticket.	#noreply

When DeskPRO is searching for values based on a string title or name (for example, a category name or an agent name), all comparisons are case-insensitive and ignore white space and punctuation. Here are a few examples:

- "Booker Dean-DeWitt" is matched as `bookerdeandewitt`
- "License ID" is matched as `licenseid`
- "Product Name (Full)" is matched as `productnamefull`

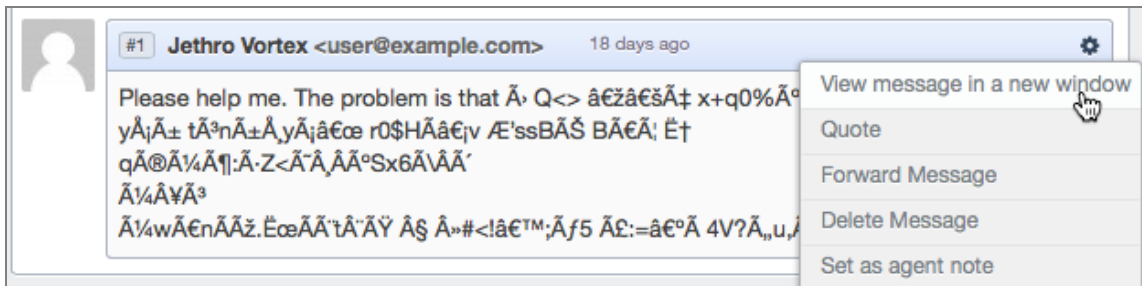
Your **option** values are treated the same way. So `#assign Booker dean dewitt` or `#assign booker dean de-WITT` would both match the name "Booker Dean-DeWitt".

Viewing raw email source

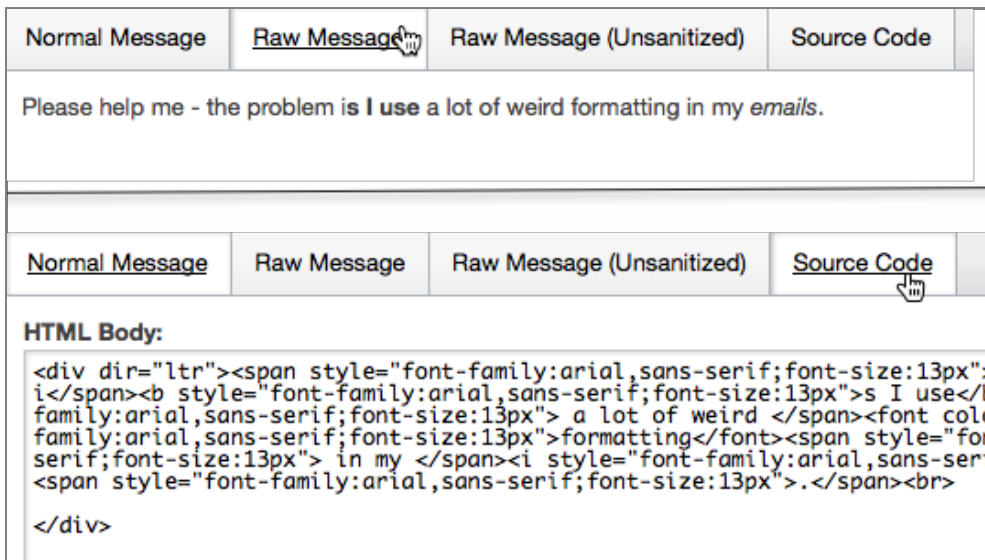
Sometimes it is useful to view the raw message source for a ticket message that arrived via email.

Load the ticket in the agent interface and find the message you want to view.

Click on the gear icon in the top-right corner of the message to bring up the context menu, then click **View message in a new window**.



In the window that opens, click on the **Raw Message** tab or the **Source Code** tab.



3.6. Ticket actions

Aside from the core reply and assignment functions, there are various other actions you can apply to tickets.

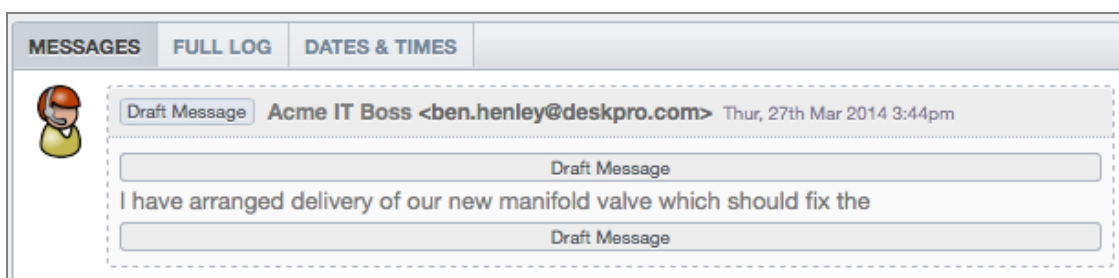
All the actions below are available from the buttons above the reply area.



Locking tickets

Confusion about who is working on a ticket is usually prevented by:

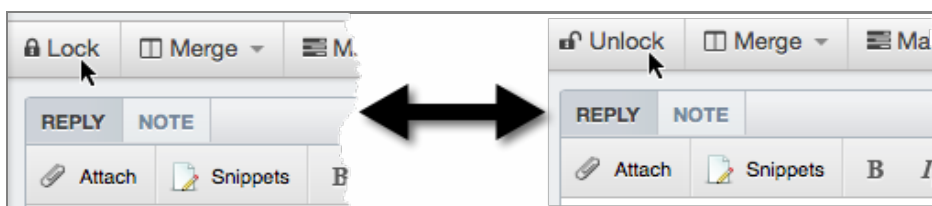
- 1 agent assignment
- 2 the live draft messages you see if another agent is replying to a ticket.



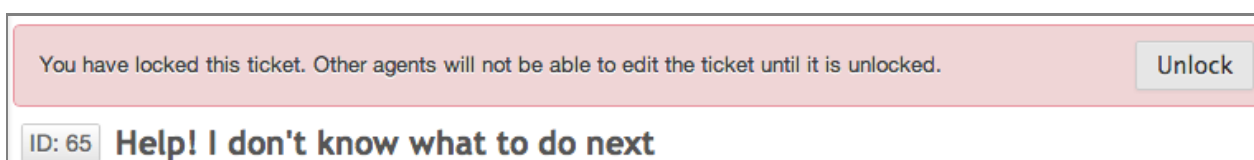
Sometimes you may want to make clear to other agents that you're working on a ticket and prevent them from editing it - for example, if you are researching the issue.

Locking the ticket achieves that.

The **Lock** button is above the reply area when you view a ticket in the content pane.



You can unlock the ticket from the **Lock** button or at the top of this tab.



The lock will automatically be removed after a period of time set by your admins (one hour is the default). This is to stop tickets being left locked for too long.

DeskPRO can also be set to automatically lock a ticket while an agent is viewing it.

Merging tickets

Sometimes you will end up with two tickets about the same issue - for example, two different users in the same organization report the same thing, or a user emails about the same issue from two different email addresses.

You can quickly **merge** two tickets together, combining their details to make one ticket.

When tickets merge, some properties will be overwritten. For example, a ticket can only have one subject, so the merged ticket can keep the subject from only one of the original tickets.

You can pick which ticket will overwrite the other ticket's properties.

If a value for a property is only set in one ticket, then it is kept in the merged ticket, regardless of which ticket you pick. For example, if one ticket is assigned to an agent team A, and the other ticket isn't assigned to any team, the new ticket will always be assigned to agent team A.

If the tickets have different users, the other user will be added as a **CC** to the new ticket.

The labels from both tickets will be applied to the new ticket.

The **Merge** button is above the reply area when you view a ticket in the content pane.

- 1 Open one of the tickets in the content pane.
- 2 Click the **Merge** button.
- 3 You are shown a list of the user's tickets and open tickets. If you want to merge with a different ticket, click **Search**, then enter a ticket ID. It may take a second or two to show the matching ticket.
- 4 Select the ticket you wish to merge with.
- 5 The **Merge Ticket** window opens. Click **Switch** to pick which ticket's properties to keep where there's a conflict. The values shown in red will be overwritten.

Merge Ticket

Find ticket

	Keep This	Switch	Merge This
ID	8		9
SUBJECT	Trouble booting up drilling machine		Capacity of the Acme Gyrocopter
PERSON	Eric User		Eric User
DATE CREATED	Fri, 7th Mar 2014 10:45am		Fri, 7th Mar 2014 11:00am
DEPARTMENT	Support Dept.		Support Dept.
STATUS	Awaiting User		Awaiting Agent
URGENCY	7		2
LANGUAGE	English		English
CATEGORY	Reseller		Consumer
PRIORITY	Busywork		Busywork
PRODUCT			Gyrocopter
WORKFLOW			Follow up
LABEL			explosion legacy-product recurring

Merge these two tickets

Click **Merge these two tickets** to complete the process.

Holding tickets

Putting a ticket **on hold** means that the helpdesk needs to act on it, but you are waiting for a third party to do something first.

You can put a ticket on hold using the **Actions** pulldown menu.

Only tickets that are **awaiting agent** can be put on hold. You can think of on hold as a sub-status that applies to **awaiting agent** tickets.

If there are tickets on hold, you will see how many there are in the **Awaiting Agent** area of the filter pane; the checkbox toggles between not showing held tickets and *only* showing held tickets.

TICKETS	SEARCH		TICKETS	SEARCH
AWAITING AGENT	☐ 3 ON HOLD		AWAITING AGENT	☒ 3 ON HOLD
My Tickets	1		My Tickets	0
Tickets I Follow	3		Tickets I Follow	0
My Teams' Tickets	5		My Teams' Tickets	0
Unassigned Tickets	9		Unassigned Tickets	3
All Tickets	16		All Tickets	3
Support Dept.	14		Support Dept.	2
Sales Dept.	2		Sales Dept.	1

Tickets on hold will be displayed in the rest of the interface as normal, whether or not the box is checked.

You can't search for tickets that are on hold from the advanced ticket search. You can find them using the **quick search bar**.

A good way to make sure you don't forget about a ticket you put on hold is to create a [task](#) linked to that ticket.

Changing a ticket's user

You can change the user associated with the ticket from the **Actions** pull-down menu, creating a new user record if necessary.

For example, if user A creates a ticket, but then tells you that user B will be handling it from now on, change the user. That way user B will receive emails about the ticket, will be able to track it from your web portal, etc.

Splitting messages to a new ticket

If there are messages about two different issues mixed up in a single ticket, you can use **Split Messages To New Ticket** from the **Actions** pull-down menu.

Enter a title for the new ticket, and select the messages you want to move with the checkboxes.

Split Messages to New Ticket

New Ticket Subject
Running in circles

☒ #1 Ms. Sue Advanced User <propellerhead@example.com> Fri, 14th Mar 2014 12:11pm
I'm having trouble with my robot horse. It runs in circles and it takes three or four goes to start up.

☒ #2 Acme Support Agent 1 <agent1@acmeinc.example.co> Fri, 14th Mar 2014 12:13pm
Don't worry. First I'd like you to try this:
1. Turn it off and on again.
2. Make sure the contacts are free of dust.
3. Check that it's on a level surface.

☐ #3 Acme Support Agent 2 <ben.henley+agent2@deskpro.com> Fri, 14th Mar 2014 12:48pm
I've reset the encabulator - has that fixed the problem?

☐ #4 Ms. Sue Advanced User <propellerhead@example.com> Fri, 14th Mar 2014 12:49pm
That's great! Everything is fine. Thanks so much.

☒ #5 Ms. Sue Advanced User <propellerhead@example.com> Thur, 8th May 2014 4:31pm
Oh, I just realized the circling problem is still not resolved.

☒ #6 Acme IT Boss <ben.henley@deskpro.com> Thur, 8th May 2014 4:32pm
I am going to have one of my team look into this again.

The user for the new ticket will be the same.

Create a linked ticket

Sometimes you might want to have separate tickets for the same issue. For example, suppose a user raises a ticket and you need to discuss it with an outside contractor. You don't want to change the ticket user, and you don't want to add the contractor as an agent.

The solution is to create a **linked ticket**, using **Create Linked Ticket** the **Actions** pull-down menu.

The new linked ticket acts like an independent ticket, but you can see that it's linked to the original ticket when you open it in the content pane.

ID: 65 **Help! I don't know what to do next**

 Susan (ham@eggs.net.za) [Add CC](#)

Support Dept. **Awaiting Agent** 3

PROPERTIES	% LINKED TICKETS (1)	TASKS (0)	SLAS	BILLING
Parent Ticket				
Subject	Department	Person	Agent	Status
Help! I don't know what to do next	Support Dept.	Jethro Vortex <user@example.com>	Acme IT Boss	Awaiting Agent 3

This works only one way: you can't see the newer ticket from the original ticket.

Create a new pending article

If you realize that the issue in a particular ticket should be addressed in a knowledgebase article, you can use **Create a new pending article** from the **Actions** pull-down menu.

Create a new pending article

X

A pending article is a note in the Publish section about an article that needs to be written.

Enter a note or description about the article that needs to be written. It will also be linked to this ticket.

Enter a **note** describing the article that needs to be written, then click **Add**.

This creates a **pending article** in the Publish app.

PUBLISH

SEARCH

4 ARTICLES

PENDING

Add

Pending Articles 4

0 selected

Perform Actions

All Drafts 2

☐

Ticket [Technical support urgently needed](#)

Need to update troubleshooting guide

Create Article

Delete

Linked ticket

Note

The pending article is linked to the ticket, making it easy to refer to the ticket while writing the article.

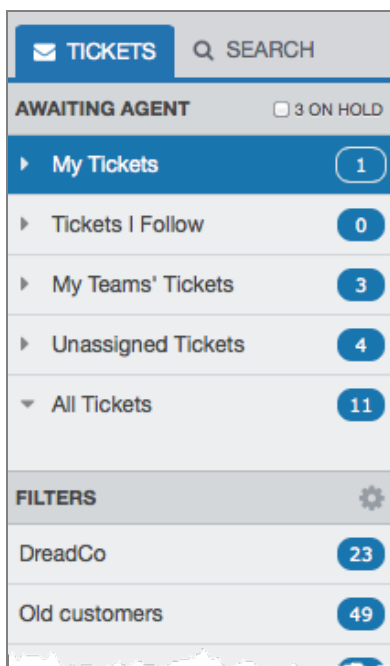
Printing and exporting ticket information

You can select **Print** from the **Actions** pull-down menu to display the ticket in a layout suitable for printing from your web browser.

You can select **Download PDF** from the **Actions** pull-down menu to get a PDF version of the ticket details and message history.

3.7. Filtering and sorting tickets

The Tickets app has a variety of **filters**. Some of them are shown in the image below; for example, **My Tickets** is a filter.



Filters give you an overview of how busy the helpdesk is at a glance, because each filter displays the number of tickets it matches. In this example, there is one ticket in **My Tickets**, none in **Tickets I Follow**, three in **My Teams' Tickets**, and so on.

To select a filter, click on it. The tickets matching it are displayed in the **list pane**.

The awaiting agent section

At the top of the filter pane is the **Awaiting Agent** section. As you'd expect, this section only shows the tickets with **awaiting agent** status; in other words, the tickets agents need to act on because the user is waiting for help!

The filters in this section are:

- **My Tickets** - tickets assigned to you and awaiting agent
- **Tickets I Follow** - tickets you follow that are awaiting agent
- **My Teams' Tickets** - tickets assigned to a team you belong to that are awaiting agent
- **Unassigned Tickets** - unassigned tickets that are awaiting agent
- **All Tickets** - all tickets that are awaiting agent

Ticket status filters

At the bottom of the filter pane you can see filters for the other statuses.

TICKETS	LABELS	FLAGGED
Awaiting Agent		11
Awaiting User		27
Resolved		3
Awaiting Validation		0
Spam		0
Recycle Bin		~2

The **Awaiting Agent** filter will show you the same tickets as the **All Tickets** filter in the **Awaiting Agent** section.

The other filters available are:

- Awaiting User
- Resolved
- Awaiting Validation
- Spam (tickets marked as spam)
- Recycle Bin (deleted tickets)

Tickets marked as spam or deleted will be permanently deleted after a period of time set by your admins - by default, spam tickets are kept for 2 weeks, and deleted tickets for 1 month.

Real-time updating in the list pane

When you click a filter, it shows you all matching tickets in the list pane. It's a lot like running a search - except that a filter doesn't just show you the tickets that matched at one point in time.

The list of matching tickets automatically updates itself. If you watch the **All Tickets** filter for a busy helpdesk for a while, you'll see tickets appear and disappear.

A ticket that appears in **All Tickets** might be a brand new ticket that a user has just submitted by email or through the web portal. Or it might be an older ticket with several earlier messages between the helpdesk and the user, and the user has just replied.

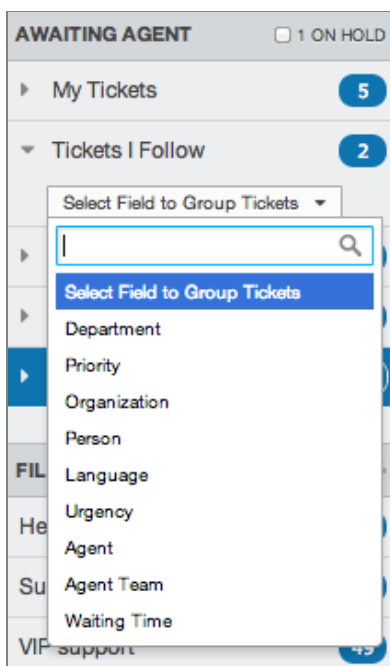
A ticket might disappear because an agent replied and set the status back to **awaiting user**, or because it was marked as spam or deleted, or because it was put on hold.

You can disable real-time updates by clicking the  icon at the upper right of the list pane.

Grouping tickets

You can customize the filters in the **Awaiting Agent** section by **grouping** tickets to create a subfilter.

- 1 Click the arrow to the left of a filter.
- 2 Click on **Select Field to Group Tickets**
- 3 Select the field you are interested in from the pull-down menu.

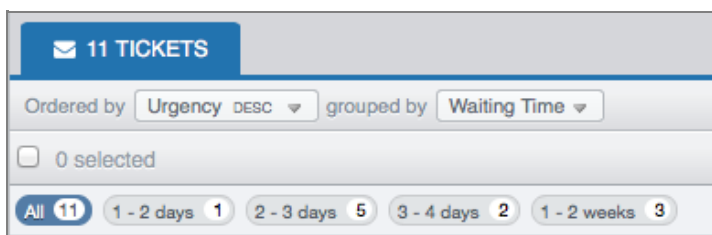


For example, you might choose to group **All Tickets** according to the user's organization.



To change the grouping, just click the arrow again.

A second level of grouping is available in the list pane, using the **grouped by** control.



DeskPRO creates groups based on the range of values for the property you've selected.

You can click the groups at the top of the list pane to filter the results further.

Creating custom ticket filters

If grouping is not sufficient to show you the tickets that matter to you, you can also define your own custom filter.

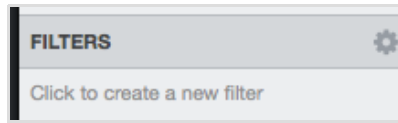
A custom filter is specific to your account; other agents can't see your custom filters.

To make a custom filter:

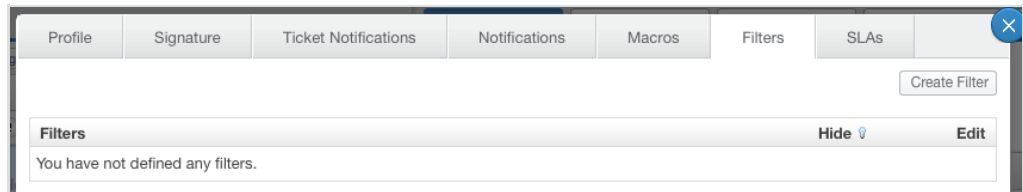
1 Click the **Filters** section



icon to make a new custom filter.



2 The Filters section of your account **Preferences** opens.



3 Click **Create Filter**.

4 Under **Title**, enter a name for the filter that describes what it shows.

5 Click **Add criteria** to select a ticket property that you want to show in this filter.

Possible criteria are:

- **Originated interface** (how tickets were created - email, web portal, website or through the agent interface)
- **Ticket Gateway Address**
- **Ticket Gateway Account** i.e. the email account through which the ticket was created
- **Subject**
- **Department**
- **Assigned Agent**
- **Assigned Team**
- **Followers** (which agents are following the ticket)
- **Labels**
- **Status**
- **Ticket is on hold**
- **Organization**
- **Product**
- **Category**
- **Urgency**
- **Priority**
- **Workflow**
- **SLA** (filter tickets to which a certain SLA applies)
- **SLA Status** (filter tickets which are meeting or failing an SLA)
- **User Waiting Time** (filter tickets that are currently awaiting agent by how long they have had that status)
- **User Total Waiting Time** (filter by how long in total the ticket has spent awaiting agent over its lifetime)
- **Date Created**
- **Date Closed** (when the ticket was archived - this only applies if your helpdesk has a very large number of tickets and older ones have to be archived)
- **Date of Last Agent Reply**
- **Date of Last User Reply**
- **Custom ticket fields** your admins may have set up

You can filter tickets by the properties of the ticket's user:

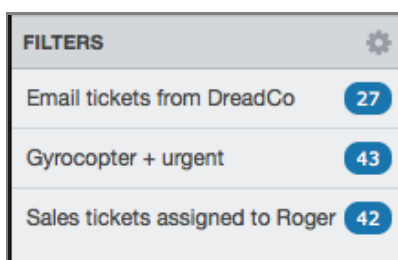
- **Name** (of user)
- **Email Address** (of user)
- **Email Domain** (the part of the user's email address after the @ symbol - useful for finding users from the same company)
- **Person ID** (ID number, the user equivalent of ticket ID)
- **Date** of profile creation
- **Labels** (on the user)
- **Contact Phone**
- **Contact Address**
- **Contact Instant Messaging**
- **Custom user fields** your admins may have set up

You can also filter by the properties of the user's organization:

- **Date Created**
- **Email Domains** (which email domains are recorded in DeskPRO for the organization: e.g. email from anyone @dreadco.zy is from a user belonging to the DreadCo organization)
- **Labels**
- **Contact Phone**
- **Contact Address**
- **Contact Instant Messaging**
- **Custom organization fields**

You can click **Add Criteria** again to add to the filter - the filter will only show tickets which meet *all* the criteria you set.

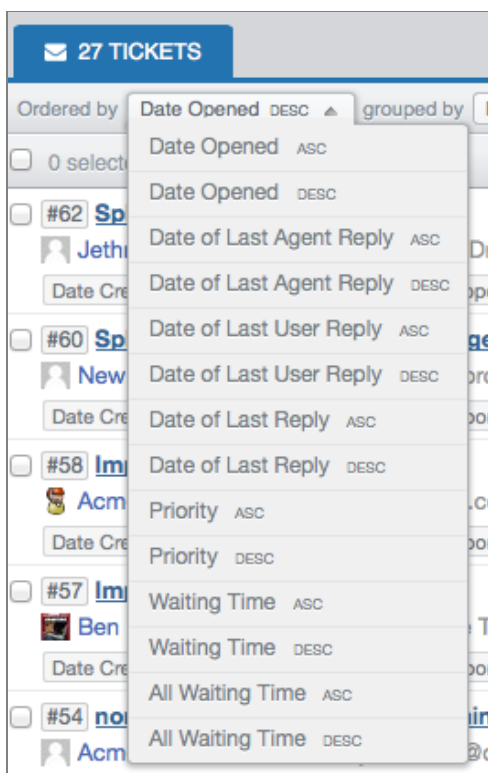
Close the account preferences window with the **X** at the top right. Your custom filters are displayed in the filter pane.



Ordering tickets in the list pane

Once you have selected a list of tickets using a filter, you may want to view them in a certain order - for example, oldest tickets first, or tickets with the highest [urgency](#) first.

You can order the tickets in the list pane using the **Ordered by** pull-down menu.



ASC and DESC mean *ascending* and *descending*. For example, **Waiting Time ASC** means that the tickets will be shown in ascending order of user waiting time: the waiting time gets higher as you go up the list, with the highest waiting time at the top.

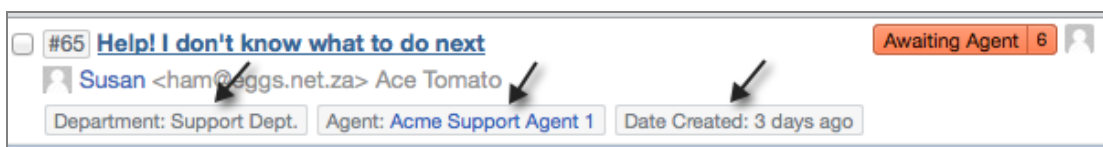
You can order by:

- **Urgency** (available for **Awaiting Agent** and custom filters only)
- **Date Opened** (when the ticket was created)
- **Date of Last Agent Reply**
- **Date of Last User Reply**
- **Date of Last Reply**
- **Priority** (if your helpdesk uses this field)
- **Waiting Time** (for tickets with awaiting agent status; this does nothing on tickets with another status)
- **All Waiting Time** (total time spent with awaiting agent status over the ticket's lifetime)

Note that DeskPRO saves your chosen order separately for each filter.

Field display options

Some fields are shown in gray boxes on each ticket in the list pane.



You can customize which fields are displayed by clicking the  icon at the top right of the list pane.

Display Options: My Teams' Tickets

☒ Department ☒ Agent ☒ Date Created

☐ ID ☐ Status ☐ Agent Team ☐ Language ☐ Category ☐ Priority

☐ Workflow ☐ Product ☐ Organization ☐ SLAs ☐ Labels ☐ User Waiting

☐ All Waiting Time ☐ Date of Last Reply ☐ Date of Last User Reply

☐ Date of Last Agent Reply ☐ Date Resolved ☐ Flammability ☐ User Field: Custom1

Apply

Use the checkboxes to add and remove fields, then click **Apply**.

3 TICKETS

Ordered by Urgency DESC grouped by None

0 selected

☐	#65	Help! I don't know what to do next	Awaiting Agent 6
	Susan	<ham@eggs.net.za> Ace Tomato	
	Category: Consumer	Priority: Routine	Flammability: Flammable
	All Waiting Time: 3 days		
☐	#61	Rotor splitting during takeoff	Awaiting Agent 3
	Brian Canid	<coyote@example.com> CTO, DreadCo	
	Category: Regulator	Priority: Existential	Flammability: Inflammable
	All Waiting Time: 3 days		
☐	#9	Capacity of the Acme Gyrocopter	Awaiting Agent 2
	Eric User	<rocketfan@example.com> DreadCo	
	Category: Consumer	Priority: Busywork	Flammability: Inflammable
	All Waiting Time: 5 days		

The fields you choose to display are saved separately for each filter.

Labelling tickets

You can apply **labels** to tickets (and other items). A label is a short piece of text you can attach to items to help find them quickly, and group similar items.

Labels are shared between agents. Other agents can see labels you add, and you can see and benefit from other agents' labels.

You can enter a label using the content pane from the **Properties** section of an individual ticket.

You can either select an existing label from the pull-down menu, or type a new one and press Enter.

Click the **x** on the left of a label to remove it.

You can also apply labels as a [mass action](#).

There are many possible uses for labels, depending on the needs of your helpdesk. You might label tickets to track software platforms, or product versions, or different types of problem.

Labeling has two benefits:

- 1 Searches from the **Quick Search bar** match labels.
Suppose you had a ticket that was about engine problems but didn't mention the word "engine" in the Subject field. A quick search for "engine" wouldn't find it, but you could label it "engine" to make it easier to find.
- 2 You can use labels to filter tickets using the **Labels** tab in the bottom section of the filter pane.

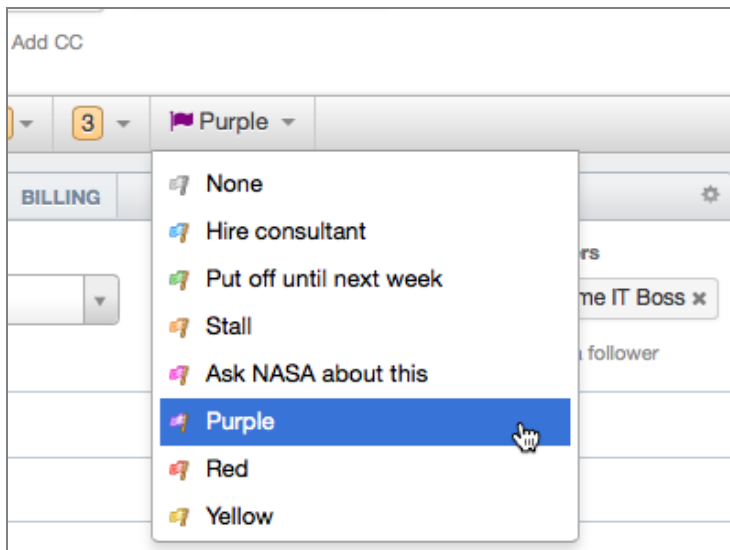
Click on each label to see tickets.

The **Cloud** view shows labels in bigger text the more tickets they have. You can also select a **List** view by clicking on the List tab.

Flags

Flags are a personal way to organize tickets. Unlike labels, other agents can't see your flags.

You can apply flags using the content pane from the **Properties** section of an individual ticket.



You can use flags to filter tickets from the **Flagged** tab in the bottom section of the filter pane.

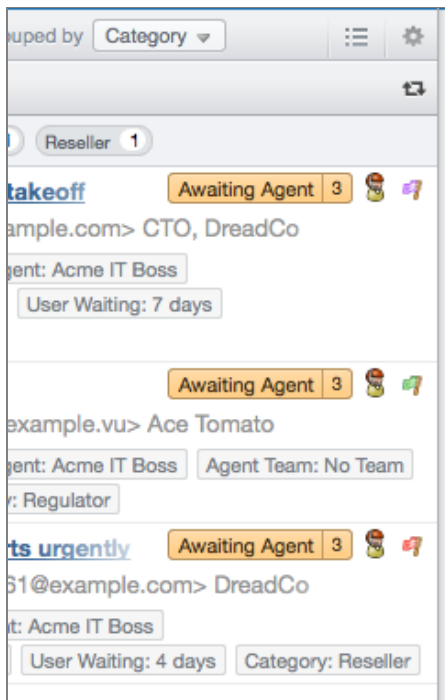
TICKETS	LABELS	FLAGGED
	Hire consultant	0
	Put off until next week	0
	Stall	0
	Ask NASA about this	2
	Purple	1
	Red	0
	Yellow	0

Flags let you create personal collections of tickets. Double-click on a flag to change its title.

By default, flags are named after their colors.

You can double-click on the flag names in the filter pane to change them to something more descriptive.

Flags are also displayed at the right hand side of the list pane.



3.8. Prioritizing tickets

There are several different ways in DeskPRO to track which tickets are most important.

SLAs

SLAs (Service Level Agreements) are targets set up by your admins for how soon you should reply to or resolve a ticket. They may reflect your company's own service standards, or contractual obligations your company has to your users.

A simple example is an SLA which states you will send the first reply to each ticket within 4 hours.

SLA requirements can be more complex: for example, you could have an SLA that states a user shouldn't spend more than 12 hours total waiting time during your helpdesk working hours before their ticket is resolved.

An SLA may apply to all tickets, or only to certain categories of tickets. For example, if some organizations pay you for premium support, your helpdesk could have an SLA that applied only to tickets from those organizations.

Some SLAs can be manually assigned by agents.

An SLA also has a **warning** time which specifies when you will be warned that the ticket is close to failing.

You can see SLAs in the Tickets app filter pane.

SLAs		
First Response	7	2
Special VIPs	0	1

In this example, 7 tickets are currently passing the "First Response" SLA (figure in green), 2 are on warning (in amber), and 1 has failed (in red).

Click on the name of an SLA to see all the tickets to which it applies, ordered by descending SLA severity (that is, failing tickets at the top).

10 TICKETS		
Ordered by SLA Severity DESC grouped by None		
0 selected		
☐	#11 Technical support urgently needed	Simon User <simon@example.com> DreadCo Department: Support Dept. Agent: Unassigned Agent Team: No Team
☐	#71 Need replacement parts urgently	Mariam User <mariam1961@example.com> DreadCo Department: Sales Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: No Team
☐	#70 Loose bolt issue	A User <auser@example.com> DreadCo Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme IT Boss Agent Team: No Team
☐	#59 Spin-off	Advanced User <propellerhead@example.com> DHARMA Department: Support Dept. Agent: Acme Support Agent 1 Agent Team: Support Mana
☐	#48 Different wheel type??	Suki User <sukif6@example.com> DreadCo

Tickets that are **failing** an SLA are **red** at the left-hand edge whenever they're displayed in the list pane.

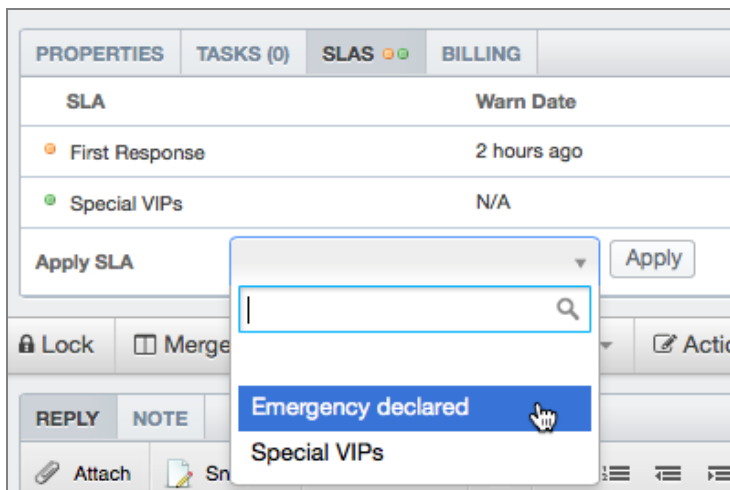
Tickets on **warning** are *amber* at the edge.

To see the details of your helpdesk's SLA conditions, click the  icon in the SLA section.

You can view the SLAs which apply to an individual ticket in the **SLAs** tab in the content pane.

PROPERTIES	TASKS (0)	SLAS 	BILLING
SLA		Warn Date	
	First Response	2 hours ago	
	Special VIPs	N/A	

This is also where you can select agent-assigned SLAs to apply to the ticket.



Filtering SLAs

Click the  icon at the top right of the SLAs section to open the SLAs section of your account **Preferences**.

From here you can use the **Filter SLA results** pull-down menu to change what the SLAs area of the filter pane shows.

Profile	Signature	Ticket Notifications	Notifications	Macros	Filters	SLAs
Filter SLA results: Show only tickets assigned to me						
SLAs	Type	Warning	Failure	Hide 		
First Response	Time until first response (Default working hours)	90 minutes	3 hours	☐ Hide		
Special VIPs	Time until ticket resolution (24x7)	1 hour	2 hours	☐ Hide		

You can choose to:

- Show all matching tickets
- Show only tickets assigned to me
- Show only tickets assigned to my team

For example, if you select **Show only tickets assigned to me** then close **Preferences**, you see SLA information only for tickets assigned to you.

SLAs: MY TICKETS ⚙			
First Response	1	2	0
Special VIPs	1	0	1

You can also use the **Hide** checkboxes to hide SLAs that are not relevant to you.

SLAs	
First Response	☐ Hide
Special VIPs	☒ Hide

If a ticket is created by an agent, SLAs which specify the time until first response will not apply.

PROPERTIES	TASKS (0)	SLAS ⚙	BILLING
SLA	Warn Date		Fail Date
Special VIPs	N/A		N/A
First Response	N/A		N/A

Urgency

Tickets are assigned an **urgency** score from 1 to 10. This is a graded measure of how soon the ticket needs attention.

ID: 70 **Loose bolt issue**

A User (auser@example.com)

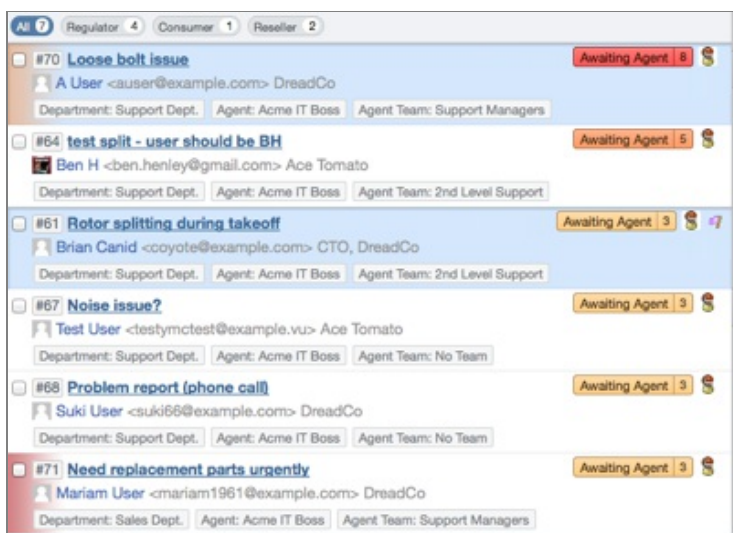
Support Dept. ⌵ Awaiting Agent 8 ⌵

Urgency can be set manually by agents.

Your admins can also automatically change urgency based on automatic **triggers** when some event happens - for example, when a certain user creates a ticket by email, it could be assigned a higher urgency than usual - and **escalations** based on how much time has passed - for example, tickets that are close to failing an SLA could be made more urgent.

Here's an example of tickets sorted by descending urgency in the list pane.

The urgency scores are displayed on the right. Low urgency scores are colored yellow, shading through orange to red as the score gets higher.



Note the difference between SLA condition and urgency score. A ticket can fail an SLA or be on SLA warning, but still have a low urgency.

Ticket priority field

Priority is an optional ticket field. It has priority levels that have an order, from lowest to highest.

The number of different priority levels and their names is decided by your admins.

Here are some examples of priority levels that different helpdesks might use, in increasing priority order:

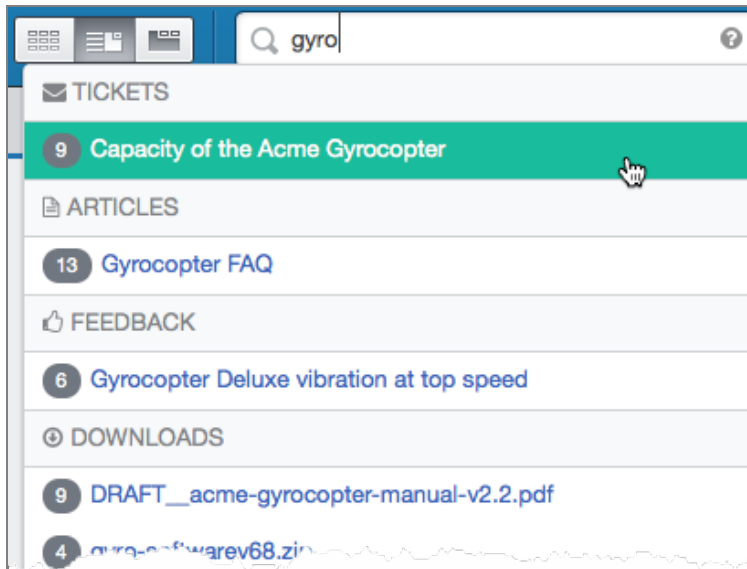
- Low/Medium/High
- Routine/Urgent
- Deviation/Anomaly/Incident/Accident/Meltdown

While **urgency** and **SLAs** are internal to your helpdesk and can't be seen by users, DeskPRO can be configured to enable users to set priority when they submit tickets from the web portal.

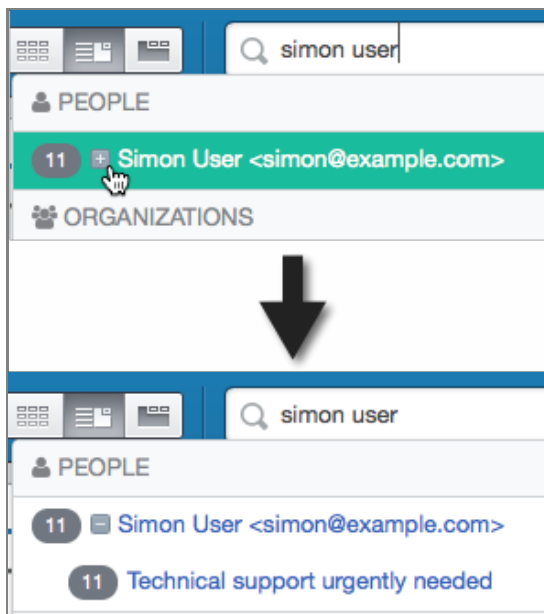
3.9. Searching for tickets

The **Quick Search** bar shows tickets where your search terms match any of the following:

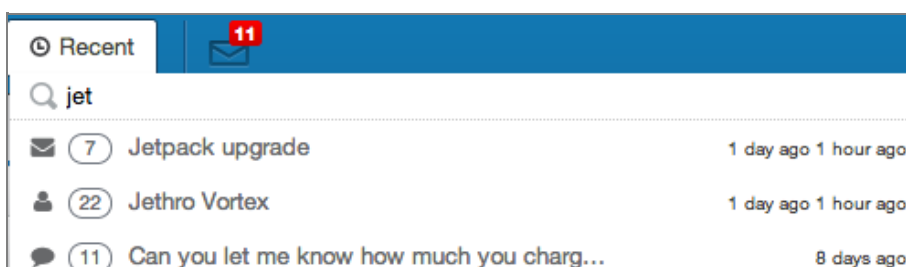
- ID
- Ref code
- Subject
- Labels



Click the gray plus icon next to a user's name to view their tickets.



If you're looking for a ticket you've worked on recently, you can also filter results from the Recent field.



Advanced ticket search

DeskPRO can handle millions of tickets, so the quick search will not always be specific enough. You can construct a much more detailed custom search from the list pane.

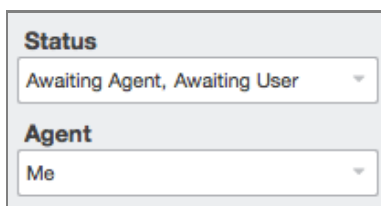
Click the **Search** tab in the list pane to access advanced ticket search.

The advanced ticket search lets you search across many more properties of the ticket than the quick search: for example, you can search through all message text, not just the ticket subject.

You can narrow down your search using:

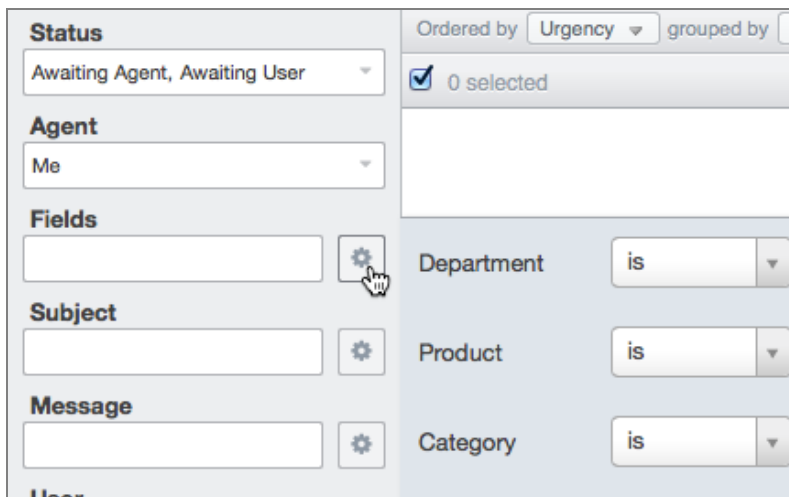
- **Status**
- **Agent** (and/or team)
- **Fields** (department, product, category, priority, workflow, custom fields you have set up etc.)
- **Subject**
- **Message** (the text, who wrote it, and when)
- **User** (name, email, usergroup)
- **Organization**
- **Dates & Times**

By default, your search is limited to tickets which are assigned to you and have a status of *either awaiting agent or awaiting user*.



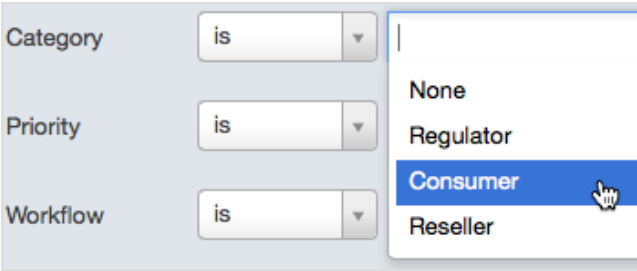
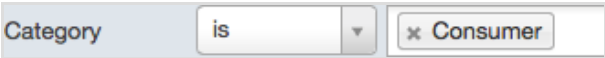
A screenshot of the advanced search filters. It shows two sections: 'Status' with a dropdown menu set to 'Awaiting Agent, Awaiting User', and 'Agent' with a dropdown menu set to 'Me'.

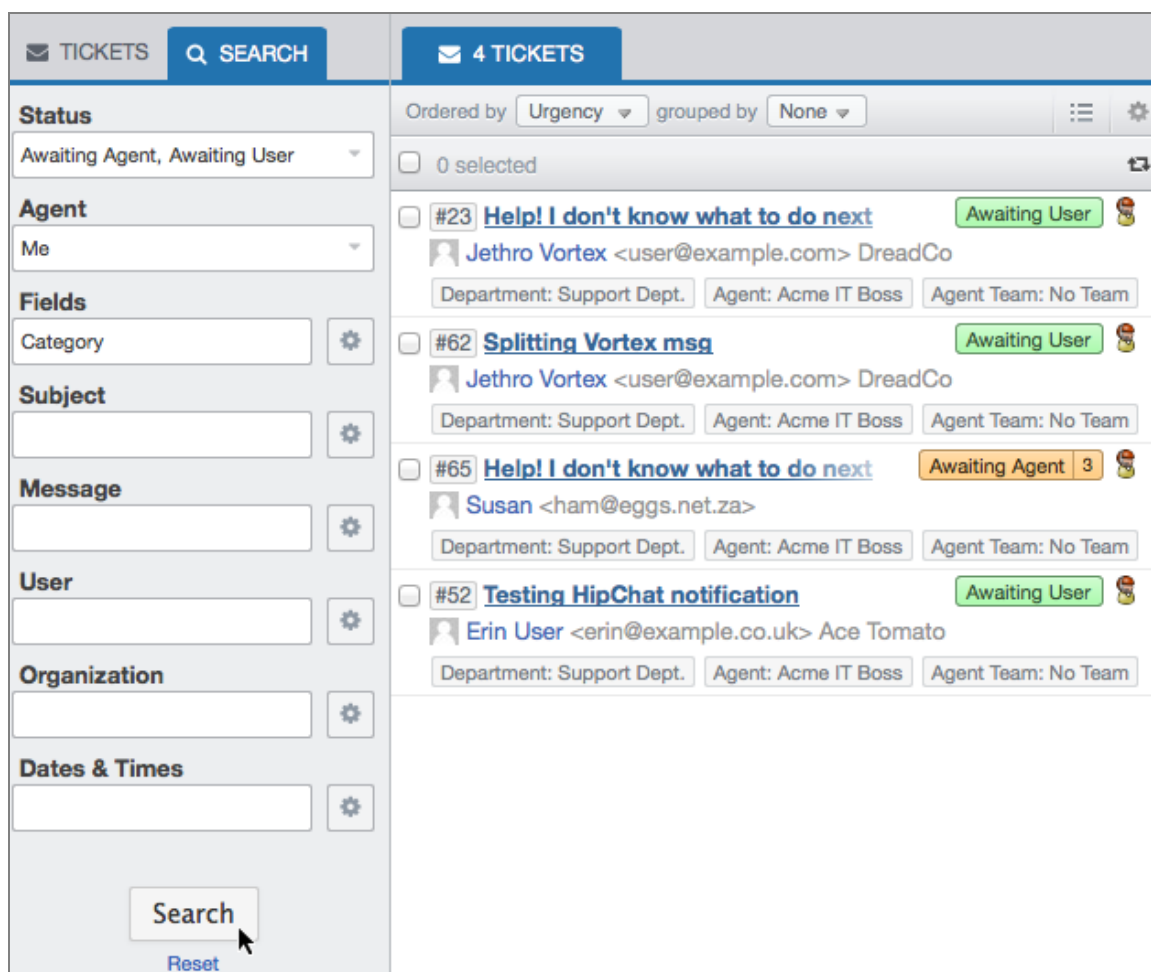
Let's say you want to narrow down the search further by specifying a category.



A screenshot of the advanced search filters. On the left, there are sections for 'Status' (set to 'Awaiting Agent, Awaiting User'), 'Agent' (set to 'Me'), 'Fields' (with an empty input field and a gear icon), 'Subject' (with an empty input field and a gear icon), 'Message' (with an empty input field and a gear icon), and 'User' (partially visible). On the right, there is a section for 'Ordered by' (set to 'Urgency') and 'grouped by' (set to 'f'). Below this, there is a checkbox labeled '0 selected'. Further down, there are three search criteria: 'Department is', 'Product is', and 'Category is', each with a dropdown menu.

- 1 Click the **Fields** gear icon

- 2 A gray panel opens showing fields search options. Click to select a category.

- 3 Your selection is shown as a gray box.

- 4 Click outside the gray panel to close it.
- 5 Click **Search** to see your results.



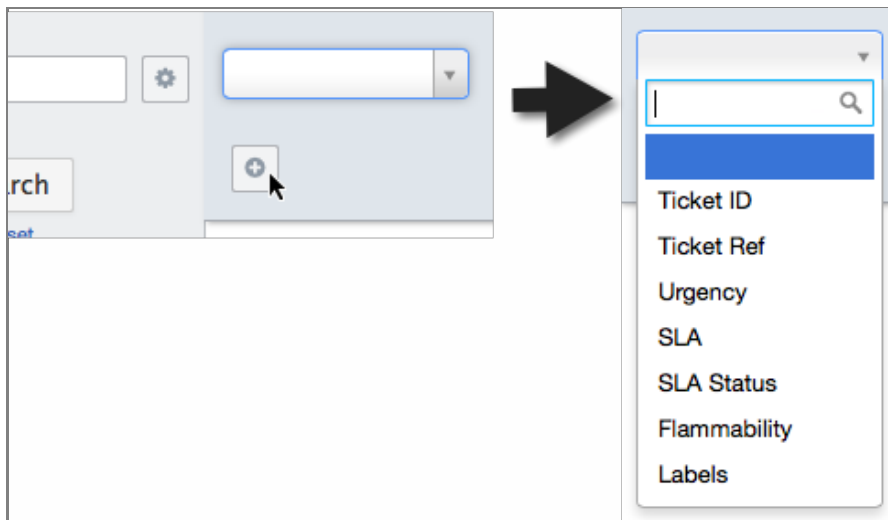
The screenshot displays the DeskPRO interface. On the left, a sidebar contains various filters: Status (Awaiting Agent, Awaiting User), Agent (Me), Fields (Category, Priority, Workflow), Subject, Message, User, Organization, and Dates & Times. At the bottom of the sidebar is a 'Search' button and a 'Reset' link. The main area shows a list of tickets. The top of the main area has a 'TICKETS' tab and a 'SEARCH' button. Below this, there are filters for 'Ordered by' (Urgency) and 'grouped by' (None). The list of tickets includes details such as ticket ID, title, user, department, agent, and team. The 'Search' button is highlighted with a mouse cursor.

Only tickets which match *every* property you have searched on will show up in your search results.

In the example search shown below, the ticket status must be **awaiting agent** *and* the **department** field must match "Support Dept" *and* the **organization** of the user must be DreadCo *and* the user total waiting time must be more than 6 days. (From this view, you can see which properties have been used in the search, but not what values you are searching for).

You can click the  icons to view and edit the search terms for a particular ticket property.

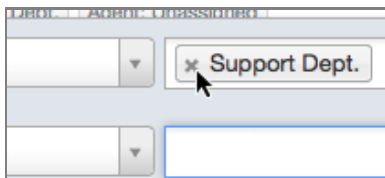
Note that the  icon at the lower left of the gray search options pane lets you access extra search options.



To clear **Status** and **Agent** options, just click the white box and then uncheck them.

Don't forget to clear the defaults for status and agent if they're not what you want.

To clear options denoted by gray boxes, click the **x** at the left.

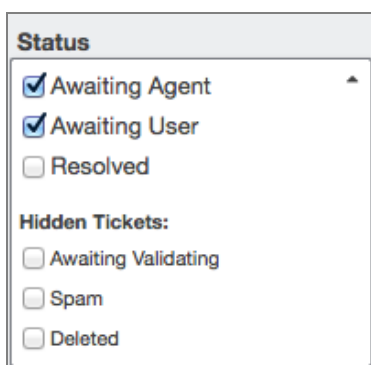


To clear text entry options, delete the entered text.

If you want to completely clear your search and go back to the default setting, click **Reset** under the Search button.

Advanced ticket search: status

Only the tickets with the checked status types will show up in your search results.



You can search for any combination of:

- Awaiting agent
- Awaiting user
- Resolved
- Awaiting validation
- Spam
- Deleted

You cannot search for tickets with "on hold" status using advanced search.

Advanced ticket search: agent

You can search for tickets assigned to any agent or team.



The screenshot shows a dropdown menu titled "Agent". It contains two sections: "Agents" and "Teams". Under "Agents", there are checkboxes for "Unassigned", "Me" (which is checked), "Acme Admin 1", "Acme Newbie Agent (Limited)", "Acme Sales Manager", "Acme Support Agent 1", "Acme Support Agent 2", "Dave", and "New Agent". Under "Teams", there are checkboxes for "None", "1st Level Support", "2nd Level Support", "Sales Team", and "Support Managers".

If you select **Unassigned** and **Me**, your search will match tickets which are either unassigned or assigned to you.

If you select **Sales Team**, your search will match tickets which are assigned to that team, but not tickets which are assigned to an individual agent who belongs to that team.

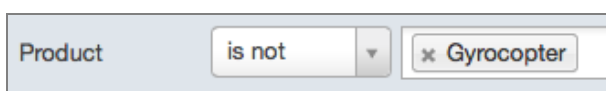
Advanced ticket search: fields

The fields search allows you to match by department, product, category, priority or workflow (your helpdesk may not have all of these set up).

Note that you can also choose **None** to match tickets which have no value entered for a field.

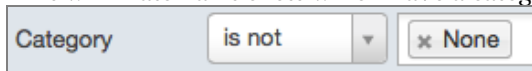
You can choose to apply either **is** or **is not** to the field.

This will match tickets where the product is *not* Gyrocopter (including tickets with no product).



The screenshot shows a search field with the label "Product". To the right of the label is a dropdown menu with "is not" selected. To the right of the dropdown is a text input field containing "x Gyrocopter".

This will match all tickets which have a category, but not tickets where no category was set.

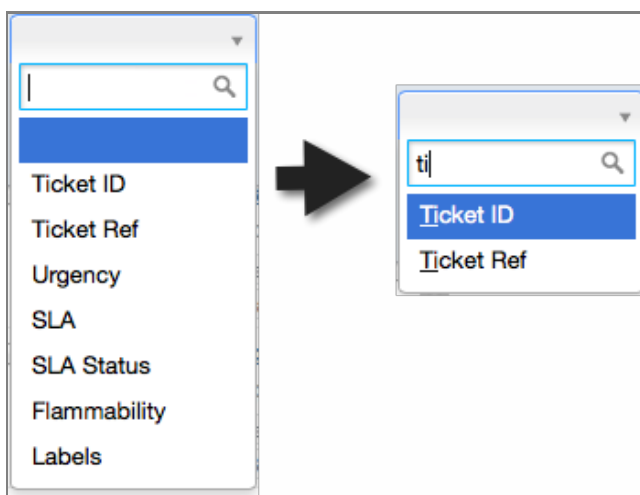


A search filter interface showing the label 'Category', a dropdown menu with 'is not' selected, and a button labeled 'x None'.

The extra options accessible from the  are:

- Ticket ID
- Ticket ref code
- Urgency
- SLA
- SLA status
- Custom fields
- Labels

You can filter the available search options.



A diagram illustrating the filtering of search options. On the left, a dropdown menu lists search fields: Ticket ID, Ticket Ref, Urgency, SLA, SLA Status, Flammability, and Labels. A large black arrow points to the right, where the same dropdown is shown with the text 'ti' entered in the search box. The results are filtered to show only 'Ticket ID' and 'Ticket Ref'.

Advanced ticket search: message text

You can enter text into the **Subject** and **Message** boxes. You can press Enter to update your search straight away.

Use the  to construct more advanced searches.

You can choose to search for tickets which either contain or do not contain the text.

You can choose to match/exclude by:

- **All words** - every word you type must be present
- **Any words** - any word you type can be present
- **Phrase** - the words you type must be present in that order

The message search also has options to match messages:

- **By anyone**
- **By an agent**
- **By a user**

and to match messages

- Written any time
- Written before
- Written after
- Written between

where the relevant time is selected from a calendar.



Click **Relative time** on the calendar to specify a number of minutes, hours, days, weeks, months or years ago.

For the text search options, the  icon does not let you select extra properties, but instead lets you chain searches together.

Advanced ticket search: user

You can search on the details of the user associated with the ticket:

- Name
- Email
- Usergroup

and from the  icon:

- Custom fields
- Person ID
- Date of profile creation
- Labels
- Contact Phone
- Contact Address
- Contact Instant Messaging

Advanced ticket search: organization

You can search on the organization associated with the ticket.

From the  icon:

- **Date created** (date the organization was added to your helpdesk)
- **Email Domains**
- **Labels**
- **Name**
- **Contact Phone**
- **Contact Address**
- **Contact Instant Messaging**

Advanced ticket search: dates & times

You can search by:

- **User Waiting Time** (time the user has been waiting since the last agent action)
- **User Total Waiting Time** (how long the user has spent waiting over the life of the ticket)
- **Date Created**
- **Date Resolved**
- **Date Closed** (that is date the ticket was archived - this only applies to very large helpdesks which have to archive old tickets)
- **Date of Last Agent Reply**
- **Date of Last User Reply**

3.10. Macros

Macros are a way to apply several actions to a ticket at the same time.

If your workflow involves doing the same steps over and over again, setting up a macro can save you time.

Creating a macro

For example, suppose your procedure when you find a complicated problem is:

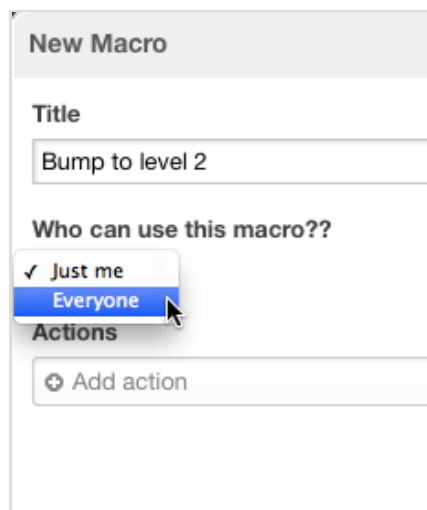
- assign it to the 2nd level support team
- label it "complicated"
- add your boss as a follower

Here's how you would set that up as a macro:

1 Open the **Preferences** area (in the toolbar at the top left of the interface) and select the **Macros** tab.

2 Click **Create Macro**.

3 The **New Macro** window opens.



New Macro

Title

Bump to level 2

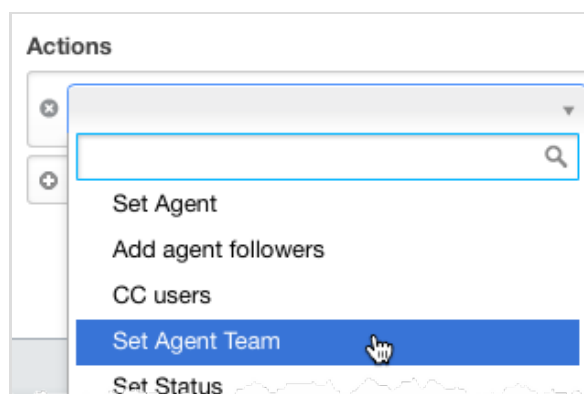
Who can use this macro??

✓ Just me
Everyone
Actions

+ Add action

4 Under **Who can use this macro??** select whether the macro is available to just you, or to every agent.

5 Click **Add Action**, then select an action from the pull-down menu. In this example, first you need to **Set Agent Team**.

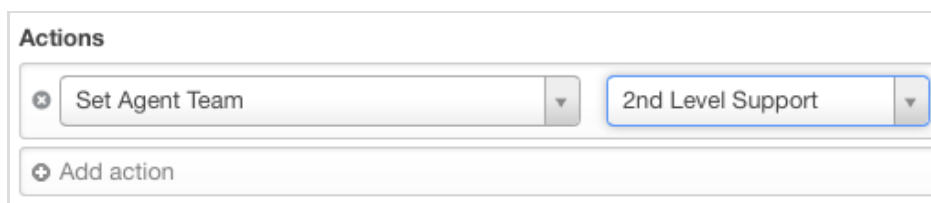


Actions

+ ×

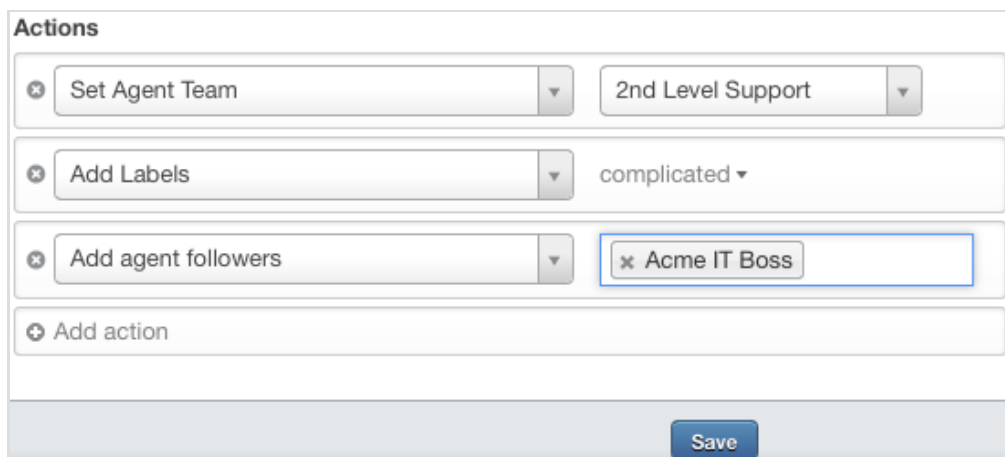
Set Agent
Add agent followers
CC users
Set Agent Team
Set Status

6 You then select which team to assign.



The screenshot shows a web interface with a section titled "Actions". Inside this section, there is a dropdown menu labeled "Set Agent Team" which has "2nd Level Support" selected. Below this, there is a button with a plus icon and the text "Add action".

7 Now use **Add Action** again with **Add Labels** to have the macro label the ticket "complicated", and use it a third time with **Add agent followers** to have it add your boss as a follower.

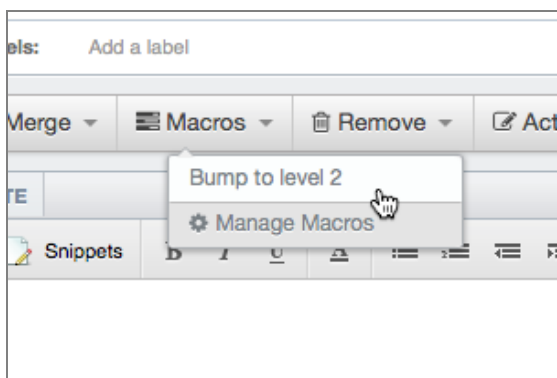


The screenshot shows the "Actions" panel with three actions configured. The first action is "Set Agent Team" with "2nd Level Support" selected. The second action is "Add Labels" with "complicated" selected. The third action is "Add agent followers" with "Acme IT Boss" selected. At the bottom of the panel is a "Save" button.

8 When the macro is complete, click **Save**.

When you apply that macro to a ticket, all three actions you've stored will be done in order.

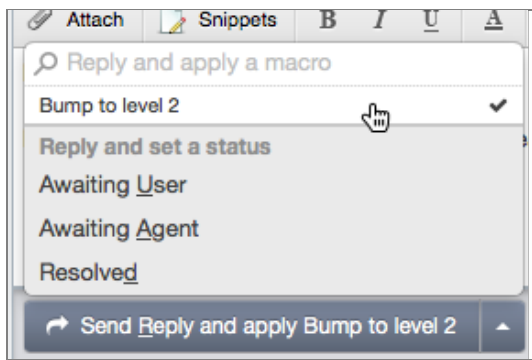
You can apply a macro from the content pane using the **Macros** button.



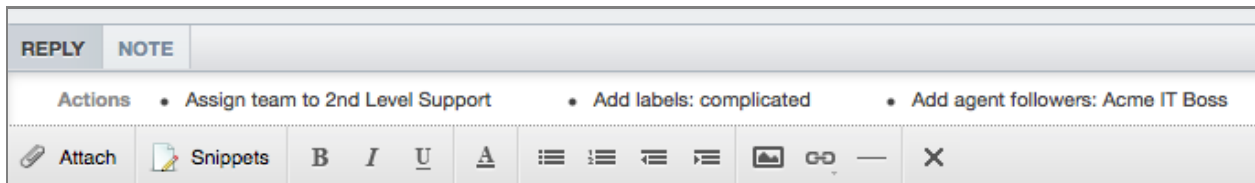
You will be asked to confirm the list of actions.

You can also choose to apply a macro when replying to a ticket, instead of setting a status.

Use the **Reply as...** pull-down and select the macro.



The actions the macro will apply are confirmed at the top of the reply box.



Of course, you can have the macro change the status for you if required.

You can also apply a macro to multiple tickets at the same time by selecting them from the list pane and using a [mass action](#).

Macro actions

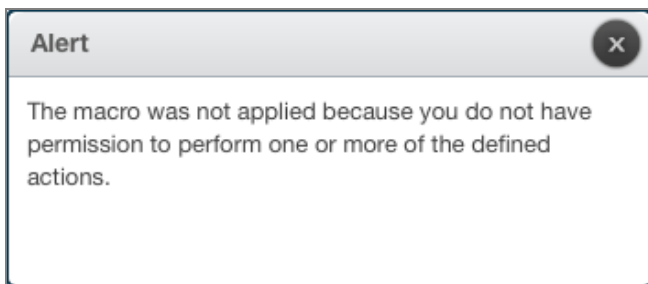
These are the actions you can add to a macro:

- Set agent
- Add agent followers
- CC users
- Set agent team
- Set status
- Ticket hold status
- Delete ticket
- Set department
- Set language
- Set category
- Set product
- Set priority
- Set workflow
- Add labels
- Remove labels
- Add organization managers to ticket
- Set flag
- Increase/decrease urgency
- Set urgency
- Set subject
- Add ticket reply
- Add reply from snippet
- Set custom field
- Set custom user field
- Close ticket tab

Macros and permissions

Different agent accounts have different permission levels which affect what they're allowed to do with tickets.

If your account lacks the permissions to do any of the actions in a macro, the macro can't run.

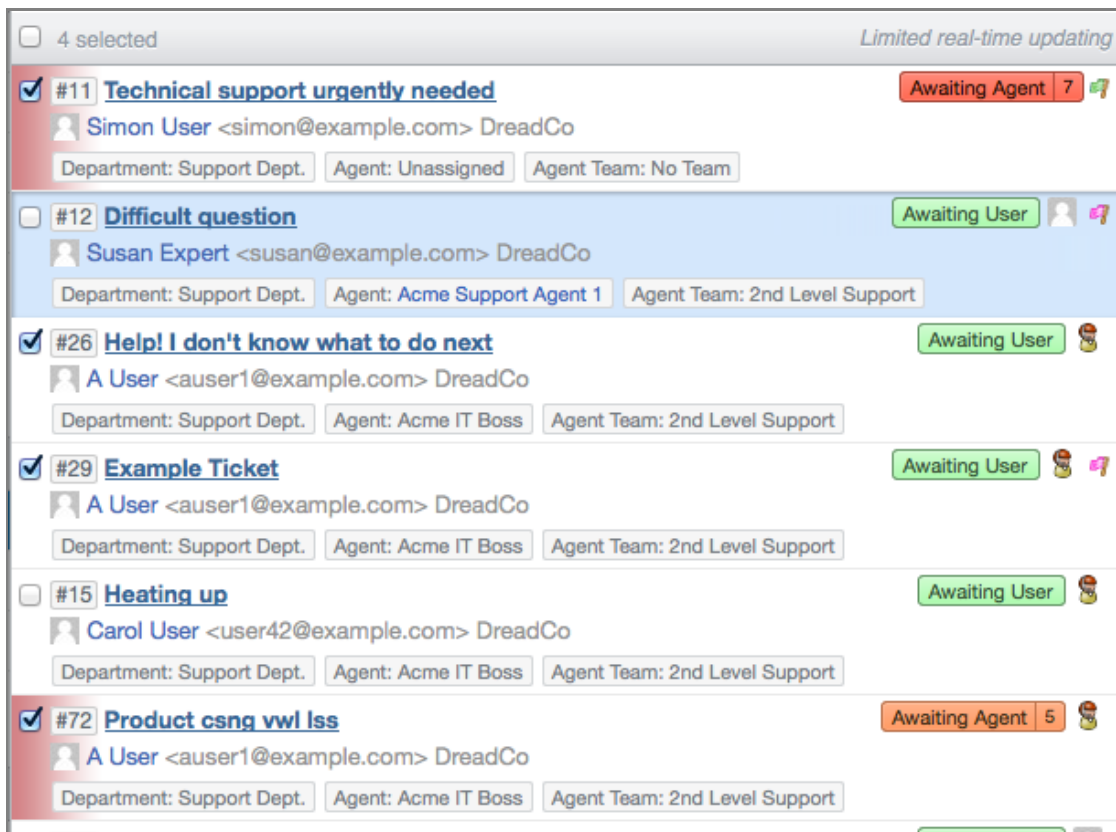


3.11. Mass actions

You may find that you need to apply the same action to a number of tickets at once.

Instead of clicking through each ticket one by one, you can carry out **mass actions**.

You can use mass actions from the list pane, by selecting tickets from the list using the checkboxes on the left.



The total number of tickets you have selected is displayed at the upper left of the list pane. You can click the checkbox at the upper left to select all the tickets on the page.

When you select a ticket, the **Apply actions to selections** window appears.

You can change the properties of all the selected tickets, subject to your account permissions.

More actions, including adding labels, are available from **Add action** under **Other Properties**.

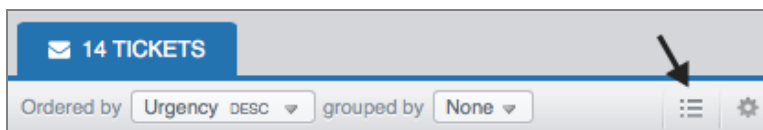
Note that your permissions may limit you from replying using a mass action, even if you would have permission to reply to the tickets individually.

If you are writing a mass reply, you could customize the message to each user by using [snippets](#).

For maximum productivity, you can apply a macro as a mass action.

Table view mass actions and CSV export

You can also carry out mass actions using the **table view**, which is accessible from the upper right of the list pane.



Select the tickets you want to act on using the checkboxes at the left, then press the **Perform Actions** button at the bottom left of the table view window.

Tickets		
☒ Status	Subject	User
☐ Awaiting Agent	Technical support urgently needed	Simon User
☒ Awaiting Agent	Help! I don't know what to do next	Susan
☐ Awaiting Agent	Product csng vwl lss	A User
☒ Awaiting Agent	Spin-off	Advanced User
☒ Awaiting Agent	Damaged parcel	A User
☒ Awaiting Agent	Fwd: Crazy cat flies rocket sled	M. Bertillon

5 selected [Perform Actions](#) [Export to CSV](#) Showing results 1-14 of 14

The table view also offers an **export to CSV** button at the bottom right. Click this to download details of all the tickets in the table as a file in CSV (*Comma Separated Values*) format. CSV is compatible with most spreadsheet programs (such as Excel) and databases.

Note that the CSV export always includes all properties for all the tickets in the table; the table view options or checkboxes you have selected do not affect it.

3.12. Billing

If you need to bill users based on the support you provide, your admins may have enabled **billing**.

This is not to be confused with the **Billing** interface you may be able to see at the lower left, where you pay for the service.

If billing is enabled, you will see a Billing tab when you have a ticket open in the content pane.

Charge/Time	Agent	Date	Comment
500.00 USD	Acme IT Boss	8 days ago	Extra charge on top of our normal support package

Charge: ☐ Amount: 0.00 USD ☒ Time: H M S Start Reset

Comment:

Add Charge

There are two ways to bill, by specifying an amount of money or by recording your time.

To add a specified charge:

- 1 Make sure the **Amount** button is selected.
- 2 Enter the amount in your currency.
- 3 Enter a comment in the **Comment** field (optional).

The billing currency is set by your admins.

To bill by time:

- 1 Make sure the **Time** button is selected.
- 2 Click the **Start** button at right.
- 3 The timer starts counting. This can be used to time how long it takes you to do work related to the ticket e.g. a chargeable support call.
- 4 Click **Pause** to stop the timer (e.g. if you stop work), and **Start** to restart it.
- 5 When you are ready to bill for the amount of elapsed time, enter a comment (optional) and click **Add Charge**.

You can only add time by running the timer. There is no way to enter an amount of time, or edit the elapsed time.

Use the **Billing** tab in an organization's record to see all the items billed to that organization.

4. Chat

The **Chat** app enables you to communicate with users via real-time instant messaging.

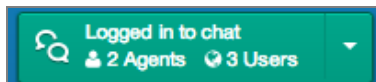
Depending on your helpdesk configuration, users may be able to initiate a chat from the web portal and/or your website.

If you are not available to chat, you can log out of the chat system while remaining signed in to DeskPRO.

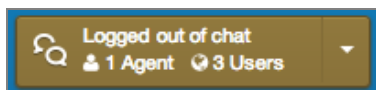
You can get an overview of the chat system using the **chat button** in the status bar.

The button shows if you are logged in or logged out, how many agents are logged in (the total includes you if you are logged in), and how many users are browsing web pages where chat is available.

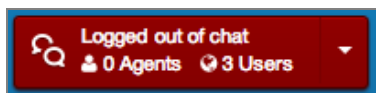
If you are logged in to chat, the button is green.



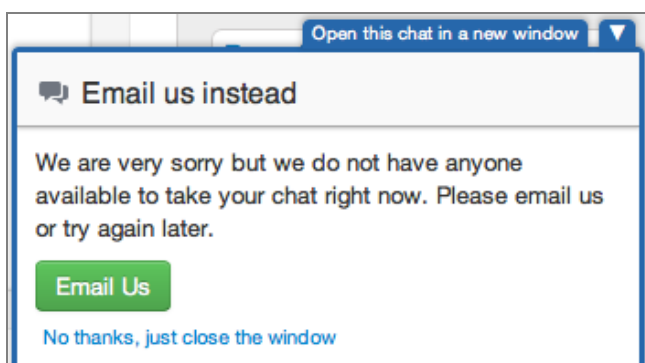
If you are not logged in, but other agents are, the button turns brown.



If no agents are logged in, the button turns red.



If no agents are logged in, users who try to chat are offered the option to email the helpdesk instead.

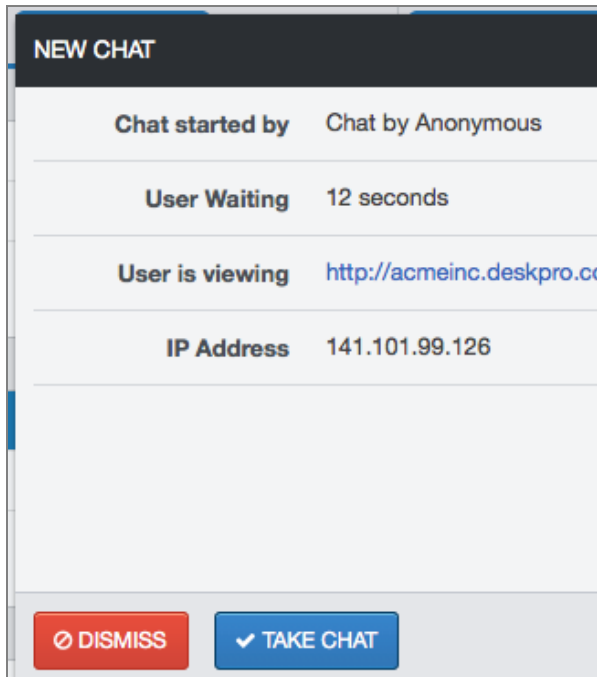


You can get a more detailed view of current and past chats from the Chat app filter pane:

USER CHAT		3 CHATS	
OPEN CHATS		Hi, can you help me understand this error	
New Chats	0	By Mike 17¼ hours ago	
My Open Chats	0	A User <auser@example.com>	
All Open Chats	0	By  A User <auser@example.com> 18 hou	
1 Acme IT Boss		Hei	
		By Chat User 4 weeks ago	
		Showing results 1 - 3 of 3	
ENDED CHATS			
My Chats	3		
Assigned Chats	16		
Missed Chats	7		
LABELS			
		LISTCLOUD	
P		panic	
T		test	

4.1. Accepting chats

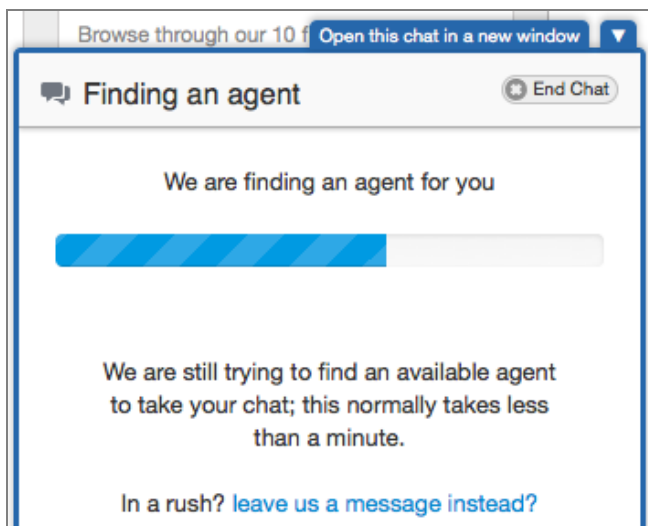
When a user initiates a chat and you're logged in to chat, you will see a **NEW CHAT** pop-up window at the top left of the user interface.



You can choose to **Dismiss** the chat and leave it for other agents, or you can **Accept** to begin chatting.

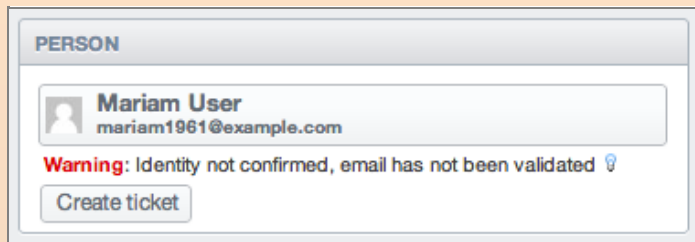
If you dismiss a chat by mistake, you can go to the **Open Chats** section of the filter pane, find the chat you want and click it in the list pane to open it.

While waiting for an agent to accept the chat, the user sees a **Finding an agent** message.



Depending on your DeskPRO configuration, user login may not be required before using chat. This means that somebody starting a chat could enter the email address of a registered user, without needing to log in and prove that the address is theirs.

When this happens, you will see the following warning:

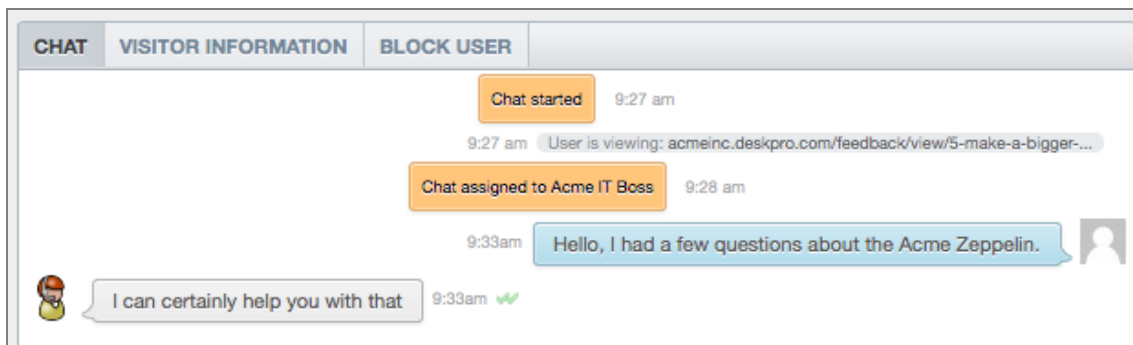


You should avoid discussing sensitive data in case the user is an imposter, at least until you can verify that they are really the user by other means.

4.2. Chatting with users

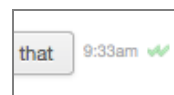
Chatting works much like any instant messaging system.

You see each message the user types in a blue speech bubble.



Use the reply box at the bottom of the window to send your response. You can use the  button or just press **Enter/Return** on your keyboard.

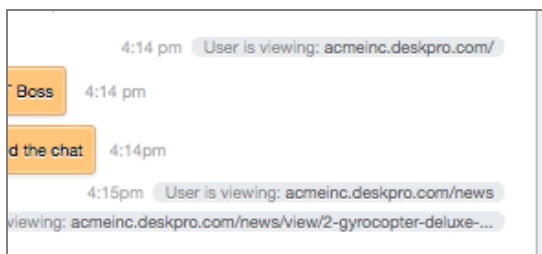
Your replies are shown in gray bubbles.



When a user has read your message, it is marked with a green icon:

You can mouse over the icon to see when they read your message.

You can see what pages the user is viewing on your web portal or website in lines with a gray background. This gives you context for the problem they're describing, and can help you check that they are in the right place while following troubleshooting instructions etc.



You can format your reply in a similar manner to a ticket message. See the [ticket message formatting](#) section for more details.

You can attach files to chat messages just as you can with a ticket reply, except that drag and drop only works with images. Users can also send you files.

Between the formatting bar and the **Send** button are two buttons specific to Chat.



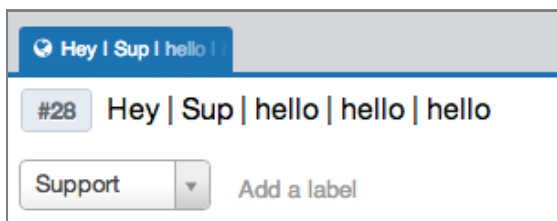
The  button creates a ticket linked to the current chat.

This is useful if you can't resolve the user's issue during the chat and need to track it in the ticket system.

Note that if the user did not enter a valid email address when you started the chat, you must enter one when you create a linked ticket.

The  button ends the chat.

Chat details



At the top of the tab you can see:

- the chat's ID number
- the **department** selected by the user, which you can change
- the label field - you can label a chat as with a ticket or user

Chat visitor information

During the chat you can switch to the **Visitor Information** tab to get details about the user:

- **IP Address**
- **User Agent** (this describes what web browser they're using)
- **Session Start Time** (the time they arrived at your web portal or site in their current browsing session)
- **Session Landing Page** (the first page they arrived at this session)
- **Initial Visit Time & Initial Landing Page** (the time and page they arrived at when they first visited your portal/site, as recorded by browser cookies)

Block user

If a chat user is abusive, trying to waste your time, or should be excluded from chat for some other reason, you can switch to the **Block User** tab and block them for the next 24 hours.

Simply enter a brief description of why you chose to block the user, then click **Block User**.



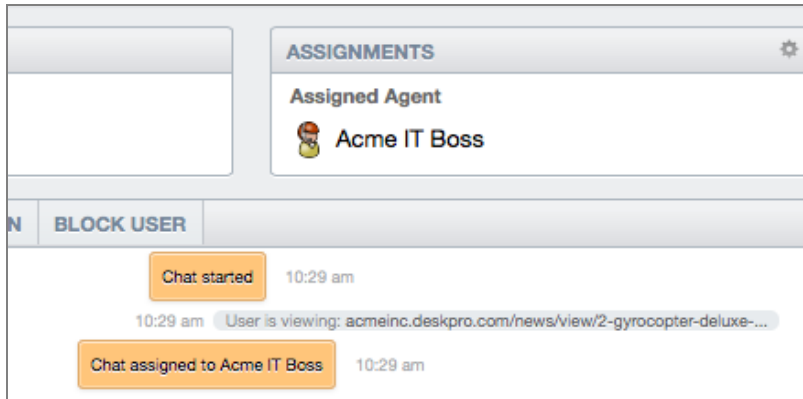
You can optionally select **Block IP address**. This prevents all chat attempts from user's last IP address.

Note that if the user was chatting from a shared network (such as a business, university or wi-fi hotspot), blocking their IP may prevent all users on the network from chatting.

Also, users accessing the internet from home or mobile broadband tend not to have fixed IP addresses.

4.3. Assigning chats

Chats are assigned to agents, just like tickets. A chat is automatically assigned to you when you accept it.



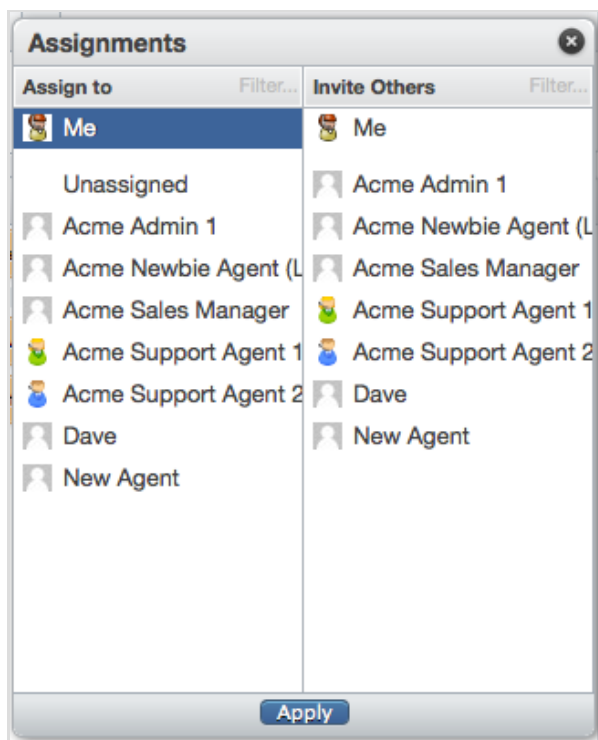
You can see the assigned agent for a chat in the **Assignments** section at the upper right.

You may decide that another agent would be in a better position to deal with a chat that's assigned to you.

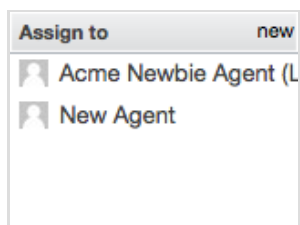
To assign a chat to another agent:

- 1 Click the  at the top right of the **Assignments** section.

- 2 The **Assignments** window opens. In the **Assign to** pane, select an agent.



You can click on **Filter** at the top right of the pane and type to filter the list of agents.

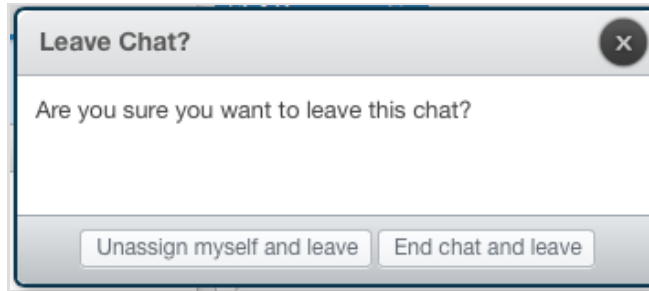


- 3 Click **Apply**.
The chat opens in the content pane of the newly assigned agent's interface. You can also make the chat **Unassigned**.

Note that if you make a chat unassigned, other agents are not notified, so you should be careful not to leave the user waiting.

You can also invite other agents to join a chat using the **Invite Others** pane. This is useful if you want to stay in control of the chat, but you want to get another agent's input.

- 1 Click the  icon at the top right of the **Assignments** section.
- 2 The **Assignments** window opens. In the **Invite Others** pane, select the agent to invite.
- 3 Click **Apply**. Again, the chat opens in the invited agent's interface. If you close the tab of a chat that's assigned to you, you see the **Leave Chat?** warning pop-up - you can choose to either unassign yourself from the chat, or end it.



4.4. Viewing closed and missed chats

You can view chats from the Chat app filter pane.

The screenshot shows the Chat app filter pane with the following sections:

- USER CHAT** (selected)
 - OPEN CHATS**
 - New Chats: 0
 - My Open Chats: 0
 - All Open Chats: 0
 - 1 Acme IT Boss
 - ENDED CHATS**
 - My Chats**: 3
 - Assigned Chats: 16
 - Missed Chats: 7
 - LABELS**
 - LIST (selected) | CLOUD
 - P: panic
 - T: test
- 3 CHATS** (selected)
 - Hi, can you help me understand this error...
 - By Mike | 17¼ hours ago
 - A User <auser@example.com>
 - By A User <auser@example.com> | 18 hours ago
 - Hei
 - By Chat User | 4 weeks ago
 - Showing results 1 - 3 of 3

There are sections for open (active) chats, ended chats, and filtering chats by label.

Open chats filter

The **Open Chats** section shows current active chats:

- **New Chats** - chats that have not yet been assigned.
- **My Open Chats** - open chats assigned to you.
- **All Open Chats** - all chats, sub-filtered by agent.

Ended chats filter

The **Ended Chat** section shows:

- **My Chats** - ended chats that were assigned to you
- **Assigned Chats** - ended chats that were assigned to an agent
- **Missed Chats** - chats where the user left before an agent was assigned

When you view ended chats in the content pane, there is a **Create ticket** button in the **Person** section of the chat record. This creates a ticket linked to the chat.

#23 A User <auser@example.com>

Sales

▼

Add a label

PERSON

 A User
auser@example.com

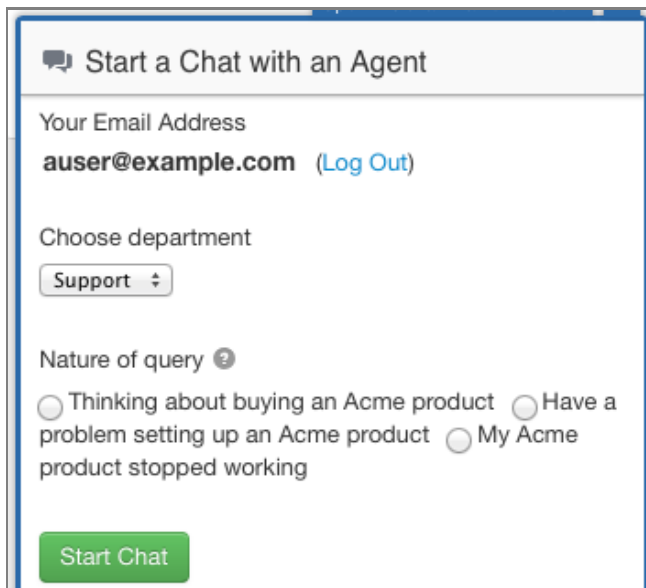
Create ticket

You can use this to quickly open a ticket linked to a missed chat and maintain communication with the user.

4.5. Custom chat fields

Your admins can set up custom chat fields to record extra information about chats. These work like [custom ticket fields](#).

The user can enter values for custom fields (that aren't agents-only) when they initiate the chat.



Start a Chat with an Agent

Your Email Address
auser@example.com (Log Out)

Choose department
Support

Nature of query ?
☐ Thinking about buying an Acme product ☐ Have a problem setting up an Acme product ☐ My Acme product stopped working

Start Chat

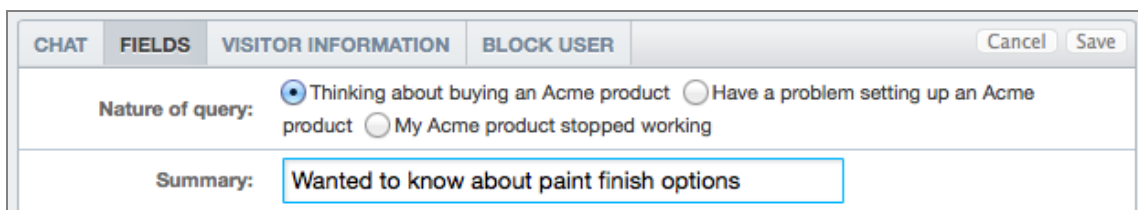
In this example, **Nature of query** is a custom field.

If your helpdesk has any custom chat fields, chats you view in the content pane have a **Fields** tab. Select it to view the custom fields.



CHAT	FIELDS	VISITOR INFORMATION	BLOCK USER
Nature of query: Thinking about buying an Acme product			
Summary: None			

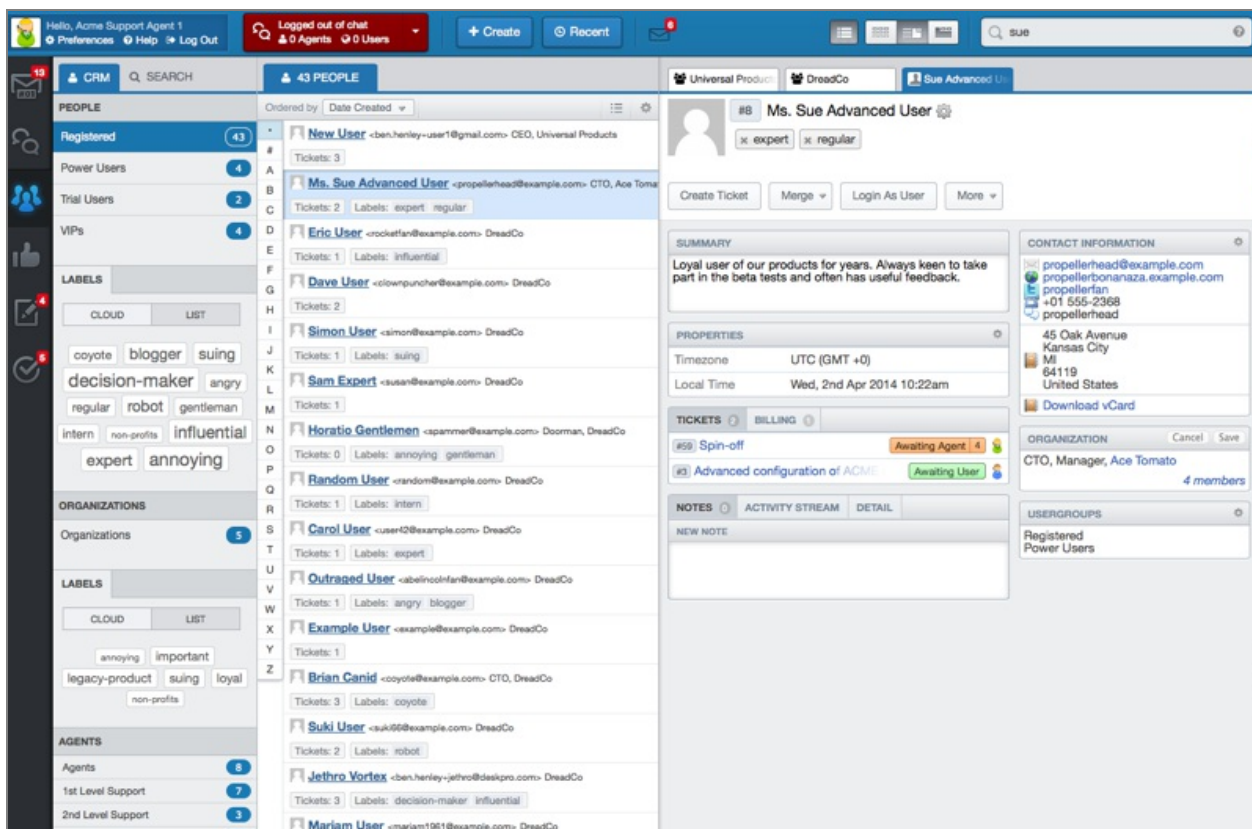
Click the  at upper right to edit the custom fields.



CHAT	FIELDS	VISITOR INFORMATION	BLOCK USER
Nature of query: ☒ Thinking about buying an Acme product ☐ Have a problem setting up an Acme product ☐ My Acme product stopped working			
Summary: Wanted to know about paint finish options			

5. CRM

The CRM (*Customer Relationship Management*) app enables you to view and manage your helpdesk users.



DeskPRO can also record details of user **organizations**: this is typically the company the user works for.

You can also control the actions each user is allowed to do on your helpdesk by adding them to **usergroups**. Belonging to a usergroup grants the user a set of **permissions**.

The usergroups available are defined by your admins, based on the needs of your enterprise. For example, you might want to limit access to the chat system to paying users only. Your admins would implement this by setting up a "paying users" usergroup, and disabling chat for users who do not belong to it.

Your admins can add extra properties to users and organizations using **custom fields**.

You can also use the CRM app to view details of your agents and teams.

5.1. Filtering and sorting users and organizations

You can use the filter pane on the left of the CRM app to filter users and organizations.

Filtering users

The **People** section at the top of the filter pane lets you filter by **usergroup**. The result of your selection is shown in the list pane.

The screenshot shows the CRM app interface. On the left, the 'PEOPLE' section is active, displaying user groups: Registered (43), Power Users (4), Trial Users (2), and VIPs (4). Below these are 'LABELS' and tabs for 'CLOUD' and 'LIST'. The main pane shows a list of 4 people, ordered by 'Date Created'. The list includes:

- Ms. Sue Advanced User** <propellerhead@example.com> Ace Tomato (Tickets: 2, Labels: expert, regular)
- Sam Expert** <susan@example.com> DreadCo (Tickets: 1)
- Prof. Loyal User** <loyal-t@example.za> (Tickets: 1, Labels: decision-maker, expert, influential)
- Rev. Neil User** <nuser@example.au> Universal Products (Tickets: 0, Labels: blogger, expert, influential)

The bottom of the list pane shows 'Showing results 1-4 of 4'.

The number of users in each usergroup is displayed on the right of the filter pane.

You can also filter users with **labels**.

The screenshot shows the 'LABELS' section of the filter pane. It displays a grid of labels: influential, suing, annoying, intern, angry, decision-maker, regular, gentleman, blogger, robot, coyote, expert, and non-profits. Below this grid, a list of users is shown, each with their associated labels:

- A: angry
- B: blogger
- C: coyote
- D: decision-maker
- E: expert
- G: gentleman
- I: influential, intern
- R: regular, robot
- S: suing

Click on a label to open the users matching that label in the list pane.

The **Cloud** view shows labels in bigger text the more tickets they have. You can also select a **List** view by clicking on the List tab.

Filtering agents

You can filter agents by **team** at the bottom of the filter pane.

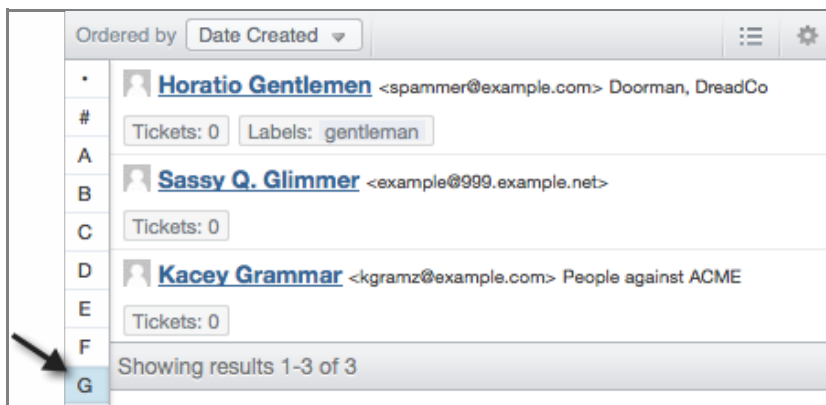
AGENTS	
Agents	8
1st Level Support	7
2nd Level Support	3
Sales Team	2
Support Managers	3

Click on a team to see its agents in the list pane.

Filtering people alphabetically

When the list pane is showing a list of people, you can further filter it alphabetically, as in an address book, using the alphabet strip to the left of the list pane.

Click a letter to show people who have a surname beginning with that letter, and who match the filter selected in the filter pane.

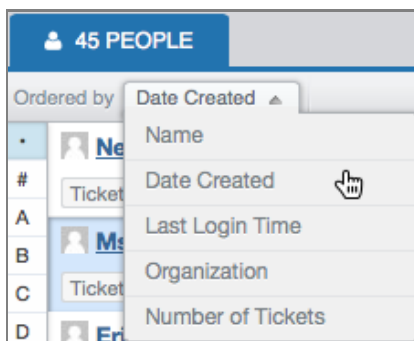


In this example, the G has been selected, so only users with surnames beginning with G are being shown.

To clear your letter selection, click the dot at the top of the strip.

Ordering people

When you're viewing a list of people (agents or users) in the list pane, you can change how they're ordered with the **Ordered by** pull-down.



You can choose to order them by:

- **Name** (first name, alphabetically)
- **Date created** (oldest account at top)
- **Last login time** (most recent at top)
- **Organization** (users with no organization at the top, then alphabetically)
- **Number of tickets** (users with most tickets at the top)

Viewing a table of people

You can view the contents of a list of people as a table using the  icon at the upper right of the list pane.

People

Name	Email Address	Organization	Position	Labels	
 Ms. Sue Advanced User	<propellerhead@example.com>	Ace Tomato		expert regular	
 Eric User	<rocketfan@example.com>	DreadCo		influential	
 Dave User	<clownpuncher@example.com>	DreadCo			
 Simon User	<simon@example.com>	DreadCo		suing	
 Susan Expert	<susan@example.com>	DreadCo			1
 Horatio Gentlemen	<spammer@example.com>	DreadCo	Dooman	gentleman	0
 Random User	<random@example.com>	DreadCo		intern	1
 Carol User	<user42@example.com>	DreadCo		expert	1
 Outraged User	<abelincolinfan@example.com>	DreadCo		angry blogger	1
 Example User	<example@example.com>	DreadCo			1
 Brian Canid	<coyote@example.com>	DreadCo	CTO	coyote	3
 Suki User	<suki66@example.com>	DreadCo		robot	2
 Jethro Vortex	<ben.henley-jethro@deskpro.com>	DreadCo		decision-maker influential	3

Ordered by: Date Created ▲

Display Options

Name

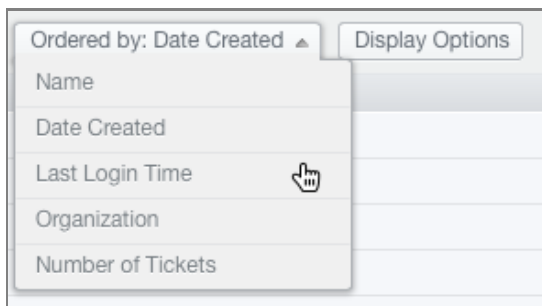
Date Created

Last Login Time

Organization

Number of Tickets

You can choose how the list is ordered and which fields to display using the controls at the top right.



5.2. User records

Click a user in the list pane to open their details in the content pane.

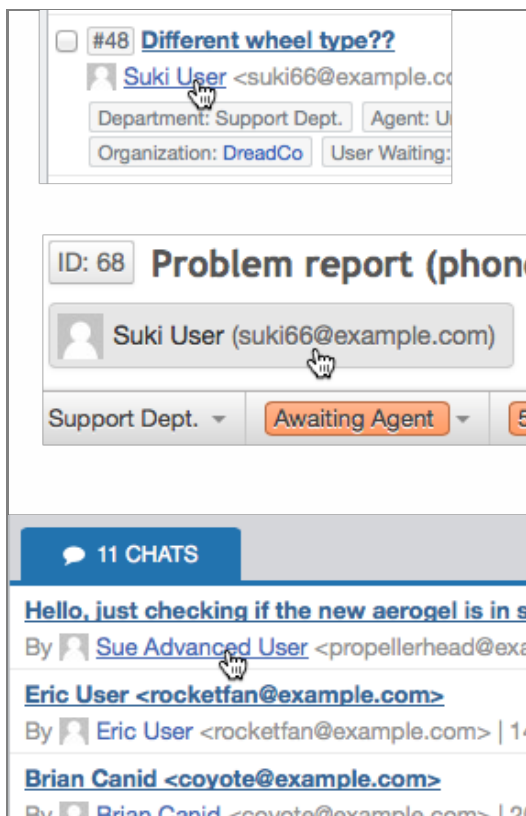
The screenshot displays the user record for 'Ms. Sue Advanced User' (ID #8). The interface includes a top navigation bar with 'Ace Tomato', 'Universal Products', and the user's name. Below the header, there are buttons for 'Create Ticket', 'Merge', 'Login As User', and 'More'. The main content area is divided into several sections: 'SUMMARY' (describing the user as a loyal beta tester), 'PROPERTIES' (showing timezone, local time, and language), 'TICKETS' (listing two tickets: 'Spin-off' and 'Advanced configuration of ACME'), 'NOTES' (with a 'NEW NOTE' button), 'CONTACT INFORMATION' (including email, phone, and address), 'ORGANIZATION' (listing 'CTO, Manager, Ace Tomato' with 4 members), and 'USERGROUPS' (listing 'Registered Power Users').

Callouts highlight the following features:

- User ID:** Points to the user ID '#8'.
- Labels:** Points to the 'expert' and 'regular' labels.
- Edit User:** Points to the gear icon next to the user name, with the instruction: 'Click gear or double-click name to edit'.
- Edit Properties:** Points to the gear icon in the 'PROPERTIES' section, with the instruction: 'Click here to edit timezone, language, custom fields'.
- Export Contact Info:** Points to the 'Download vCard' link in the 'CONTACT INFORMATION' section.

Users have a unique ID number, just like tickets do.

In most parts of the agent interface, you can access a user record by clicking on the user's name.

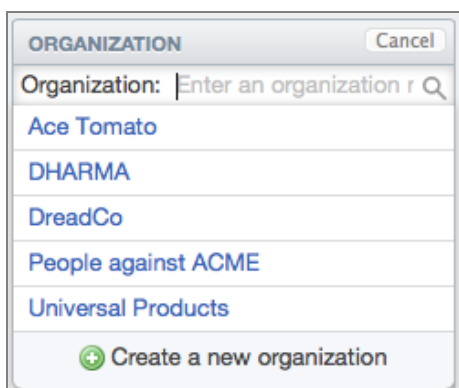


If you do this from the content pane, the user record is displayed as a pop-up window to the left. To open it in the content pane, click the green arrow at the top left of the record.



Setting user organization

Click the  icon at the top right of the **Organization** section to select the user's organization.



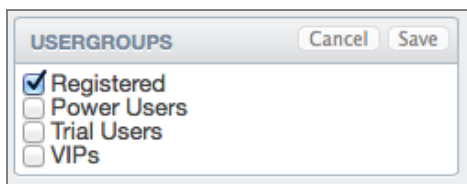
You can type into the text field at the top of the list to filter the list.

You can also **Create a new organization**.

See the [Organizations](#) section for more details.

Setting usergroups

Click the  at the top right of the **Usergroups** section to set usergroup memberships.



Select the checkboxes for the usergroups the user should be in.

Click **Save** when you are done.

See the [Usergroups](#) section for more details.

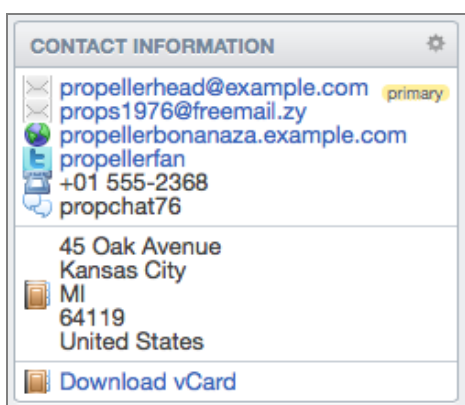
User summary

The **Summary** field is a text field that you can use to record general information about the user, any special requirements they have, and so on.

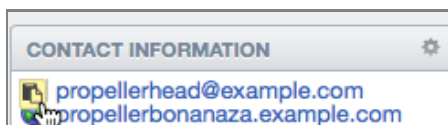
Simply click on it and enter or edit text, then click **Save**.

User contact information

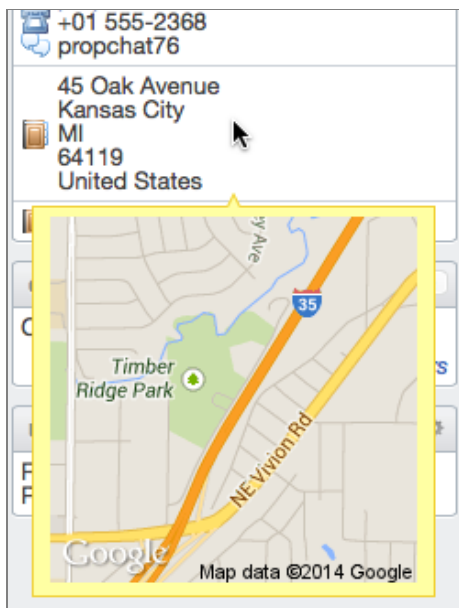
The **Contact Information** section shows the contact details available for the user.



If you mouse over the user's email address, a yellow clipboard icon appears. Click on the icon to copy the address to your clipboard.



Mouse over the user's mailing address to see a map.



Click the  icon at the upper right to edit the user's contact information.

Contact Information For Sue Advanced User

Email Address

propellerhead@example.com Add a label

props1976@freemail.zy Add a label

add another

Phone

Phone + 01 555-2368 Add a label

add another

Website

http://propellerbonanaza.example.com Add a label

add another

IM

Other propchat76 Add a label

add another

Twitter

propellerfan Add a label

add another

LinkedIn

LinkedIn URL Add a label

add another

Facebook

Add a Facebook profile

Address

45 Oak Avenue Add a label

Kansas City MI 64119

Save

User contact information can include:

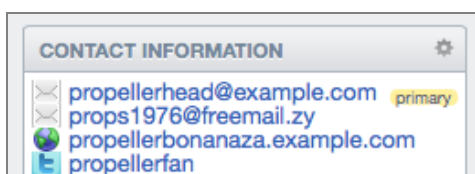
- **Email address** (every user must have at least one email address)
- **Phone number**
- **Website**
- **IM** (instant messaging) account name
- **Twitter** username (no need to include the @ symbol)
- **Linkedin** account (enter the full profile web address e.g. `http://www.linkedin.com/in/sueuser7/5/43`)
- **Facebook** profile (enter the full profile web address e.g. `http://www.facebook.com/sue.advuse`)
- **Address** (mailing address)

Users with multiple email addresses

You can enter more than one email address for a user.

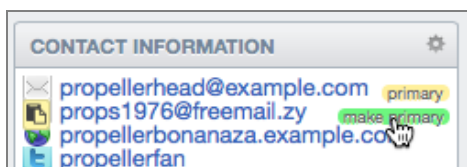
However, DeskPRO will only send ticket notifications to the **primary email address**.

When the user has more than one email address, the primary one is marked with a yellow tag:



In this example, `propellerhead@example.com` is the primary address.

To set the primary address, mouse over another email address until a green **make primary** tag appears:



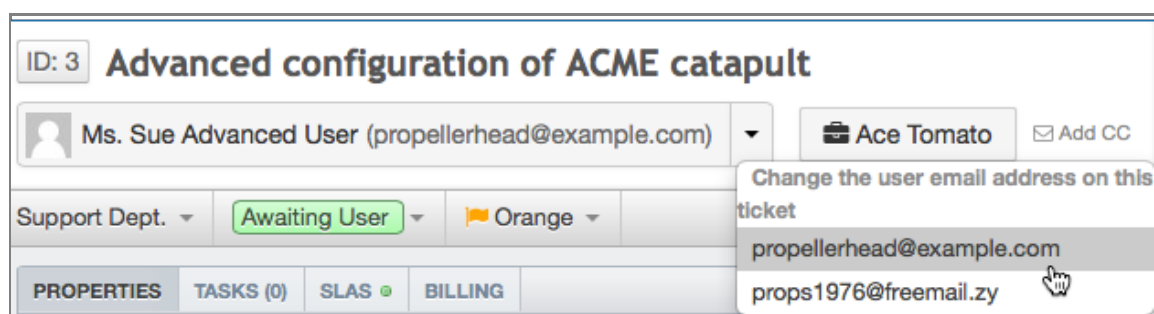
Click the green tag to make that address the primary one.

If the same person sends emails from two different addresses, DeskPRO might set up two separate user accounts for that person. You can fix this by [merging users](#).

Changing user email address for a ticket

If the user has more than one email address, you can change the address where they receive notifications for a particular ticket.

You can do this from a ticket in the content pane: use the pull-down control on the right of the user box.

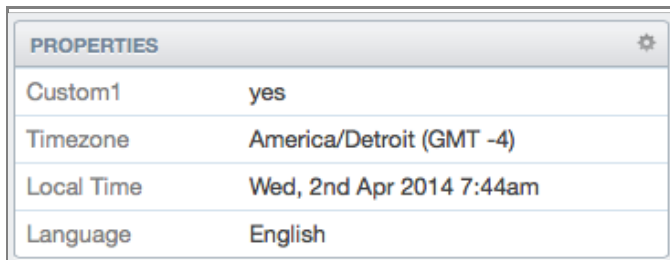


This control is only present if the user has more than one email address.

User properties

The **Properties** section records information about user timezone and language.

This is also where you can view and edit any **custom user fields** your admins have set up.

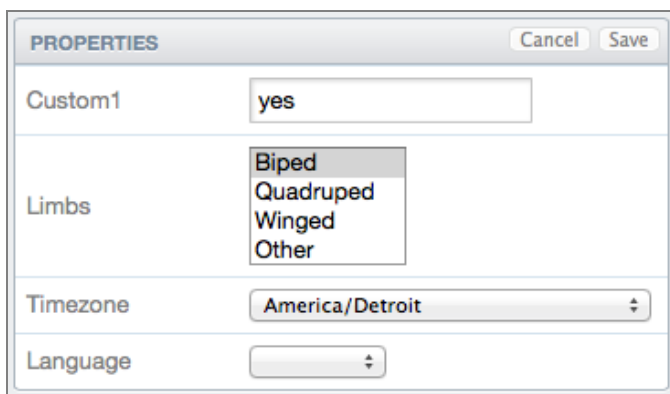


PROPERTIES	
Custom1	yes
Timezone	America/Detroit (GMT -4)
Local Time	Wed, 2nd Apr 2014 7:44am
Language	English

The **Local Time** for the user is displayed here, based on their timezone.

If no language is shown, the user is receiving content in the default user language of your helpdesk.

To change properties, click the  icon at the top right of the Properties area.



PROPERTIES		Cancel	Save
Custom1	yes		
Limbs	Biped Quadruped Winged Other		
Timezone	America/Detroit		
Language			

Click **Save** when you have finished editing the fields, or **Cancel** if you don't want to save your changes.

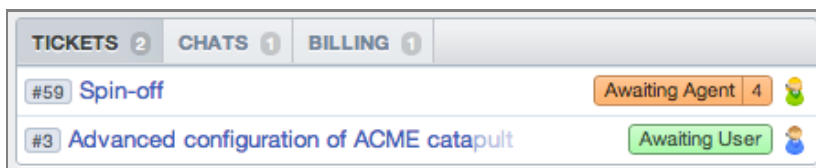
Note that custom fields with no value set for the user will not be displayed until you click the gear (in this example, **Limbs** is such a field).

Set the user's local timezone with the **Timezone** control. This affects times shown on email notifications etc.

If multiple languages are enabled on your helpdesk, you can set the user's preferred language with the **Language** control. This will change the language of their email notifications and the text they see when they're logged in to the web portal. (If you don't see the language you want, your admins may need to install a language pack).

User history

Below the user Properties section, you can see the user's tickets, chats and billing history.



TICKETS 2	CHATS 1	BILLING 1
#59 Spin-off Awaiting Agent 4		
#3 Advanced configuration of ACME catapult Awaiting User		

You can add notes at the bottom left of the user record.

NOTES 1	ACTIVITY STREAM	DETAIL
 Acme Support Agent 1: On holiday until tomorrow. 30 minutes ago		
NEW NOTE		

This is separate from the [ticket notes](#) system, and does not support **@mentions**.

Unlike the **summary**, you can enter more than one note about the user.

Click on the **Activity stream** tab to see a more detailed activity history.

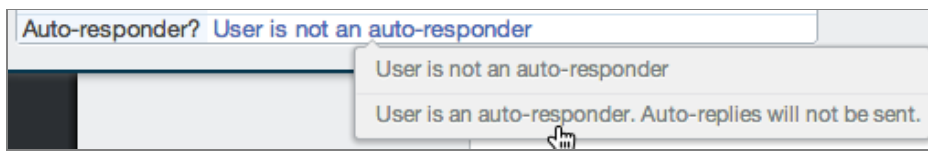
NOTES 2	ACTIVITY STREAM	DETAIL
Created a chat: Hello, just checking if the new aerc 5 minutes ago		
Submitted a ticket: Spin-off 7 days ago		
Replied to a ticket: Crashing! 26 days ago		
Submitted a ticket: Crashing! 26 days ago		
Replied to a ticket: Advanced configuration of ACM 26 days ago		
Submitted a ticket: Another highly technical questio 26 days ago		
Submitted a ticket: Advanced configuration of ACM 26 days ago		

Click on the **Detail** tab to see technical details about the account and the user's login activity.

NOTES 2	ACTIVITY STREAM	DETAIL
ID	8	
Created	Thur, 6th Mar 2014 12:54pm (27 days ago)	
Creation By	User was created by submitting an email to the helpdesk	
Last Login	Wed, 2nd Apr 2014 1:44pm (13 minutes ago)	
Online Now	Wed, 2nd Apr 2014 1:43pm (15 minutes ago)	
Last Activity	Wed, 2nd Apr 2014 1:48pm (10 minutes ago) on page acmeinc.deskpro.com	
Landing Page	User landed on page acmeinc.deskpro.com and came from acmeinc.deskpro.com	
IP Address	141.101.88.9	
Browser Agent	Mozilla/5.0 (Macintosh; Intel Mac OS X 10_9_2) AppleWebKit/537.74.9 (KHTML, like Gecko) Version/7.0.2 Safari/537.74.9	
Auto-responder?	User is not an auto-responder	

The **Auto-responder?** option is used to avoid email loops. If the user's email account sends an automatic response, such as a vacation message, DeskPRO may reply with its own automatic response, triggering a further response from the user account, and so on.

If this starts happening, click on the blue **User is not an auto-responder** text and select the option to disable DeskPRO's auto-replies.



5.3. Usergroups

You may want some users to have a different level of access to the helpdesk than others.

For example, your company may want to restrict chat access to users who pay for a premium support package, or accept feedback only from experienced users of your products.

DeskPRO supports this by giving each user **permission** levels: these determine what areas of the web portal the user can see, and what helpdesk functions they can use.

You control a user's permissions by assigning them to **usergroups**. Each usergroup grants the user a set of permissions.

Your admins decide what usergroups your helpdesk has and what permissions they grant.

Here are some example usergroups a helpdesk might have:

- **Registered** - all users who are [registered](#) with the helpdesk
- **Power Users** - advanced users who know your product well
- **Trial Users** - users who are evaluating your product with a free trial
- **VIPs** - users who pay extra for priority support

Some example permissions:

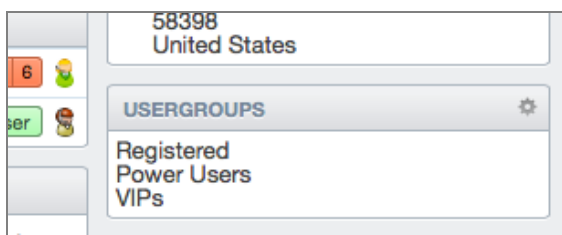
- **Power Users** can submit comments without agent approval in the web portal
- **Trial Users** can access chat with the sales department
- **VIPs** can access chat with the support department

Note that a user can belong to multiple usergroups, and is granted the combined permissions of them all.

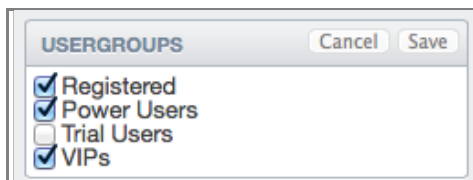
In the example above, if User A is a member of **Power Users** and **VIPs**, they can submit comments without agent approval *and* access chat with the support department.

Setting usergroups

Open a user in the content pane and look at the **Usergroups** section (lower right) to see their usergroups.



Click the  icon to see all usergroups.



Use the checkboxes to select the user's usergroups. Click **Save** to keep your choices, or **Cancel** to close the section without saving your changes.

You can also see usergroups in the filter pane of the CRM app.

PEOPLE	
Registered	45
Power Users	8
Trial Users	7
VIPs	8

Note that usergroups with no members will not be shown in the filter pane.

Guest and registered users

By default, even guest users - those who haven't been registered in the system, for example by signing up for an account through the web portal - have some permissions. For example, most helpdesks allow anyone browsing the web portal to view news items and Knowledgebase articles without logging in.

Guest permissions are set by admins using a usergroup called **Everyone**.

Most DeskPRO helpdesks have a **Registered** usergroup which grants permissions to all registered users (the requirements to be registered vary depending on the helpdesk setup, from simply emailing a ticket address to registering and being approved by an agent).

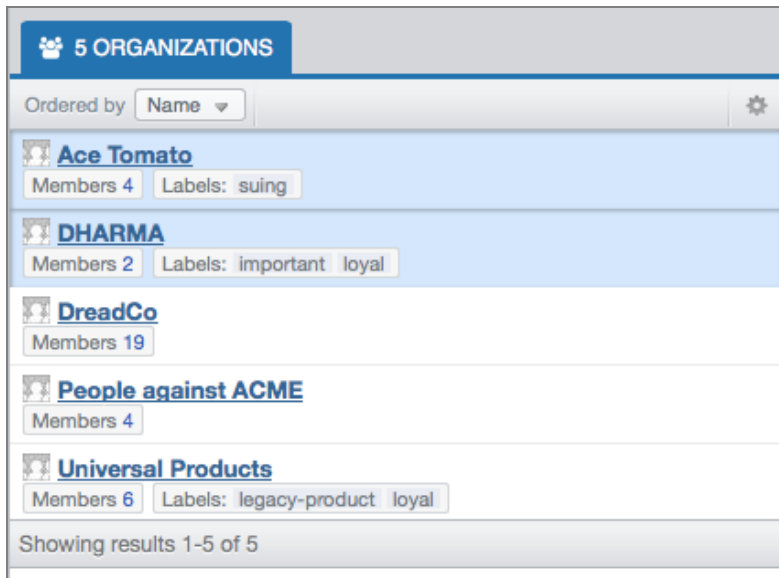
5.4. Organizations

Organizations are used to record the company (or other enterprise) to which each user belongs.

In most cases, that will be the user's employer, but it might be the charity they volunteer for, or the reseller they bought your product from, if that is what is relevant to your helpdesk.

Each user can only belong to a single organization.

To view all the organizations set up in your helpdesk, select the **Organizations** filter.



Organization details

Open an organization in the content pane to view its details.

You can edit the organization's name by double-clicking it.

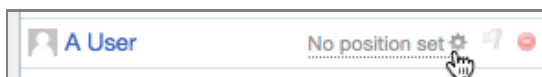
The summary field and labels work as for a user.

Organization members

The **Members** section shows you all the users who belong to the organization. Click a user's name to view their details in a pop-up window.

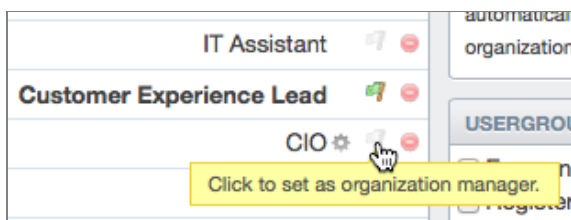
You can record the **position** (job role) of each user in an organization.

If a user doesn't have a position yet, click on the **No position set** text to add one:



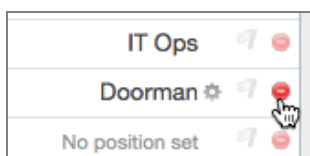
You can click on a user's position to edit it.

Use the small flags on the right to set which users are **organization managers** who can see all tickets from their organization. See the [Organization managers](#) section for more details.



The **Tickets** and **Chats** tabs let you view all the tickets or chats associated with any member of the organization.

To remove a user from an organization, click on the red icon at right. This does not delete the user.

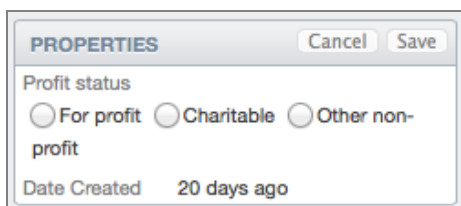


Organization properties

The **Properties** section is where you view and edit any custom organization fields your admins have set up.

For example, you could have a **Profit status** field to track if the organization is for profit or non-profit.

Click the  at the top right of the Properties section to edit the fields.



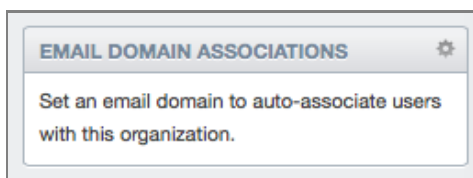
Click **Save** when you have finished editing the fields, or **Cancel** to leave them as they were.

Note that custom fields with no value set for the organization will not be displayed until you click the gear icon.

The Properties section also displays the date when the organization was created.

Automatically associating users with organizations by email domain

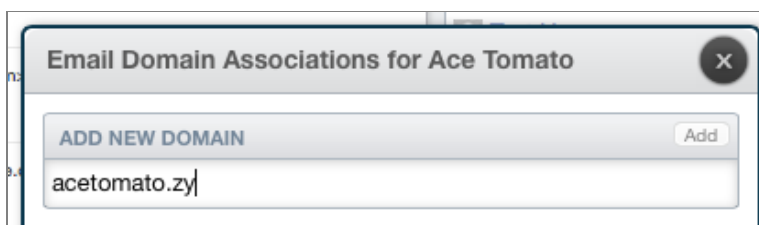
The **Email domain associations** section allows you to automatically associate users with the organization, based on their email address.



For example, suppose you want to have all new users with an `@acetomato.zy` address automatically added to the "Ace Tomato" organization.

Click the  at the top right of the section.

The **Email Domain Associations** pop-up window opens.



Enter the domain e.g. `acetomato.zy`.

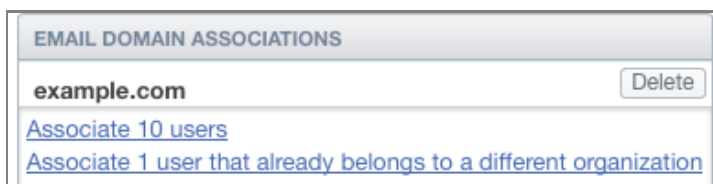
Click **Add** to associate it with the organization.

You can now add another domain. For example, you may want to associate the `.com` and `.co.uk` domains for an international organization.

When you are finished adding domains, close the window with the **X** at top right.

Note that email domain associations only apply to users who register after you have set up the association.

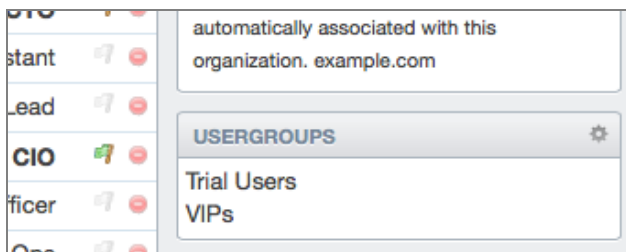
However, if there are existing users whose addresses match the domain, DeskPRO will prompt you to associate them with the organization.



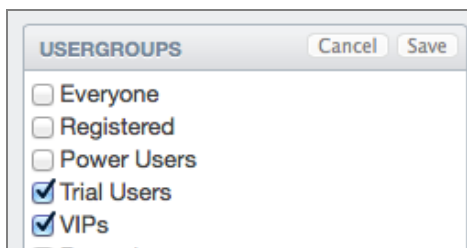
In this example, clicking **Associate 10 users** would associate all existing users who do not belong to an organization with example.com.

Linking organizations to usergroups

You can add all the members of an organization to a usergroup using the **Usergroups** section at the lower right of the organization record.



Click the  to set which usergroups are linked with the organization.



Linking an organization to a usergroup in this way is convenient when the permissions users should have changes an organization-wide basis.

For example, suppose the **VIPs** usergroup is for users who are entitled to VIP-level support, and the Ace Tomato Company decides to pay for VIP support for all its employees. You *could* find all users who belong to the "Ace Tomato" organization and change their usergroup, but it's much better to link the usergroup to the organization:

- 1 | it's quicker
- 2 | any future Ace Tomato users will automatically join the VIPs usergroup

If you try to remove a user from a usergroup that is linked to their organization, it won't work.

What if a user was already a member of a usergroup *before* it was linked to their organization? Consider the following situation:

- 1 | To start with, User A is the only member of **VIPs** from the DreadCo organization.
- 2 | DreadCo is then linked to the **VIPs** usergroup. *Every* DreadCo user is now in **VIPs**.
- 3 | The link between DreadCo and **VIPs** is removed.

Is User A removed from **VIPs** at step 3? No; DeskPRO remembers the difference between users who were added to a usergroup directly, and users who were added through a link to their organization.

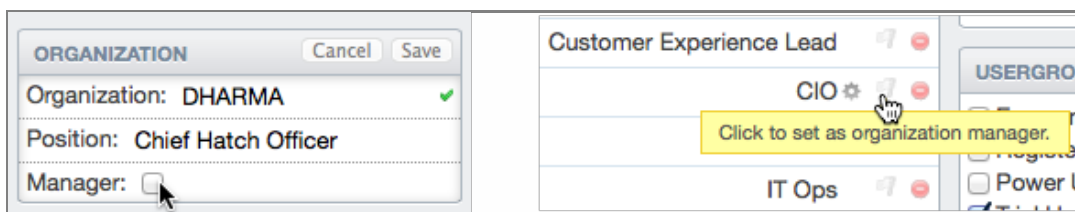
Organization managers

The **organization managers** feature allows specific users to oversee all the tickets for their organization.

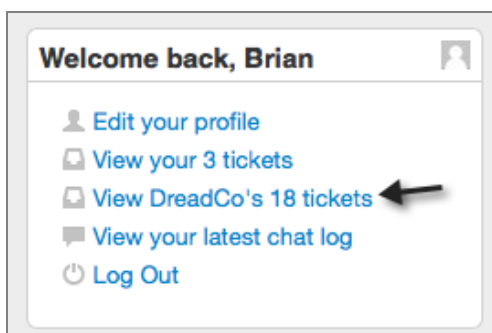
Normally, a user can only see tickets that they've created or interacted with.

However, an organization manager can see any ticket associated with their organization, and can even automatically be added as a participant to any new tickets.

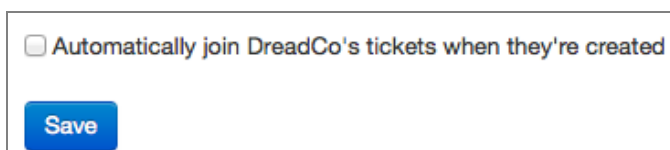
You can see and edit manager status on the user's record in the organization section, as well as from the organization's record.



An organization manager can view all of their organization's tickets via the web portal.



A manager can choose to automatically join any tickets for their organization when they're created. They can set this option on the **Edit your profile** page.



5.5. New users

Your helpdesk may be configured so that a user account is created automatically when the user submits a ticket via email or the web (an **open helpdesk**).

However, users may be required to **register** before submitting content.

Your admins may enable **validation** of new users when they register.

There are two separate forms of validation:

- 1 **Email validation:** users required to prove that their email address is valid by clicking on a link in an email
- 2 **Agent validation:** new users need to be manually approved by an agent.

If there are users who need to be validated, you will see them in a **Pending** section at the top of the CRM app filter pane.

CRM	SEARCH
PENDING	
Awaiting Agent Validation	1
Awaiting Email Validation	0

The user's tickets will be held in the **Awaiting Validation** filter in the Tickets app until the user is validated.

TICKETS	LABELS	FLAGGED
Awaiting Agent		11
Awaiting User		24
Resolved		6
Awaiting Validation		1
Spam		0
Recycle Bin		~5

To approve a user who needs **agent validation**, simply find them in the list pane or content pane and click the **Approve** button.

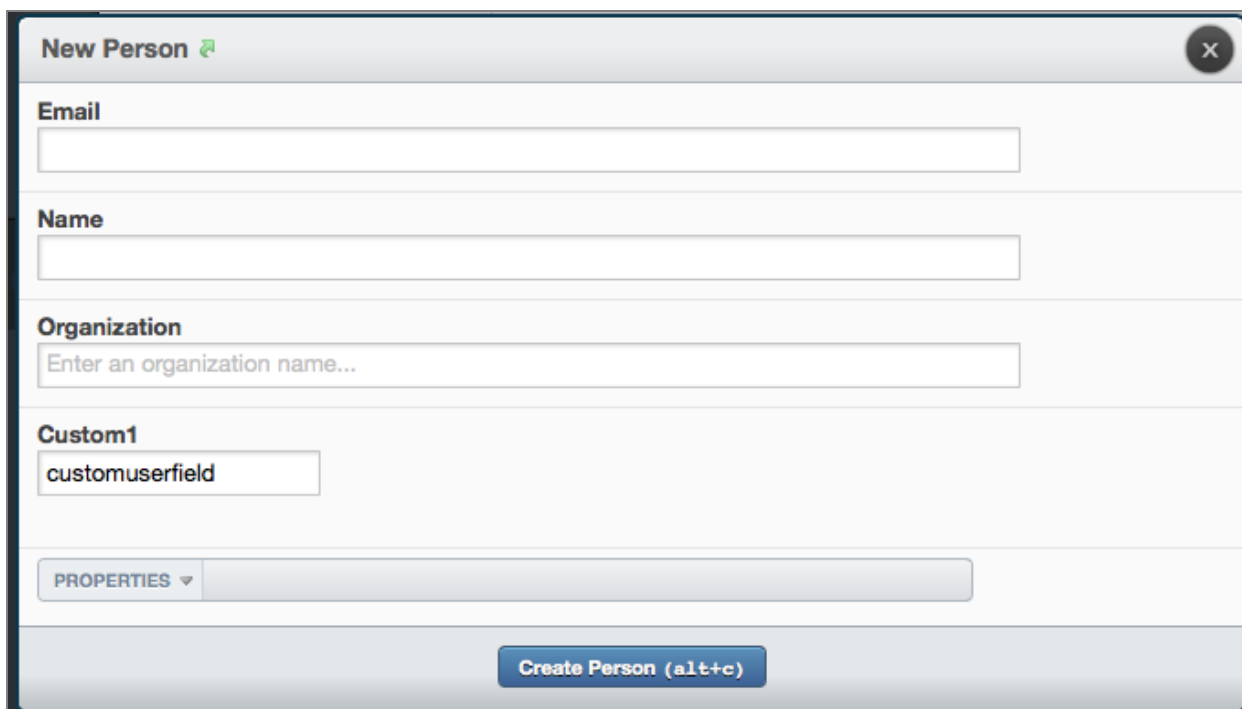


Creating a user

You can also create a user account from scratch with the **Create** button.

Select the **New Person** option.

The New Person window opens.



The screenshot shows a 'New Person' dialog box. It has a title bar with the text 'New Person' and a close button. Below the title bar are four input fields: 'Email', 'Name', 'Organization', and 'Custom1'. The 'Email' field is empty. The 'Name' field is empty. The 'Organization' field has a placeholder text 'Enter an organization name...'. The 'Custom1' field has a value 'customuserfield'. Below the fields is a 'PROPERTIES' dropdown menu. At the bottom is a 'Create Person (alt+c)' button.

You must enter an email address for the user in the **Email** field.

Name and **Organization** are optional.

If your helpdesk uses **custom user fields**, they may be required or optional.

Users may also be able to log in with their Facebook, Twitter or Google accounts.

User rules

DeskPRO can automatically associate users with organizations based on their email address.

For example, your helpdesk could add all users with a `@dreadco.zy` address to the DreadCo organization.

See the section on [email domain associations](#) for how you can set this up.

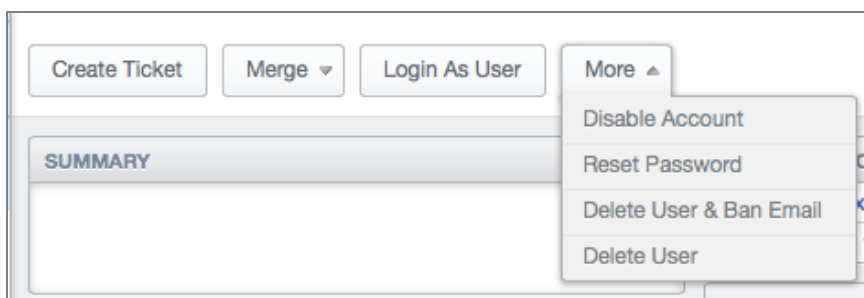
Your admins can also set up rules which automatically add new users to usergroups.

These user rules only apply to new users created after the rule was set up.

You can use [linking an organization to a usergroup](#) to associate all of an organization's new and existing users with a usergroup.

5.6. User actions

When you open a user record in the content pane, you can carry out the following actions.



Create ticket

This opens a pop-up window where you can create a ticket assigned to the user.

Merging users

If you have duplicate user records for the same person, you can combine them into one record using the **merge** action.

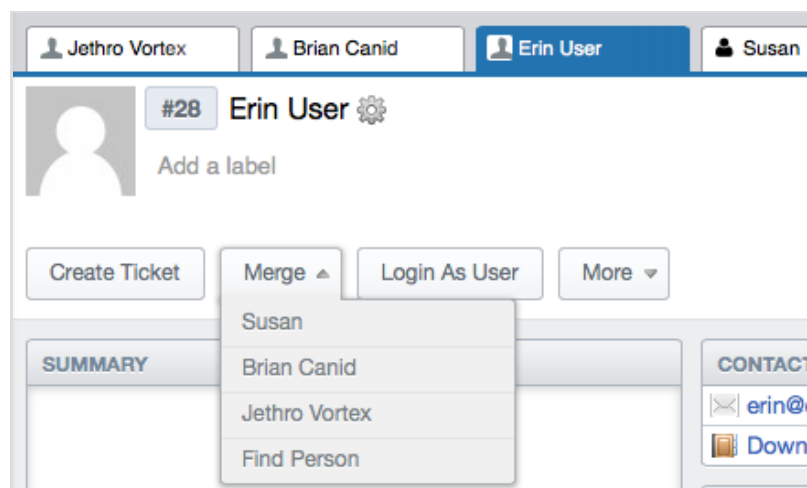
When users merge, some properties will be overwritten. For example, a user can only have one organization, so the merged user can keep the organization from only one of the originals.

You can pick which user will overwrite the other user's properties.

The labels from both users will be applied to the new user.

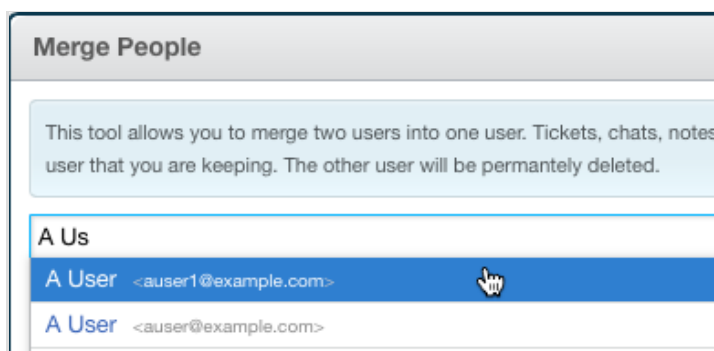
1

Click **Merge**.



2

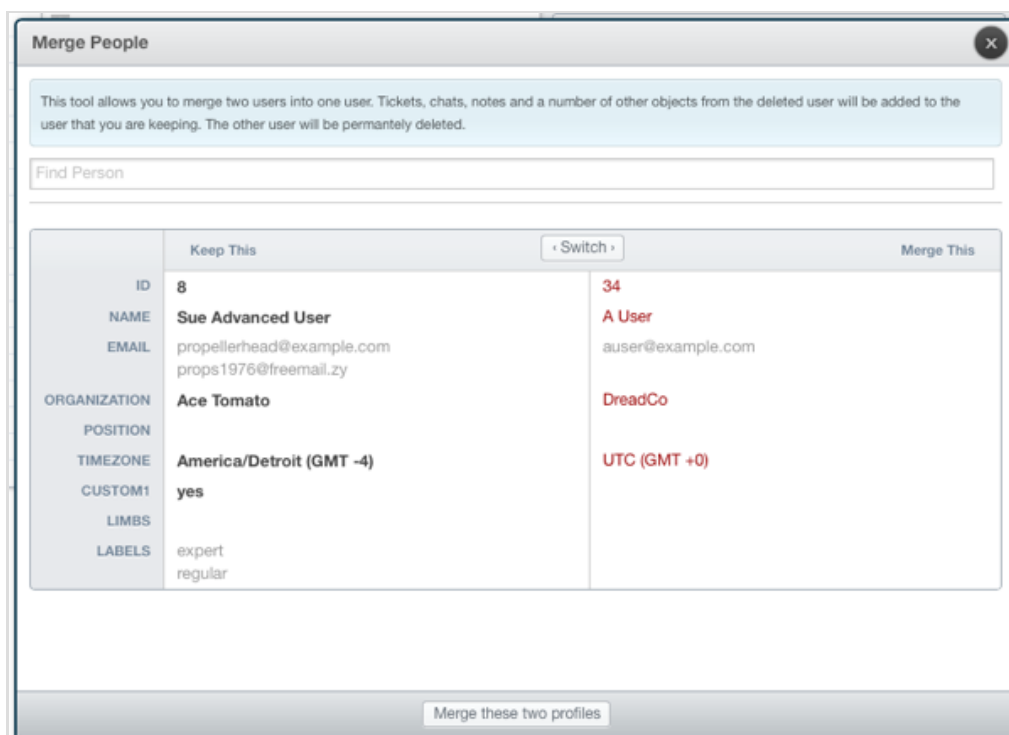
Any users whose records are currently open are offered as targets for the merge. Click the user you want. If the user you want is not shown, click **Find Person**. The **Merge People** window opens.



Type part of the user's name or email address to filter user records, then click the user you want.

3

Click **Switch** to pick which user's properties to keep where there's a conflict. The values shown in red will be overwritten.



4

Click **Merge these two profiles** to complete the process.

Login as user

Click the **Login As User** button to access the user's web portal account.

This can be useful when troubleshooting; you can see exactly what the user does when they view their tickets and chats on the web portal.

Disable account

Use the **Disable Account** option from the **More** pull-down menu to temporarily disable the user's account.

When the account is disabled the user's profile image is marked with an X.



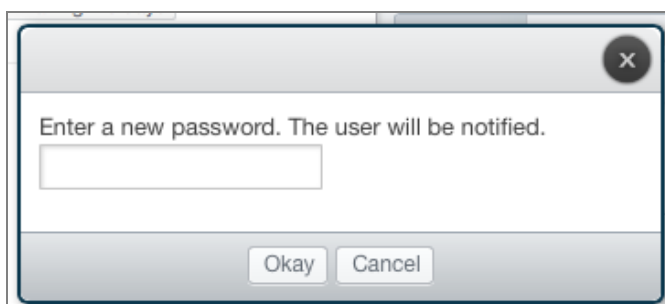
The user will not be able to log in or create tickets.

They will still show up in searches and filters. You can still set them as the user for existing tickets.

Select **Enable Account** from the **More** pull-down to restore the account to normal.

Reset password

Use the **Reset password** option from the **More** pull-down menu to change the user's password.



The password you enter will replace the user's old password. The new password will be emailed to the user, so it is important that you have the right email address for them.

Deleting users

Use the **Delete User** option from the **More** pull-down menu to permanently delete the user's account.

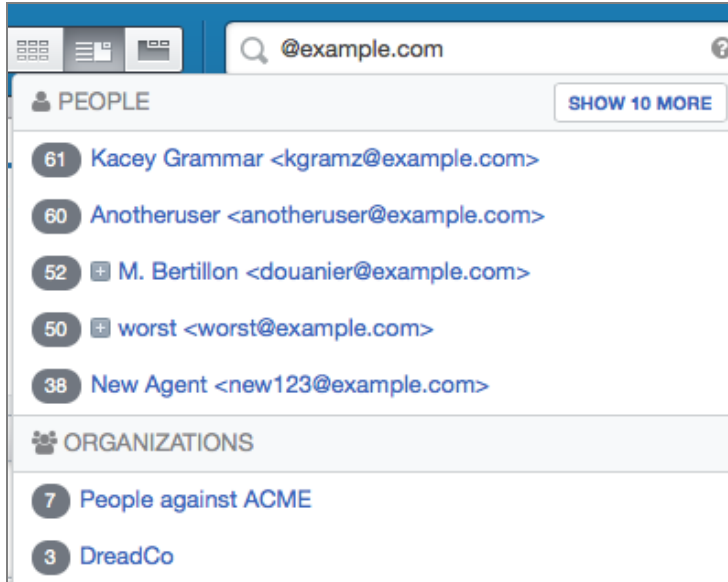
Deleting a user will also delete all their tickets.

The **Delete User & Ban Email** option does the same thing, but also prevents the user registering again with the same email address.

5.7. Searching for users and organizations

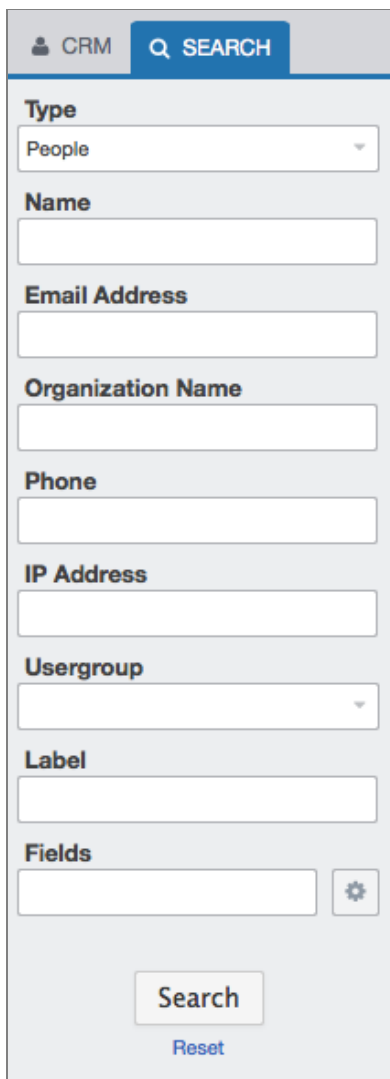
You can search for users and organizations from the Quick Search bar at the top right of the agent interface.

Quick search will match what you enter to the name, ID number or label of a user or organization. It will show you users whose email addresses match your search, and organizations where any user's email address matches.



Advanced search for users and organizations

You can access advanced search for users or organizations from the filter pane when the CRM app is selected.

A vertical search form for CRM. At the top, there is a header bar with a user icon and 'CRM' on the left, and a blue 'SEARCH' button with a magnifying glass icon on the right. Below the header, the form contains several input fields: 'Type' (a dropdown menu with 'People' selected), 'Name', 'Email Address', 'Organization Name', 'Phone', 'IP Address', 'Usergroup' (a dropdown menu), 'Label', and 'Fields' (a text input with a gear icon to its right). At the bottom of the form, there is a 'Search' button and a 'Reset' link in blue text.

Use the **Type** field to select if you want to search for **People** (users) or **Organizations**.

For users, you can search by:

- Name
- Email Address
- Organization Name
- Phone
- IP Address
- Usergroup
- Label
- Fields - enables you to search by custom user fields if your helpdesk has any

For organizations, you can search by:

- Name
- Email Domain
- Label
- Fields - search by custom organization fields if your helpdesk has any

Note that if you enter values for more than one of these properties, the results will include only users/organizations which match all your requirements.

6. Publish

The **Publish** app is used to manage the content on your web portal.

There are four different types of content you can manage through Publish:

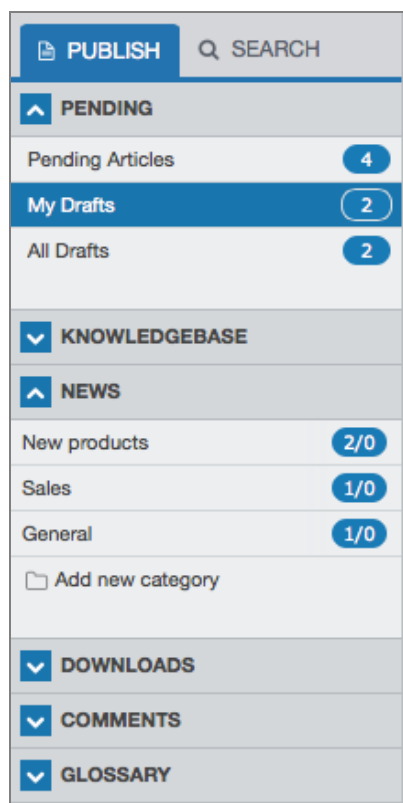
- **Knowledgebase articles** - rich-text articles that can include images or attachments; they typically address a common user problem or explain how to do something
- **News posts** - designed for announcements about your company, new products or product updates, etc.
- **Downloads** - files you want to make available to your users; for example, manuals, brochures or software drivers
- **Glossary words** - definitions of terms you use in **articles** to help users understand them

Feedback also appears on the web portal, but is managed in the [Feedback](#) app, rather than in Publish.

Portal content items (articles, news posts or downloads) can have the following **statuses**:

- **Published** - item is visible to users on the web portal
- **Unpublished** - item not visible to users
- **Draft** - item not visible to users, appears in the **Pending** section of the agent interface
- **Archived** - status only available once an article has been **published**; removes item from visibility on web portal; use this for outdated content

You can see an overview of your portal content using the filter pane.



Content is organised into [categories](#). In this example, you can see that posts in the News section are divided into categories called **New products**, **Sales** and **General**.

At the top of the filter pane is the **Pending** section which shows:

- **pending articles** that need to be written
- any content (articles, news posts, downloads) saved with **Draft** status

You can expand and collapse the different sections to show only the items that are relevant to you.

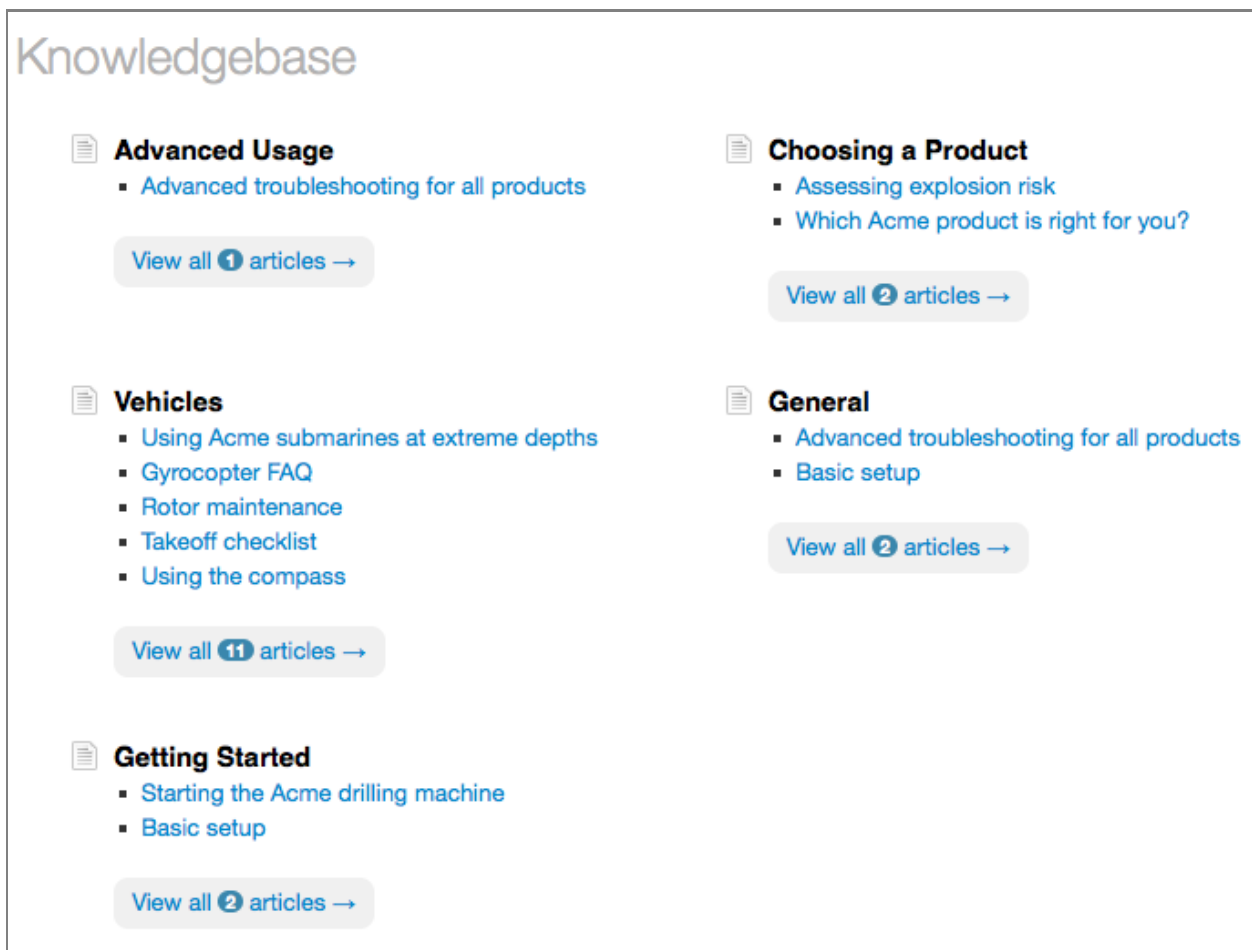
Click the  icon to collapse a section.

Click the  icon to expand a collapsed section again.

6.1. Organizing portal content into categories

You can help your users find what they're looking for by organizing your articles, posts and files using categories.

Items in the same category are displayed together on the web portal. In this example, **Advanced Usage**, **Choosing a Product**, **Vehicles**, **General** and **Getting Started** are all categories.



You can limit access to each category by **usergroup** - for example, you could set it so that only users in the **Experienced** usergroup could see articles in the **Advanced Usage** category.

You can create one category inside another, giving you a **nested** category structure. This is useful to subdivide large categories.

In this example, the **Vehicles** category has four sub-categories inside it.

Knowledgebase: Vehicles

There are 4 sub-categories

**Submarines**

- [Using Acme submarines at extreme depths](#)
- [Using the compass](#)
- [Submarine basics](#)

[View all 3 articles →](#)

**Robot Horse**

- [Using the compass](#)
- [Horse FAQ](#)

[View all 2 articles →](#)

**Gyrocopters**

- [Gyrocopter FAQ](#)

**Jetpacks**

- [Using the compass](#)

Nested categories are also used to help users navigate the portal.

[🏠](#) → [Knowledgebase](#) → [Vehicles](#) → [Submarines](#)

You can have as many layers of nested categories as you want.

In the filter pane, there are two numbers next to a category: the first shows the number of items in the top level of the category, and the second the total number inside it, including in subcategories.

▶ Vehicles	1/11
▼ Submarines	3
— Deep subs	0
— Robot Horse	2
— Gyrocopters	4
▶ Jetpacks	0/1
— Navigation	1

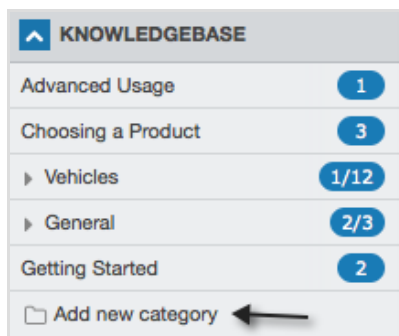
In the example above, there is one article in the Vehicles category, and ten more articles in subcategories below Vehicles.

The category structures for **Knowledgebase**, **News** and **Downloads** are all separate.

Adding a new category

You can create new categories from the filter pane of the **Publish** app. Use the **Add new category** link at the bottom of the relevant section.

1 Click the **Add new category** link.



2 The **Add Category** window opens.

A screenshot of the 'Add Category' window. It has a title bar 'Add Category'. Below it is a 'PROPERTIES' section. The 'Title' field contains 'Submarine beta program'. The 'Parent Category' dropdown menu is set to '-- Submarines'. Under the 'Permissions' section, there are five checkboxes: 'Everyone' (unchecked), 'Registered' (unchecked), 'Power Users' (checked), 'Trial Users' (unchecked), and 'VIPs' (checked). There is also an unchecked checkbox for 'Renewing soon'. At the bottom right of the window is a 'Save' button.

- Enter a **Title** for the category to identify it to agents and users
- If you want the category to be nested, select the **Parent Category** that it should be inside
- Use the **Permissions** checkboxes to select which usergroups can see the category.

3 Click **Save**.

If the **Everyone** usergroup is selected, anyone can see articles in the category without logging in. When **Everyone** is selected, it overrides all the options below - deselecting other usergroups has no effect, because all users have permission to view the category through their membership of **Everyone**.

If the **Registered** usergroup is selected, all users who are registered on the helpdesk and logged in can see the category. Again, when **Registered** is selected, deselecting the usergroups below has no effect.

Editing, deleting and reordering categories

To edit an existing category, click on it in the filter pane.

The items in the category are displayed in the list pane. Click on the name of the category at the top.

The screenshot shows the DeskPRO interface. On the left, the 'PUBLISH' tab is active, and the 'KNOWLEDGEBASE' filter pane shows the 'Choosing a Product' category selected with 5 items. The main list pane displays three articles under the 'CHOOSING A PRODUCT' category:

- Which Acme product is right for you?** (Published, Author Acme IT Boss, Date Created Mar 12 2014)
- Assessing explosion risk** (Published, Author Acme IT Boss, Date Created Mar 12 2014)
- To the maximum possible extent: Acme legal liability disclaimers and you** (Published, Author Acme IT Boss, Date Created Apr 10 2014)

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Category' dialog box for the 'Choosing a Product' category. It includes the following sections:

- DELETE CATEGORY:** A button labeled 'Delete Category'.
- EDIT CATEGORY:**
 - Title:** A text field containing 'Choosing a Product'.
 - Permissions:** A list of checkboxes for user groups: Everyone, Registered, Power Users, Trial Users, VIPs, and Renewing soon. All are checked.
- REORDER CATEGORY (DRAG & DROP):** A list of categories for reordering: Advanced Usage, Choosing a Product, Vehicles, General, and Getting Started.
- Save:** A button at the bottom right.

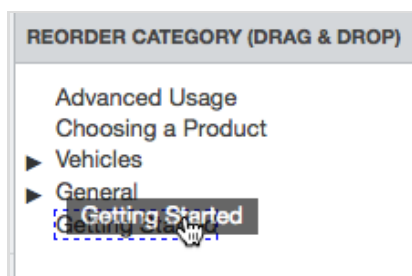
You can use the **Delete Category** button to remove the category altogether. You must remove all items from the category (either deleting them or putting them in different categories); otherwise deleting will not work.

In the **Edit Category** section, you can edit the category **title** or change which usergroups have **permissions** to view the category.

You can use the **Reorder Category** section to change the display order of categories. This lets you change the order of all the categories.

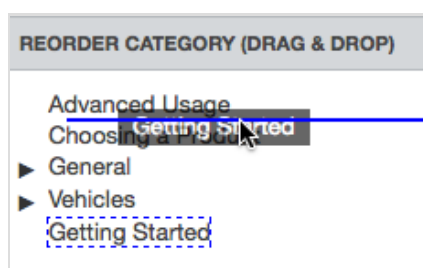
For example, suppose you decide it would make more sense to have the "Getting Started" category appear before "Advanced Usage".

- 1 Click on the category, and drag it with the mouse button held down.

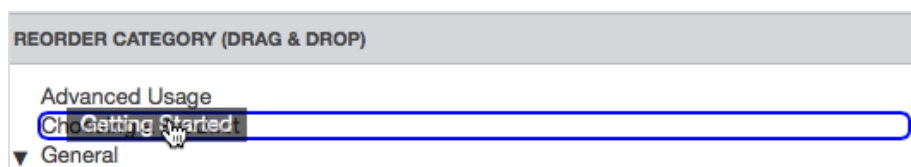


- 2 Drag the category to where you want it to go.

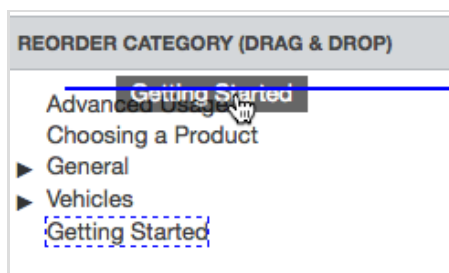
- A horizontal blue line means you are going to put it *between* categories



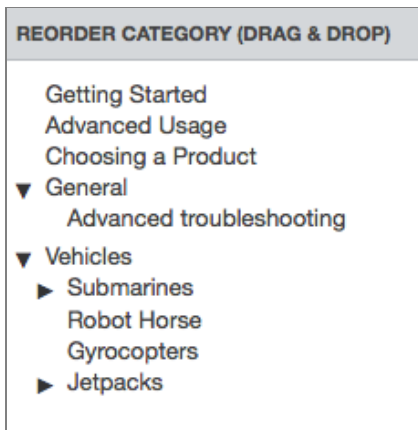
- A blue box means that you are going to put it *inside* another category.



- 3 Let go of the mouse button when the category is where you want it.

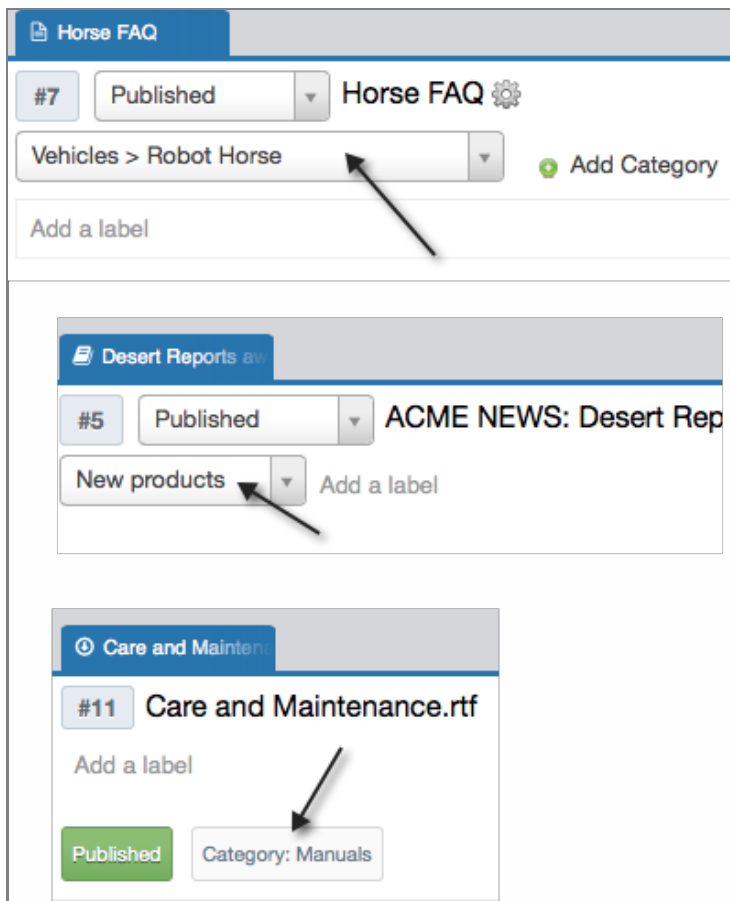


You can expand nested categories by clicking on the triangle icons. They also expand automatically when you drag something over them.



Adding items to categories

When you open a **Knowledgebase** article, **News** post or **Downloads** file in the content pane, you can change its category using these controls:



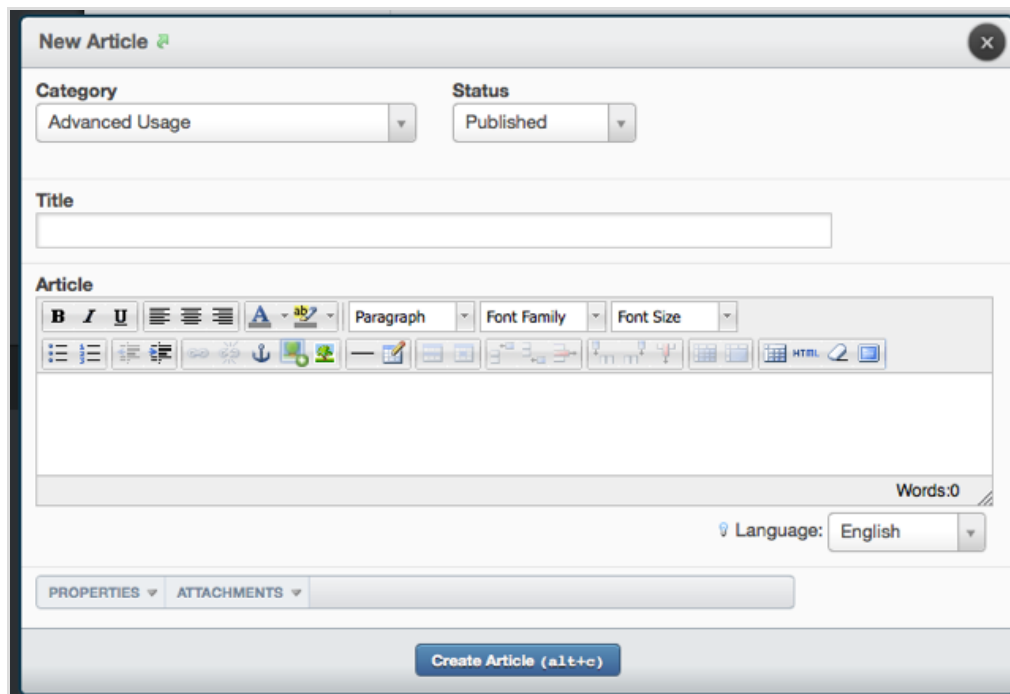
Note that a Knowledgebase article can belong to more than one category, but News posts and Downloads files can't. See the [Editing article categories](#) section for details.

6.2. Creating a Knowledgebase article

To create an article from scratch:

1 Select the **New Article** option from the **Create** button in the toolbar.

2 The **New Article** window opens.



3 Select a **Category** that the article will appear in. You can add extra categories later.

4 Choose the **Status** the article should have when you save it.

- **Published** - article visible to users on the web portal, appears in the **Knowledgebase** section of the filter pane
- **Unpublished** - article not visible to users, still appears in the **Knowledgebase** section of the filter pane
- **Draft** - article not visible to users, appears in the **Pending** section (under **My Drafts** for articles you create)

Saving a new article as **draft** is useful if you don't want to publish it straight away; for example, if you want to get other agents to check it over before you publish it. Because draft articles appear in the **Pending** section, saving them with draft status makes them easier to find.

5 Enter a **Title**, and then write the article in the rich text editor.

- The editing controls are an expanded version of the controls found in the **Tickets** message editor. See the section [Knowledgebase article editing controls](#) for more details.

6 Click **Properties** to add a label to the article.

Click **Attachments** to attach a file to the article.

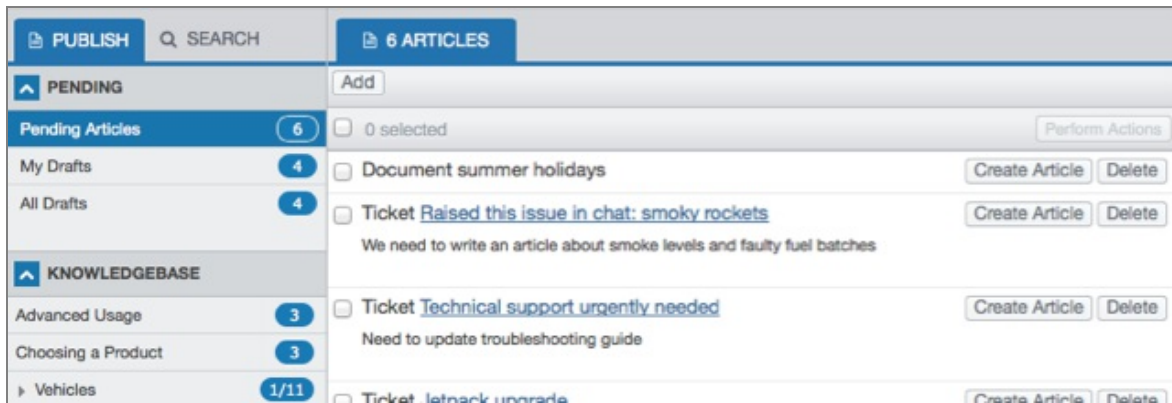
7
8

Click **Create Article** to save the article with your chosen status.

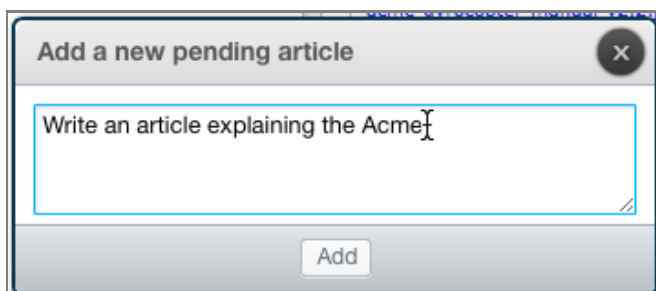
Pending articles

Pending articles are a way to keep track of which articles need to be written.

Select the **Pending Articles** filter (at the top of the **Pending** section) to view all pending articles.



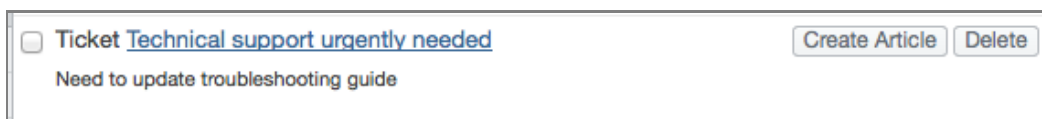
In this view, you can use the **Add** button at the top left of the list pane to create a new pending article.



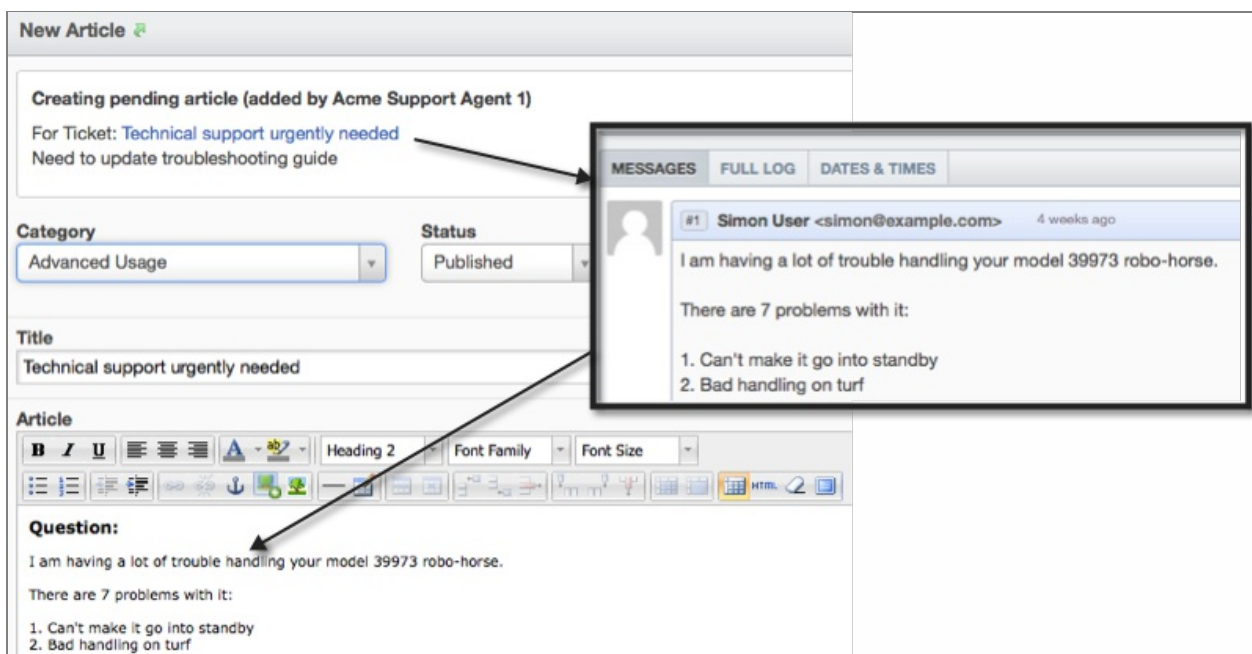
Enter a brief description of the article and click **Add**.

Often an article that needs to be written will be about an issue that has come up in a ticket (or maybe a series of tickets). So a better way to make a pending article is to find a related ticket and use the [Create a new pending article](#) action available from the ticket **Actions** menu.

A pending article created this way is linked to the ticket.

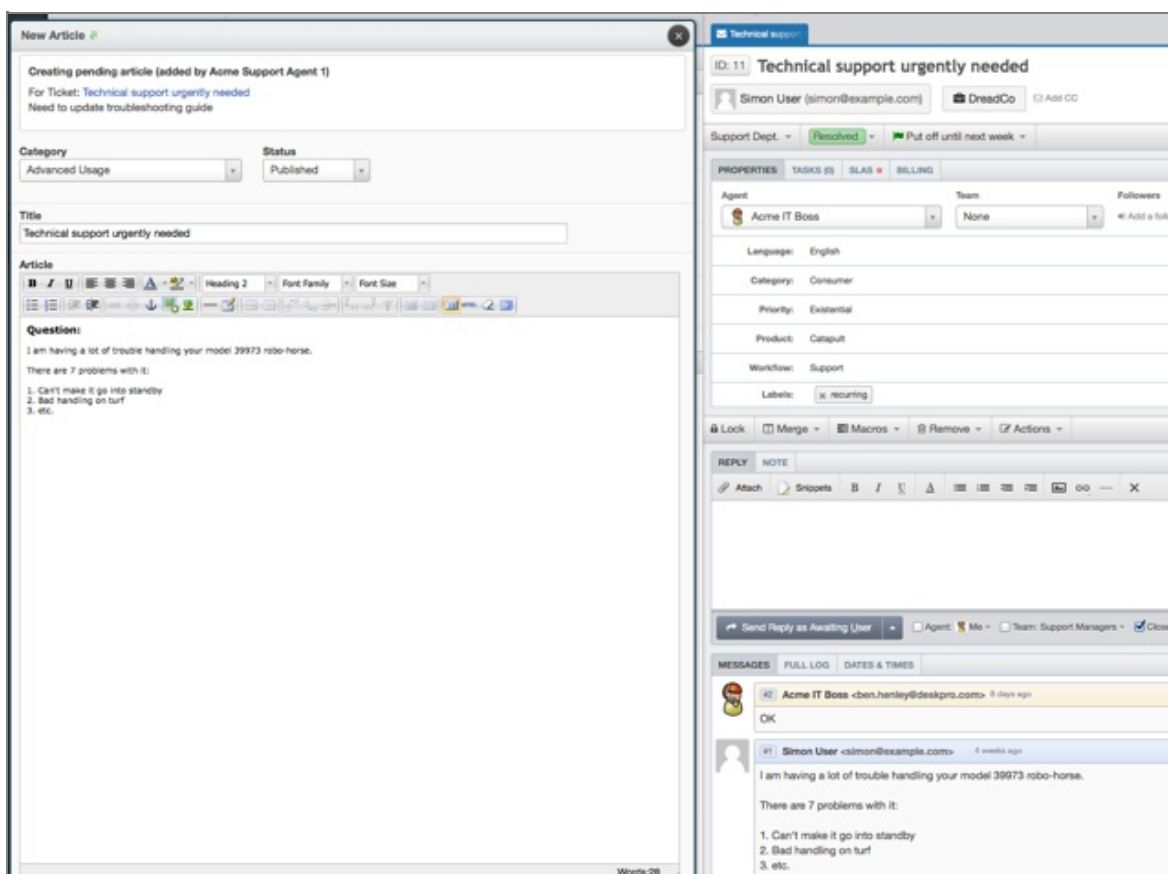


When you click **Create Article**, the new article takes the title of the original ticket, and the first message from the ticket is inserted into the article, formatted as a question.



Of course, you can edit the content from the ticket as you write the article.

If you want to refer to more details of the original ticket, click the link to it at the top of the new article window to open it in the content pane. The **Create Article** window opens in a pop-out to the left of the content pane, so you can see both the article and the ticket at the same time.

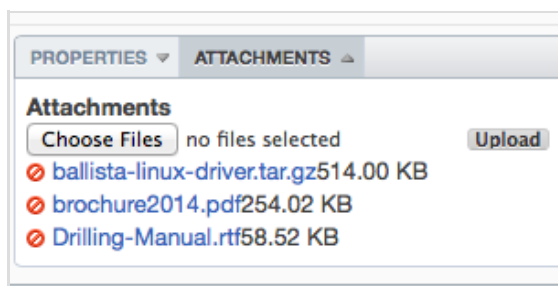


Adding attachments and images to a Knowledgebase article

Note that when editing an article, you can't use drag and drop to add attachments or images as you can with a ticket message.

You can attach a file to the article using the **Attachments** section at the bottom.

- 1 Click **Choose Files** and select the attachment(s) you want. You can upload multiple files at once by holding down **Ctrl/Cmd**.

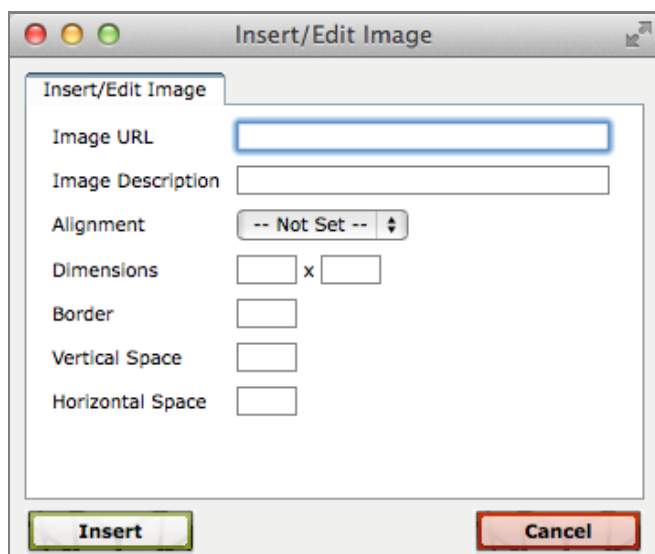


- 2 Click **Upload**.

You can insert an image into the text of an article, use the  button.

Do not use  to attach non-image files. It may look like it has created a link, but the link won't work for users.

You can use the  button to embed an image from the internet into your article.



Be wary about embedding images from servers your company doesn't control. The content of the image displayed in your article could change without warning.

Knowledgebase article editing controls

Icons	Function
	make text bold, italic or underlined
	make text left-aligned (default), centred or right-aligned

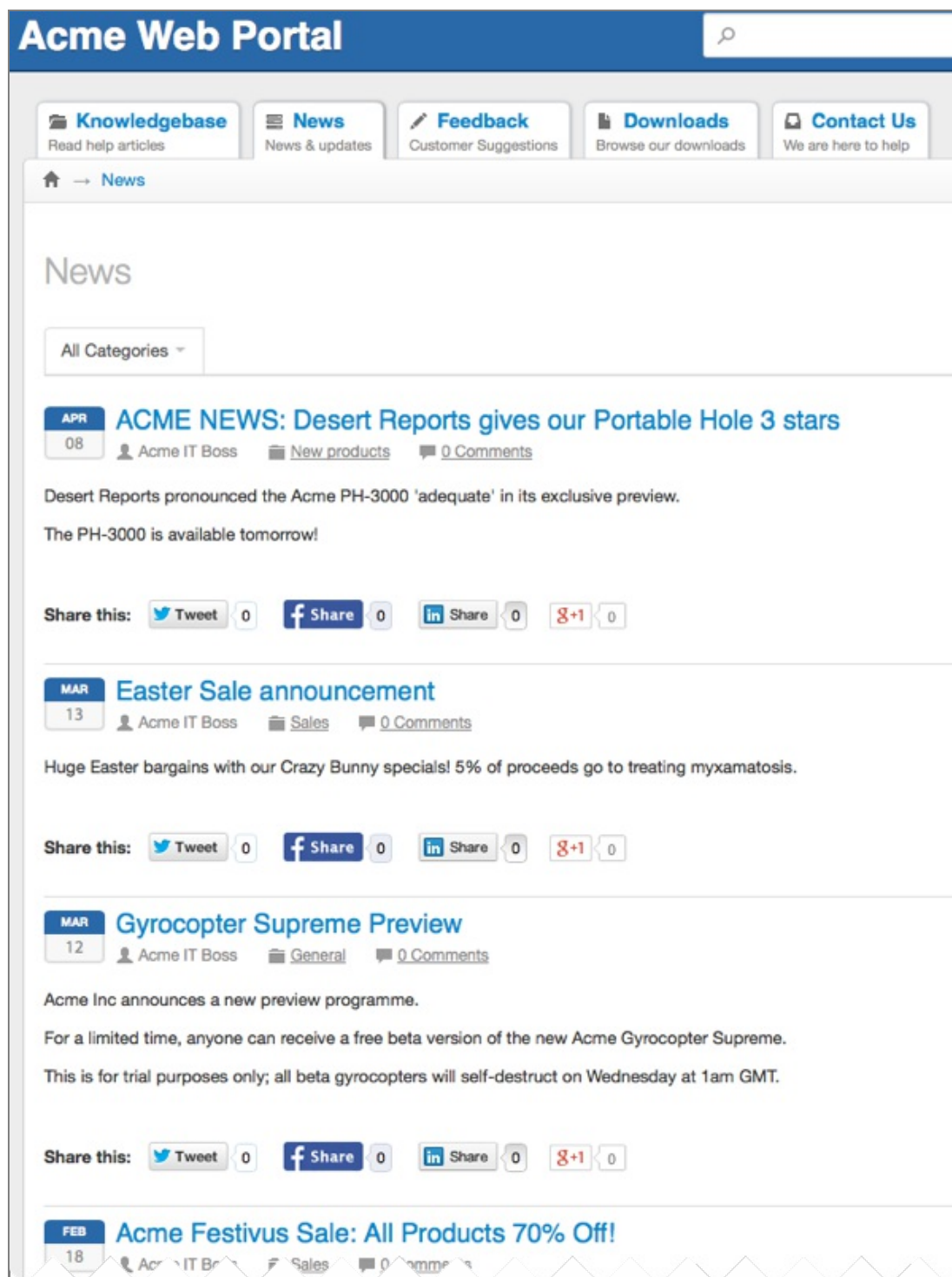
Icons	Function
	set the text color, set a background color (giving a highlighter effect)
	apply styles
	select custom font settings
	make bulletpoint lists or ordered lists
	indent paragraphs or decrease indent
	add or remove links; add an anchor; insert an image; hotlink or edit images
	add a horizontal rule; add a table
	table editing options
	toggle table guidelines; view raw HTML; remove formatting; toggle full screen editor

6.3. News posts

News posts are intended for communicating information which is time-sensitive, like a new product announcement or details of a holiday sale.

In contrast, Knowledgebase articles are for content which will be useful for a long period of time, like a product troubleshooting guide. If the information in an article is likely to be stale within a week or two, it may be better as a news post.

News posts are shown on the web portal in reverse chronological order, like blog posts.



They have sharing buttons to encourage your users to promote them on social media.

You can make a news post using the **Create** button in the toolbar.

News posts contain rich text content. The process of editing and publishing them is the same as for creating Knowledgebase articles.

Remember that your news post is only visible once you save it as **Published**.

News posts can only belong to one category (but news categories can still be nested).

6.4. Downloads

A **download** is a file you want to make available to your users. It might be a PDF manual or brochure, a software application or driver.

Each download consists of a single file, plus a rich-text description which you can create and edit as you would a Knowledgebase article.

You can make a new download using the **Create** button in the toolbar.

To select the file, you can either:

- click **Choose Files** and upload a file from your computer
- click the **Hotlink an existing file** link and enter a URL (web address) for the file

- you must enter the full URL e.g. `http://www.example.com/files/manual.pdf`
- you can optionally specify the file size to display

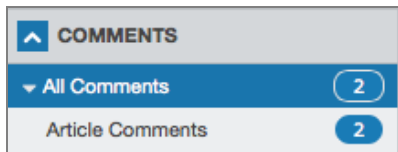
Once you've selected a file, you can use the **File Name** field to change the filename. You can use this to pick a name that is more meaningful to users. For example, you might have saved your download file as `Gyr Manual-updated FINAL davehasapproved.pdf`, but a better user-facing filename would be `ACME_Gyrocopter_Manual-v2.pdf`.

Click **Create Download** to save your download. It will only be available to users if you save it as **Published**.

6.5. Comments on portal content

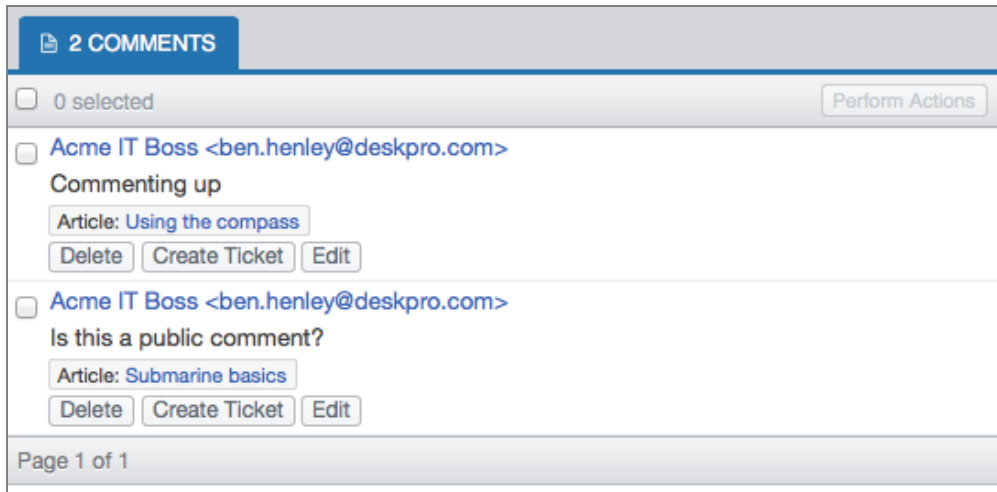
Users with the right permissions can add comments on portal content.

You can select user comments from the **Comments** section of the filter pane.



Comments may need to be approved before they can become visible.

Select comments in the filter pane to view them in the list pane.



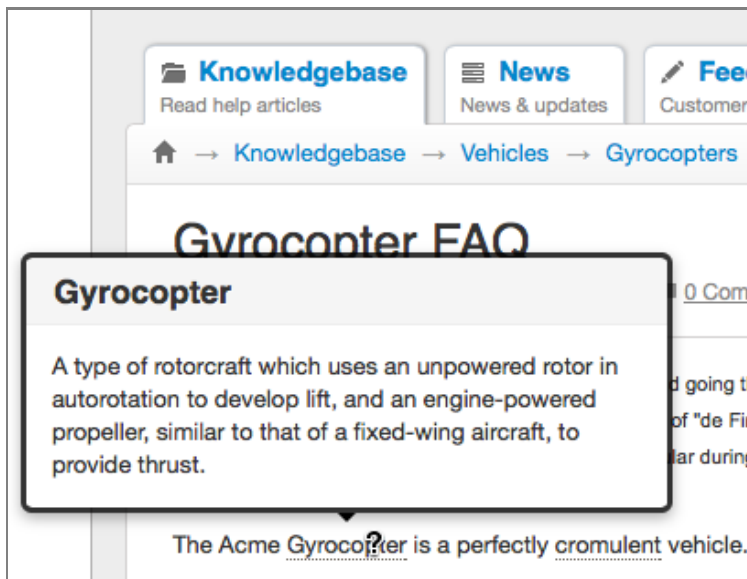
You can approve, delete and edit comments from this view. You can also create a linked **ticket** in case the user's issue needs addressing.

You can also view comments on an item when it is open in the list pane, using the **Comments** tab.

6.6. Glossary

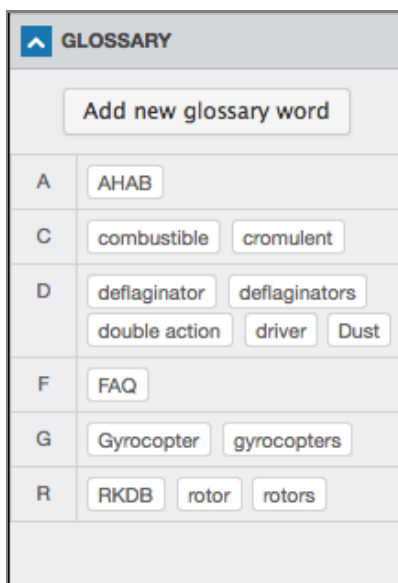
The **glossary** is used to provide definitions of terms you use in **Knowledgebase articles**.

If you have a glossary entry for a term, then it is show underlined on the web portal the first time it appears in an article. Users can mouse over to see the full definition.



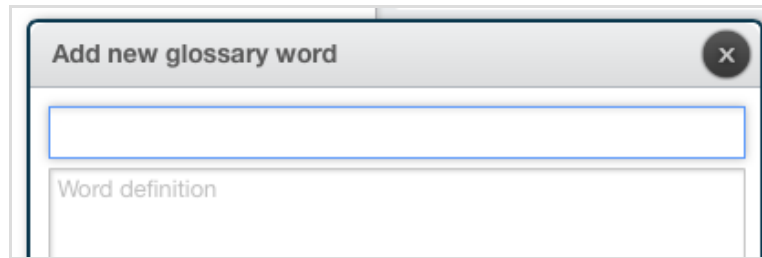
This is useful to explain acronyms or technical terms which might confuse users.

The glossary is displayed at the bottom of the filter pane.



To create a new definition:

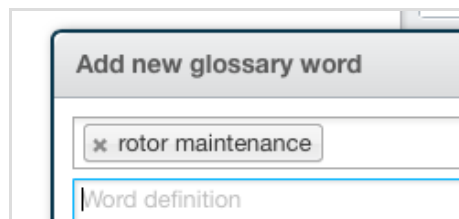
- 1 Click **Add new glossary word**.



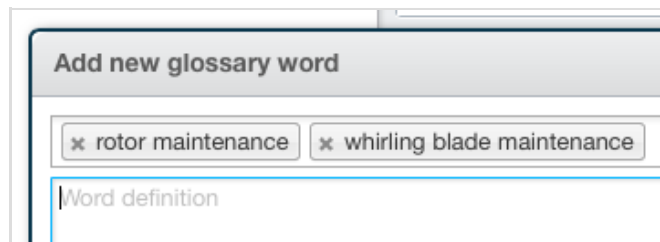
- 2 Enter the term you wish to define in the top field, then press **Tab**.

- 3 Enter the definition and click **Add**.

A term can consist of more than one word.



If you want several variations of a term to share the same definition, you can enter multiple versions

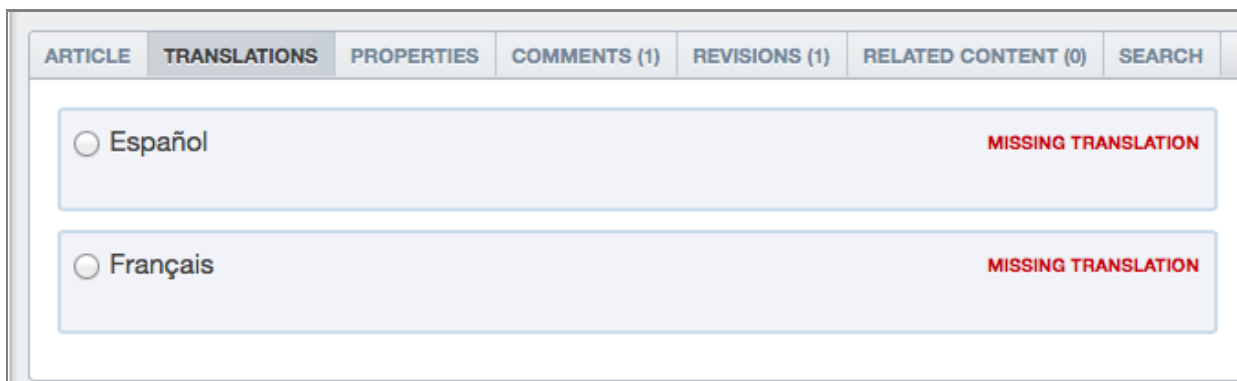


Click an existing term to edit it.

6.7. Advanced properties for Publish content

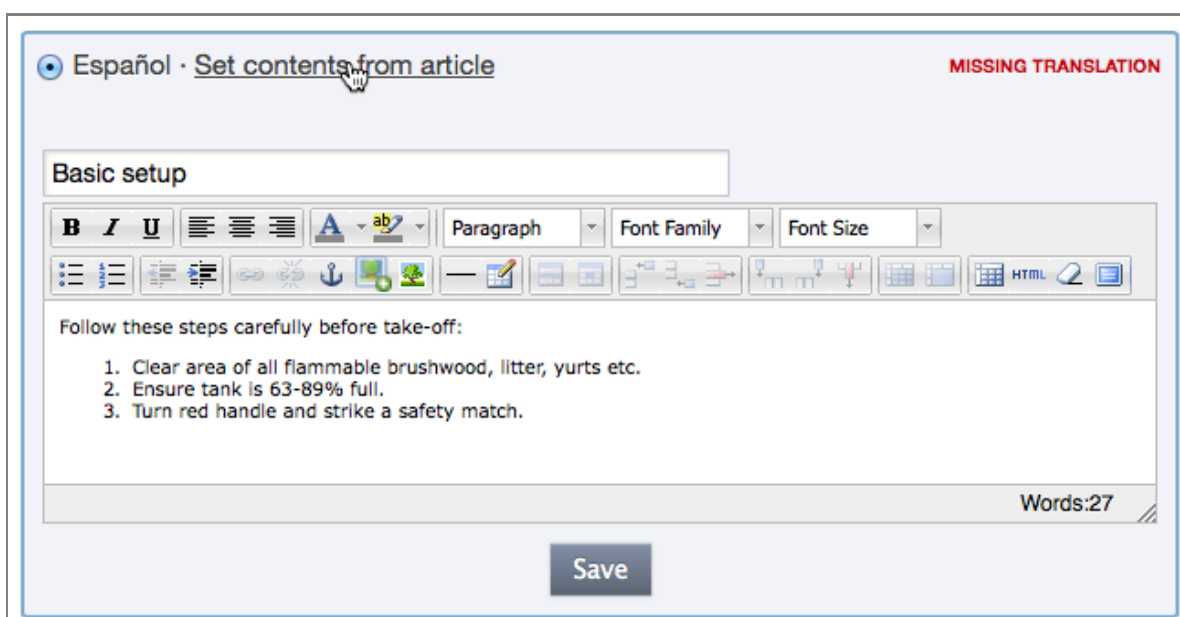
Translations

If your helpdesk has multiple languages enabled, Knowledgebase articles have a **Translations** tab for managing alternate language versions.



Click on a language and edit the translation with the usual rich text editor.

The **Set contents from article** loads the untranslated text into the editor as a guide.



Editing the URL slug for portal content

An item's **URL Slug** is the text that appears at the end of the web address for the item on the web portal.

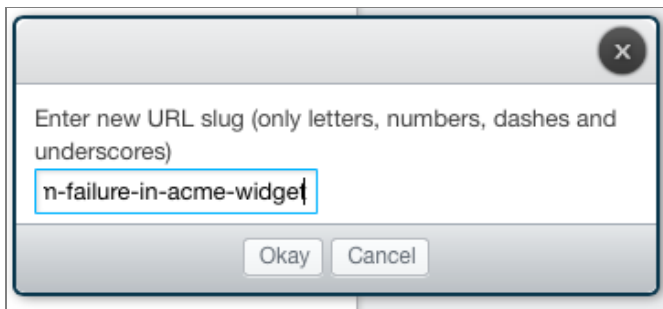
You can see the **URL Slug** for an item in its **Properties** tab. By default, this is based on the title of the item.

For example, if you had an **article** with the title "Diagnosing Shim Failure":

- its URL slug will be `diagnosing-shim-failure`
- its address on the portal will be something like `https://acmeinc.deskpro.com/articles/12-diagnosing-shim-failure`

Putting more descriptive text in the web address can help users find your help content through web search engines.

Click **Edit Slug** to change the URL text to something more descriptive.

A screenshot of a web application dialog box. The dialog box has a title bar with a close button (X) in the top right corner. The main content area contains the text "Enter new URL slug (only letters, numbers, dashes and underscores)" followed by a text input field. The input field contains the text "n-failure-in-acme-widget". Below the input field are two buttons: "Okay" and "Cancel".

Enter new URL slug (only letters, numbers, dashes and underscores)

n-failure-in-acme-widget

Okay Cancel

Click **Okay** to save your change.

Any links to the old address will be redirected to the new address, so don't worry that editing the slug will break any links, or stop users' bookmarks working.

Linking articles to products

On the **Properties** tab of an article, you can select related products. This improves navigation on the web portal.

Viewing revisions of portal content

Click the **Revisions** tab to see a list of previous versions of an item.

To see a comparison of exactly what changed between two versions:

1

Select the two versions to compare with the checkboxes on the right.

ARTICLE	TRANSLATIONS	PROPERTIES	COMMENTS (0)	REVISIONS (3)	RELATED CONTENT (0)	SEARCH
Revision					Compare	
1	By Acme IT Boss, Mar 13 2014				☒	
2	By Acme Support Agent 1, Apr 11 2014				☐	
3	By Acme Support Agent 1, Apr 11 2014				☒	
					Compare Selected	

2

Click **Compare Selected**.

3

The **Comparing Revisions** pop-up window opens, showing the differences.

Comparing Revisions
Acme makes the following vehicles:
Acme Digger
Acme Monster Truck
Acme Gyrocopter
Acme Rocket Sled
Acme Jetpack
Acme Flivver
Acme Disposable Scooter (suspended pending legal outcome)

Setting related content

You can use the **Related Content** tab of an item to cross-reference it to other portal content.

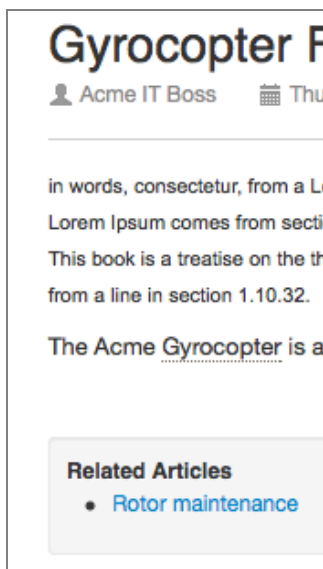
- 1 Find related items in the list pane, then click the **Related Content** tab.



- 2  icons appear next to the list items.

- 3 Click the  to link the two items.

Each of the linked items is shown under "Related articles" when viewed from the other item's portal page.



Setting search terms

You can use the **Search** tab of an item to influence how the item will appear in search results.



Enter search terms related to the item.

ARTICLE	TRANSLATIONS	PROPERTIES	COMMENTS (0)	REVISIONS (8)	RELATED CONTENT (0)	SEARCH
---------	--------------	------------	--------------	---------------	---------------------	--------

Search Words

✕ list

✕ brochure

✕ catalogue

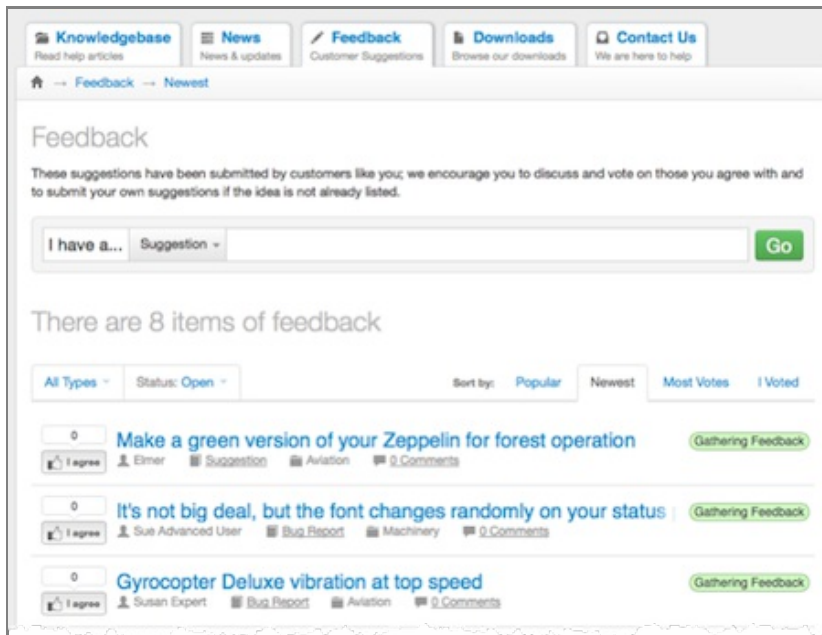
✕ vehicles

When a user searches for any of these words, this page will always be listed in their top results.

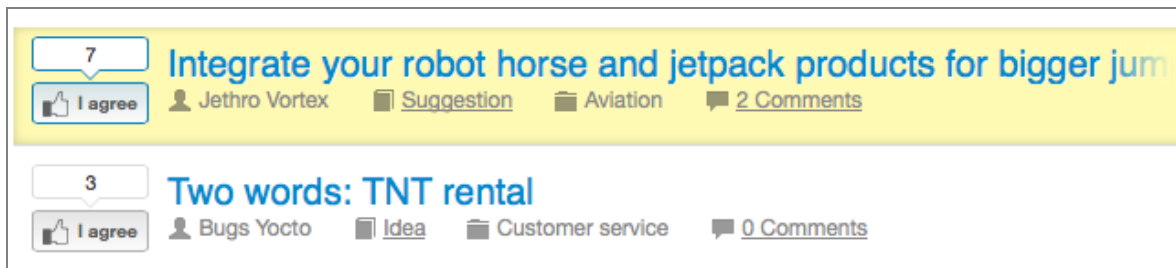
When a user searches for any of the terms you enter using the portal search function, the item will always be listed in their top results.

7. Feedback

The **Feedback** app lets you view and manage user suggestions from the web portal. This enables you to gather crowdsourced ideas to improve your products or services.



As well as submitting items of feedback, users can vote and comment on them (depending on their permissions).

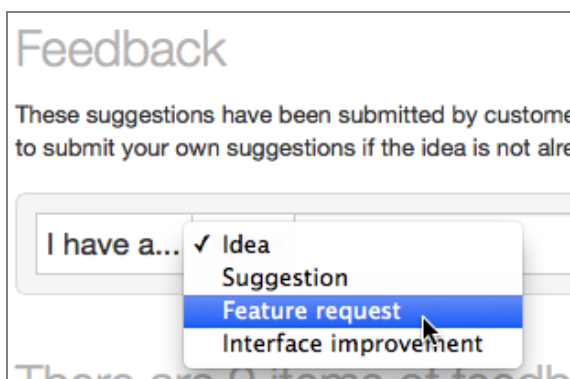


Agents can also vote and comment on feedback.

7.1. Feedback types

Feedback submitted is organized by **type**. The possible types are set by your admins, but some examples would be:

- Suggestion
- Product idea
- Bug report
- Feature request



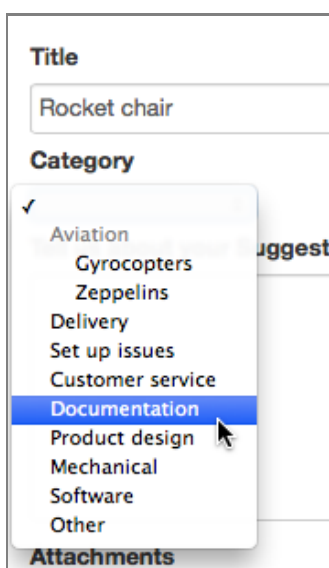
Your admins can configure the helpdesk so that some types of feedback can only be submitted by particular usergroups. For example, you might take **Feature request** feedback only from members of the **Advanced users** usergroup, or **Bug reports** only from **Registered users**.

Feedback categories

Your helpdesk may also require users to select a **category** for their feedback. The categories available are chosen by your admins, based on what categories your helpdesk finds useful.

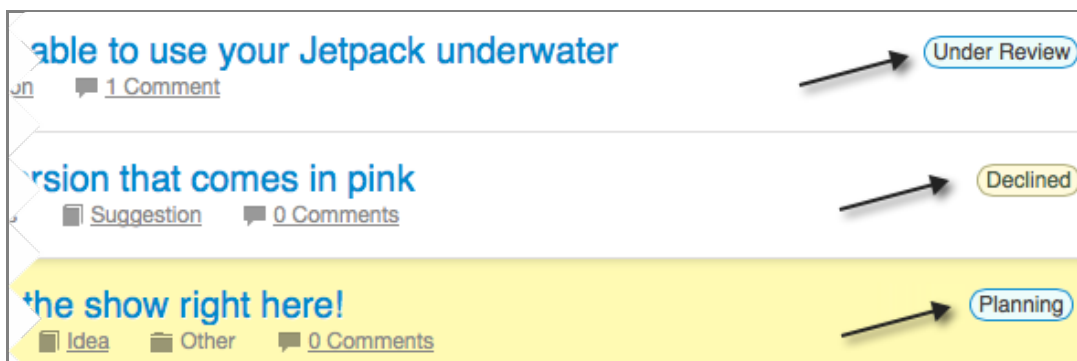
Examples of some possible sets of feedback categories:

- Delivery/Set-up/Usage/Maintenance
- Desktop/Mobile
- Software/Hardware/Packaging/Manuals/Accessories

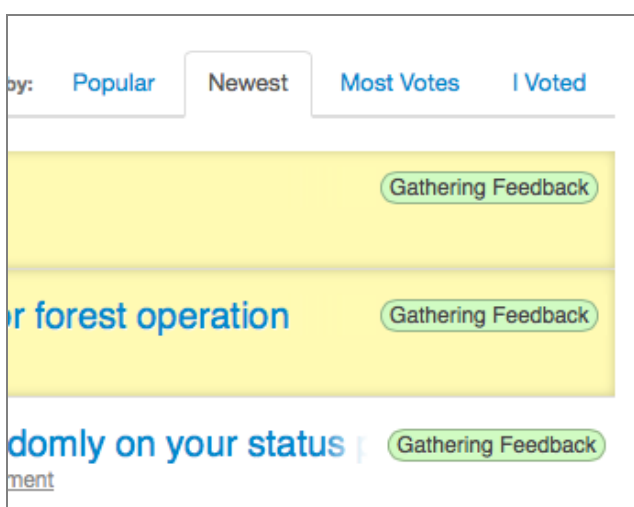


7.2. Feedback status

Feedback items have a **status** which tracks what your enterprise is doing with that item. Users can see the status on the web portal.



A feedback item starts out with **new** status. On the web portal, this is displayed as "Gathering Feedback".



Agents can then change the status to reflect what is happening with each feedback item.

The available statuses are chosen by your admins. You can have as many different statuses as you like, but they are divided into two main kinds:

- **Active** statuses - indicate that the feedback has been looked at by an agent, and your enterprise is going to do something further with it - for example, it is going to be studied further, or it is actively being implemented
- **Closed** statuses - indicate that your enterprise is not going to do anything further with the feedback - for example, it has been acted on or rejected

Examples of possible **Active** statuses:

- Under review
- Planning
- Started
- Testing

Examples of possible **Closed** statuses:

- Completed
- Duplicate
- Declined

Setting an item to a **Closed** status means it is **archived** on the web portal: still visible to users, but no further comments or votes will be accepted.

There are also **hidden** statuses - items that have been **deleted** or **marked as spam** or are waiting for the user to validate their email address. Hidden items are not shown on the web portal.

7.3. Filtering and sorting feedback items

You can see an overview of feedback items in the filter pane.

FEEDBACK		SEARCH
PENDING		
Feedback to Validate		2
Comments to Review		5
STATUS	TYPE	LABELS
New		6
Active		3
Planning		1
Started		0
Under Review		2
Archived		2
Completed		0
Duplicate		1
Declined		1
Hidden		3
Deleted		0
Spam		0

The **Pending** section shows feedback and comments that need agent approval before becoming visible on the web portal.

Which items need approval depends on your DeskPRO configuration: every item may need approval, or only items from unregistered users, or all items that don't come from users in a trusted usergroup.

The **Status** section shows all feedback items which don't need approval, filtered by status.

Use the **Type** or **Labels** tabs to filter by the relevant properties.

Approving pending feedback items and comments

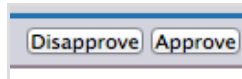
Use the **Feedback to Validate** filter to approve pending feedback items.

FEEDBACK		SEARCH	2 VALIDATING	
PENDING			☐ 0 selected Perform Actions	
Feedback to Validate		2	☐ 100 ton weight rusting Feedback By Brian Canid	
Comments to Review		5	☐ Acme Submarine air gauge backlight Feedback By Brian Canid	

To approve feedback items individually:

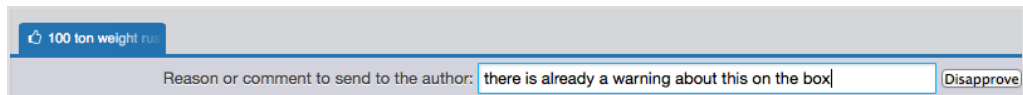
1 Click on the feedback item. It opens in the content pane.

2 Use the **Disapprove/Approve** buttons in the upper left.



3 Click **Approve** to move the feedback to **new** status.

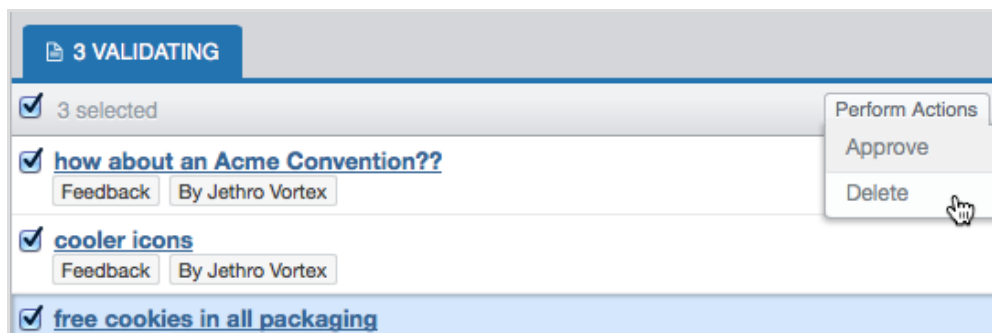
Or click **Disapprove** to delete the feedback. You can enter a brief explanation which will be emailed to the user who created it.



To approve feedback items with mass actions:

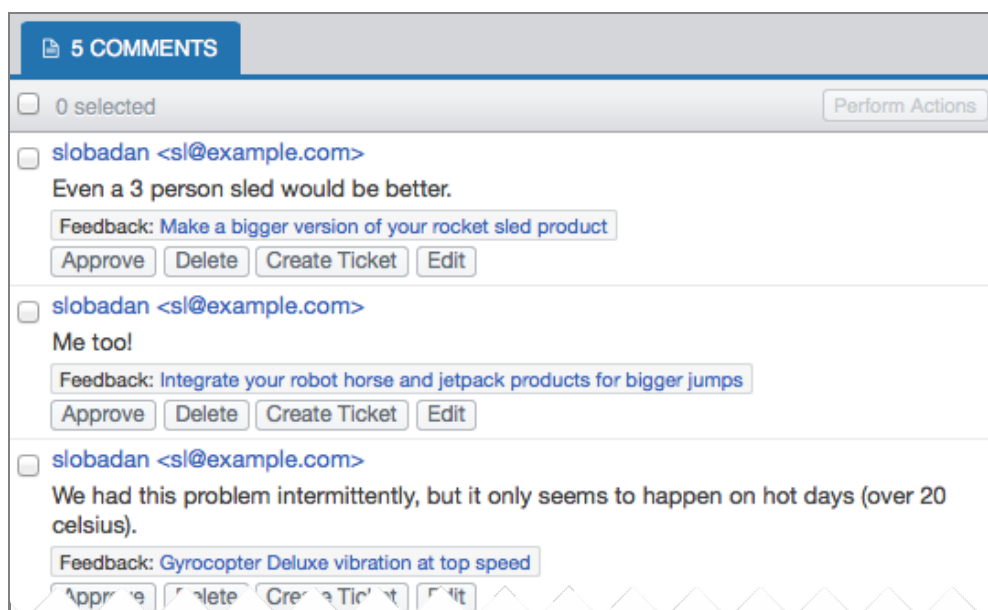
1 Select the items you want to delete using the check boxes to the left.

2 Click the **Perform Actions** button and select **Approve** or **Delete**.



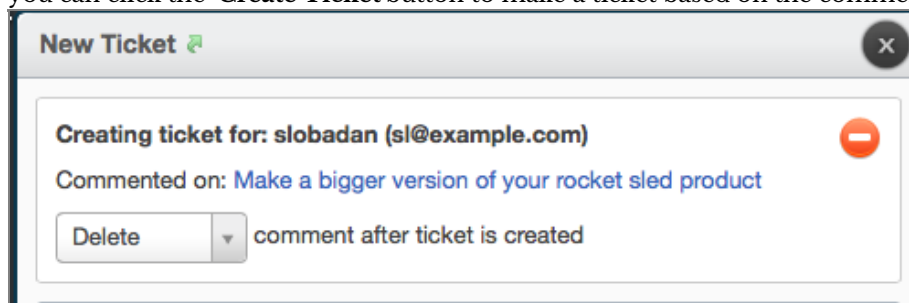
If you choose to **Delete** items with a mass action, you can enter a single explanation to send to all the users.

Use the **Comments to Review** filter to approve pending comments.



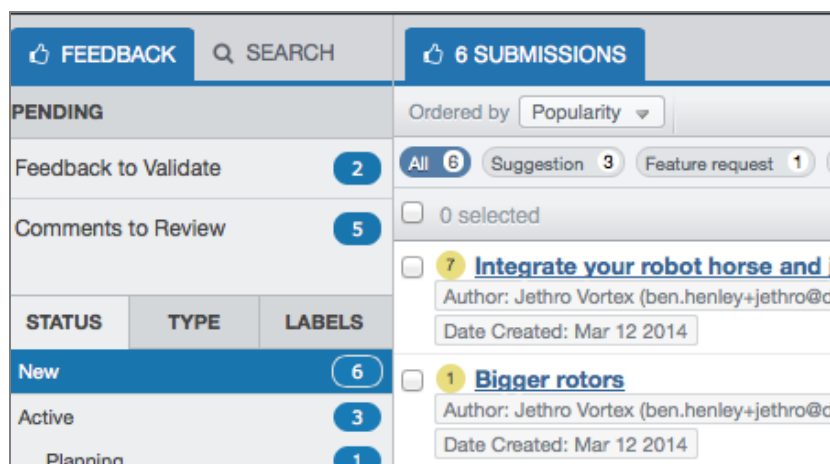
Approving comments works like approving feedback, except that:

- you can't enter an explanation when deleting a comment
- you can **Edit** comments from the list pane; to edit a feedback item you need to open it in the content pane
- you can click the **Create Ticket** button to make a ticket based on the comment

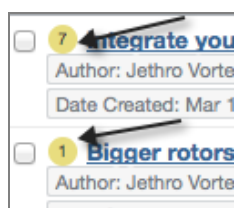


Working with feedback in the list pane

Click on a filter to view all its feedback items in the list pane.

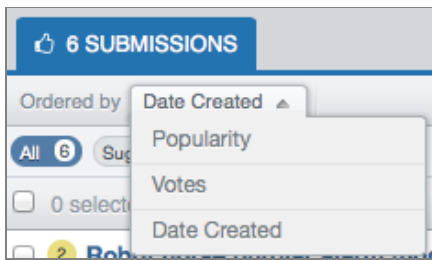


The number of votes for each item is displayed in a yellow circle.

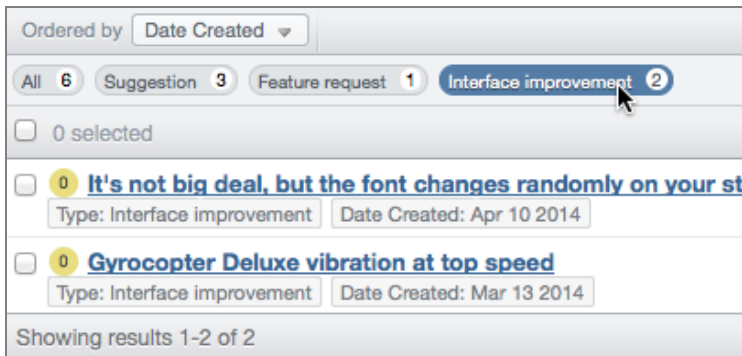


You can use the **Ordered by** control at the top of the list pane to sort feedback by:

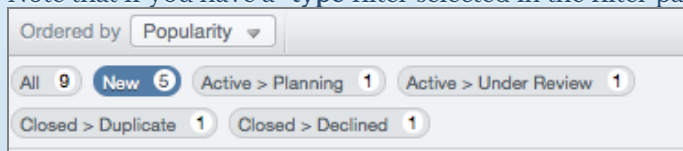
- **Votes** - total user votes
- **Popularity** - popularity score (takes into account both the total number of votes received and how long it took to get those votes)
- **Date Created** - newest at top



You can group by feedback **type** in the list pane:



Note that if you have a **type** filter selected in the filter pane, you can group by status instead.



To carry out **mass actions** on feedback, select items with the checkboxes on the left, then click **Perform Actions**.

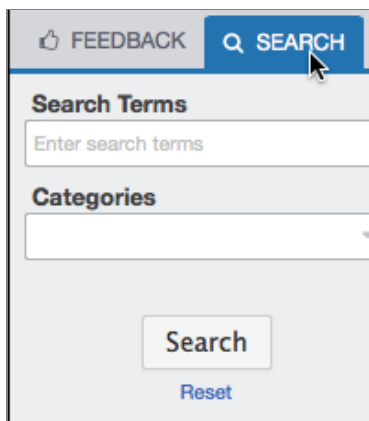
Mass actions available for feedback items are:

- Set status
- Set type
- Delete
- Mark as spam

Searching for feedback

You can find feedback items by ID, title or labels using the **Quick Search bar**.

Advanced search is available from the **Feedback** app filter pane.



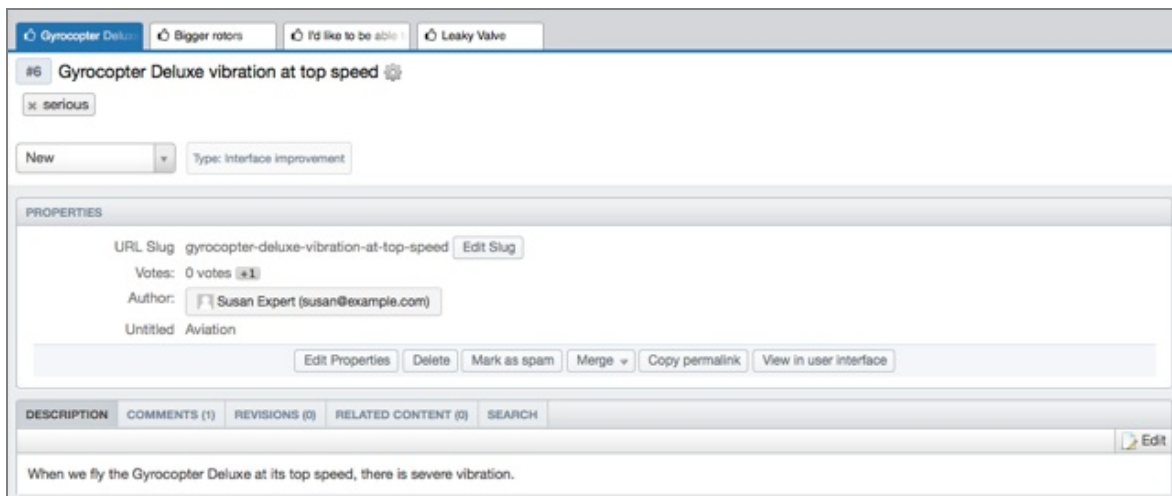
The image shows a feedback search interface. At the top, there are two tabs: 'FEEDBACK' with a thumbs-up icon and 'SEARCH' with a magnifying glass icon. A mouse cursor is pointing at the 'SEARCH' tab. Below the tabs, there is a section titled 'Search Terms' with a text input field containing the placeholder 'Enter search terms'. Below that is a section titled 'Categories' with a dropdown menu. At the bottom of the form, there is a 'Search' button and a 'Reset' link.

Search only works for feedback items, not comments.

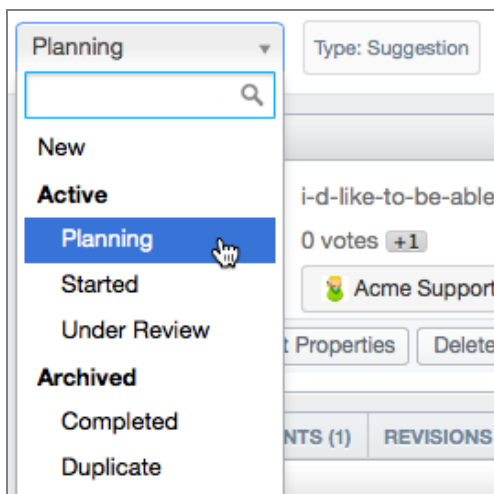
7.4. Working with feedback in the content pane

Click on a feedback item in the list pane to open it in the content pane.

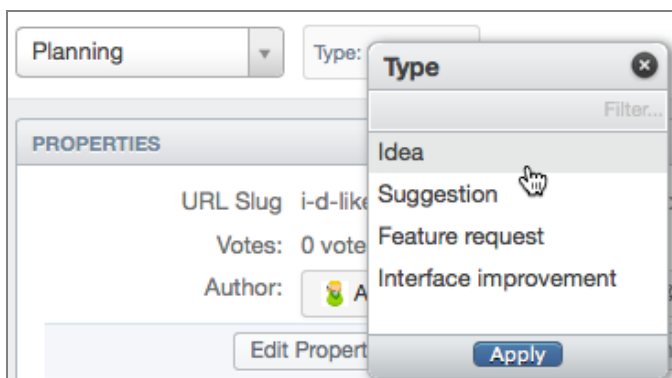
From this view of a feedback item, you can view and edit it in detail.



You can change the **status** of the item using the pull-down menu at the upper left. If your helpdesk has a lot of different statuses, you can type in the search box at the top to filter them.



You can also click on the **Type** box to change the item's type (if your helpdesk uses types).



The **Properties** section enables you to apply a range of actions to the feedback item.

Next to the item's **Votes**, you can vote for it yourself by clicking the **+1** button. If you change your mind, you can withdraw your vote by clicking **+1** again.

Feedback item properties

Click **Edit Properties** to change the item's **category**.

You can also **Delete**, **Mark as Spam** and **Merge** the item.

Merging feedback items works like [merging tickets](#)

Click **Copy permalink** to see a permanent web address for this item that will not change even if you [edit the URL slug](#).

Click **View in user interface** to see the item on the web portal, as users would see it. Note that this shows you how the item will look on the web portal even if it is not currently being displayed to users because it is awaiting validation. In that case, you will see a reminder.

Editing the URL slug for a feedback item

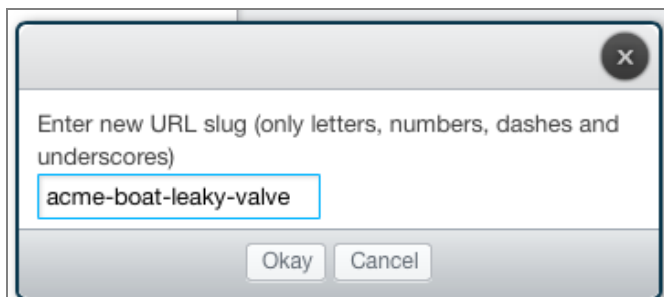
The item's **URL slug** is the text that appears at the end of the web address for the item on the web portal. By default, this is based on the user-submitted title of the item.

For example, if the feedback item's title is "Leaky Valve":

- its URL slug will be `leaky-valve`
- its address on the portal will be something like `https://acmeinc.deskpro.com/feedback/view/17-leaky-valve`

Putting more descriptive text in the address address can help users find your content through web search.

Click **Edit Slug** to change the URL text to something more descriptive.

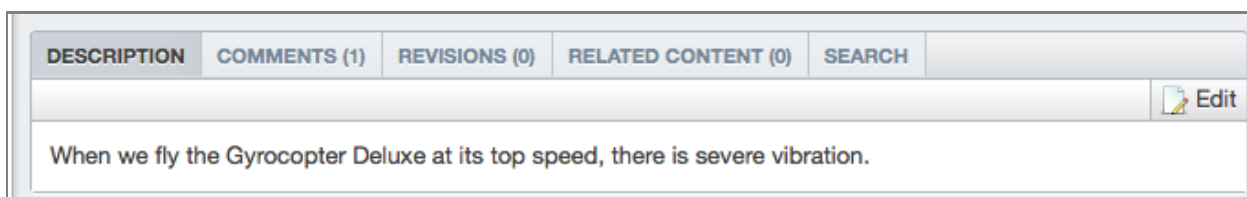
A modal dialog box with a close button (X) in the top right corner. It contains a text input field with the placeholder text "Enter new URL slug (only letters, numbers, dashes and underscores)". The input field currently contains the text "acme-boat-leaky-valve". Below the input field are two buttons: "Okay" and "Cancel".

Click **Okay** to save your change.

Any links to the old address will be redirected to the new address, so don't worry that editing the slug will break any links, or stop users' bookmarks working.

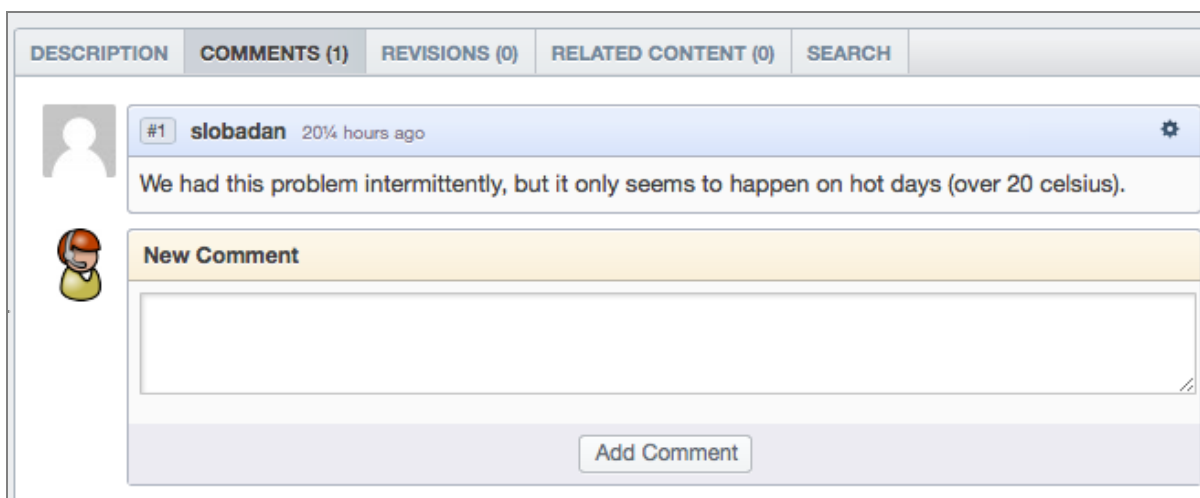
Editing feedback item content

The **Description** tab at the bottom of a feedback item shows you the description submitted by the user.

A screenshot of the feedback item interface. At the top, there are five tabs: "DESCRIPTION", "COMMENTS (1)", "REVISIONS (0)", "RELATED CONTENT (0)", and "SEARCH". The "DESCRIPTION" tab is selected. Below the tabs is a text area containing the description: "When we fly the Gyrocopter Deluxe at its top speed, there is severe vibration." To the right of the text area is an "Edit" button with a pencil icon.

Click the **Edit** button on the right to edit the description. This might be necessary to fix a formatting problem, or to remove sensitive information like passwords.

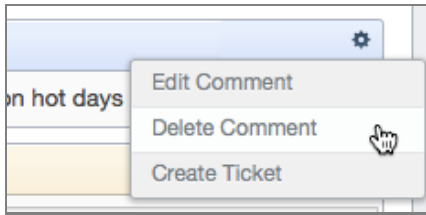
The **Comments** tab shows the comments on a feedback item.

A screenshot of the feedback item interface showing the "COMMENTS (1)" tab selected. The "DESCRIPTION" tab is also visible. Below the tabs, there is a comment from user "#1 slobadan" posted "2014 hours ago". The comment text is "We had this problem intermittently, but it only seems to happen on hot days (over 20 celsius)." Below the comment is a "New Comment" section with a text input field and an "Add Comment" button.

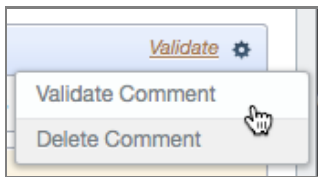
You can use the comment box here to add your own comment, which will be displayed to users on the portal.

Click the  icon to the upper right of an existing comment for options to:

- **Edit** the comment
- **Delete** the comment
- **Create a ticket** based on the comment



Comments awaiting agent approval will have a **Validate** link at the top right. Click it for options to **Validate** or **Delete** the comment.



Click the **Revisions** tab to see a list of previous versions of the feedback item.

To see a comparison of exactly what changed between two versions:

1

Select the two versions to compare with the checkboxes on the right.

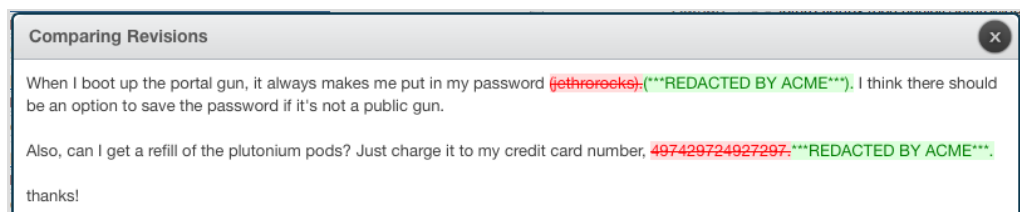
ARTICLE	TRANSLATIONS	PROPERTIES	COMMENTS (0)	REVISIONS (3)	RELATED CONTENT (0)	SEARCH
Revision					Compare	
1	By Acme IT Boss, Apr 11 2014				☒	
2	By Acme IT Boss, Apr 11 2014				☐	
3	By Acme IT Boss, Apr 11 2014				☒	
					<button>Compare Selected</button>	

2

Click **Compare Selected**.

3

The **Comparing Revisions** pop-up window opens, showing the differences.



8. Tasks

The **Tasks** app is a way to keep track of pieces of work agents need to do beyond dealing with tickets. For example, you could use a task to remind yourself to proof-read a product manual next Monday, or to

DeskPRO keeps a list of your outstanding tasks, and can send you a notification the day a task is due.

You can **delegate** tasks to other agents, and see when they have been completed.

Tasks can be **private** or **public**. Public tasks are visible to all agents. Private tasks you create are visible only to you and any agents you assign them to.

Tasks can be assigned to **teams** instead of single agents.

8.1. Creating a task

To create a new task:

1 Click the **Create** button in the toolbar, then **New Task**.

2 The **New Task** window opens.

Enter a description of the task.

3 To set a **due date** (optional), click on **No due date** and select a date from the calendar.

- If a due date is set, you can also choose to specify a time on that date.

4 By default, the task is **Public**.

- You can make the task **Private** using the pull-down menu.

5 By default, the task is assigned to you. If you wish to delegate it, click **Me** and pick an agent or team from the pull-down menu.

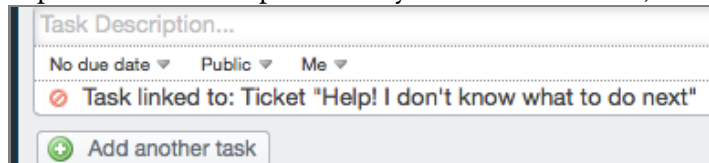
- 6 If you need to create more than one task, click **Add another task** and repeat the above steps.
- 7 When you are finished, click **Save**.

Creating a task linked to a ticket

You can create a task linked to a ticket, making the context for the task more obvious.

There are two ways to create a linked task. You can *either*:

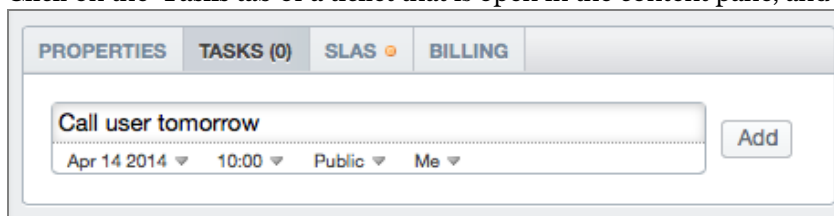
- If a ticket is open in the content pane when you create a new task, the new task will be linked to it

A screenshot of a task creation form. At the top is a text input field labeled "Task Description...". Below it are three dropdown menus: "No due date", "Public", and "Me". Under these is a red circle with a slash icon followed by the text "Task linked to: Ticket 'Help! I don't know what to do next'". At the bottom is a button with a green plus icon and the text "Add another task".

by default. If you don't want the task to be linked to the ticket, click the  icon to remove the link.

or

- Click on the **Tasks** tab of a ticket that is open in the content pane, and enter a task from there.

A screenshot of a ticket's content pane with the "TASKS (0)" tab selected. The tab bar also includes "PROPERTIES", "SLAS", and "BILLING". Below the tabs is a task entry form. It has a text input field containing "Call user tomorrow". Below this are four dropdown menus: "Apr 14 2014", "10:00", "Public", and "Me". To the right of these dropdowns is an "Add" button.

8.2. Keeping track of tasks

The **Tasks** app filter pane shows you an overview of outstanding tasks.

TASKS	
My Tasks	8
Overdue	1
Due Today	1
Due In Future	6
My Teams's Tasks	3
Overdue	0
Due Today	1
Due In Future	2
Tasks I Delegated	10
Overdue	2
Due Today	5
Due In Future	4
All Tasks	21
Overdue	4
Due Today	7
Due In Future	11

You can filter tasks based on assignment and due date.

My Tasks shows tasks assigned to you.

My Teams' Tasks shows tasks assigned to any team to which you belong.

Tasks I Delegated shows any task you have delegated to another agent or team.

All Tasks shows every outstanding task that you are allowed to see:

- all public tasks
- any private tasks you have created or that have been delegated to you

Under each of these filters are sub filters based on due date, showing which tasks are **overdue**, which are **due today** and which are **due in future**.

If there is no due date set for a task, then it is always shown in the **Due Today** filter.

Click on any of these filters to see matching tasks in the list pane.

Task notifications

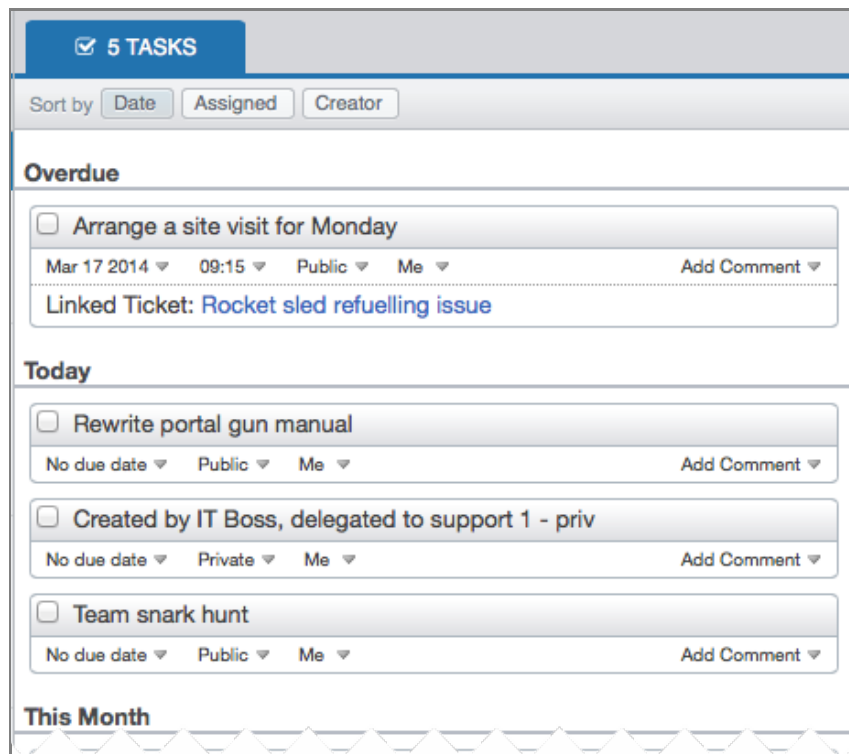
By default, you are notified when a task is assigned to you or your team, when a task you delegated is completed, and when a task that's assigned to you is due that day. You can configure your task notifications in the **Notifications** area of your account preferences.

8.3. Working with tasks in the list pane

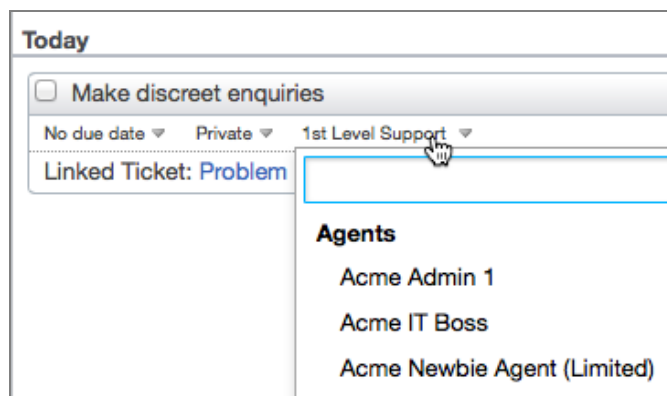
Unlike most DeskPRO items, you can't open a task in the content pane.

Everything you need to do with tasks can be done in the list pane.

At the top of the list pane, you can choose to sort by **Date** (most overdue at top, shown here), **Assigned** agent or **Creator**.



You can re-assign (delegate) a task by clicking the assigned agent or team, and selecting a new one from the pull-down menu.



To mark a task **completed**, just use the checkbox to the left.

The image shows a two-part interface for task management in DeskPRO. The top part shows a task 'Arrange a site visit for Monday' in the 'Overdue' status. The bottom part, indicated by a downward arrow, shows the same task after its status has changed to 'Due Today'.

Top Screenshot (Initial State):

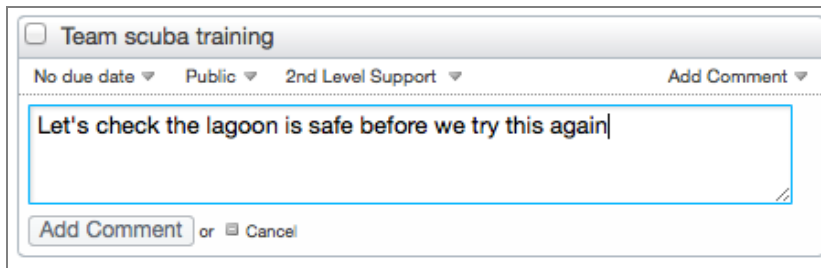
- TASKS** sidebar: My Tasks (5), Overdue (1), Due Today (3), Due In Future (1).
- Sort by:** Date, Assigned, Creator.
- Overdue** section: Task 'Arrange a site visit for Monday' with details: Mar 17 2014, 09:15, Public, Me. Linked Ticket: Rocket sled refuelling issue.

Bottom Screenshot (Final State):

- TASKS** sidebar: My Tasks (4), Overdue (0), Due Today (3).
- Sort by:** Date, Assigned, Creator.
- Overdue** section: Empty.
- Due Today** section: Task 'Arrange a site visit for Monday' (checkbox checked).

8.4. Commenting on tasks

You can click on the **Add Comment** control to comment on a task.



The screenshot shows a modal dialog box for commenting on a task titled "Team scuba training". At the top, there are three dropdown menus: "No due date", "Public", and "2nd Level Support". To the right of these is an "Add Comment" button with a dropdown arrow. Below the dropdowns is a large text input area containing the text "Let's check the lagoon is safe before we try this again". At the bottom of the dialog, there is an "Add Comment" button followed by the text "or" and a "Cancel" button.